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MORE THAN JUST A JOB, IT'S THEIR CROWNING MOMENT

STORY BY CELINE HIJAZI | PHOTOS BY ERIN CLARK | GLOBE STAFF



At Story Land, being Cinderella isn't just a case of having the right slipper

GLEN, N.H. — As the clock strikes 10 a.m., Becca Collins and Jordan Tisdale sit opposite each other in the Story Land changing room, gluing their signature blond wigs in to place in unison.

The outfit is a familiar one: a blond updo matched with a headband and a structured baby-blue gown stretching to the floor, narrowly covering the women's new and improved glass slippers: blue Converse with silky shoelaces.

Unlike in the titular story, when the clock strikes for Collins and Tisdale, their performance is just beginning.

Their dressing room is fit for a princess. Multicolored wigs and shoes are sprawled across the space, as are princess memorabilia and cards and custom artwork from young admirers.

The day has just started for the



Becca Collins (top) and Jordan Tisdale (embracing Everly Falco) have to be ready for all kinds of children.

princesses, and they aim to impress arguably the most demanding audience of all: children.

Tisdale, 22, strolls out of the changing room and into Story Land, her stage for the day. She passes the Three Little Pigs and a gaggle of amazed children on her morning commute to her pumpkin carriage.

The rest of the Story Land staff is in on the act. Her footman, Chris Perley, bows before opening the door for her, welcoming and greeting the children as they, too, enter the magical pumpkin.

"The first time she showed up, I thought to myself, 'Well, what would the pumpkin coach driver do?' Of course, he would bow to her highness," Perley said. "We're putting our best foot forward to keep that magic going."

Tisdale's take on Cinderella is

CINDERELLA, Page A7

Suspected thief of vintage sailboat in N.J. is fatally shot days later in R.I.

By Christopher Gavin
GLOBE STAFF

Last Sunday looked like an ideal day to be on the water, so James and Jennifer Bonomo went to their marina in Jersey City, N.J., for a day of cruising around New York Harbor on their vintage 40-foot sailboat.

But Pathfinder, as they named their 1968 Hinckley Bermuda 40 Custom Yawl, was not where it's been docked for a decade. Puzzled, James Bonomo wondered if marina staff had moved it, but soon learned that wasn't the case.

Surveillance video at the marina had captured someone the night before hopping a fence and then, after boarding Pathfinder, launching the elegant vessel out into open water.

"I'm just going through my head like, 'Who steals a sailboat?'" Bonomo recalled in an interview Thursday. "Like, this doesn't happen."

Jennifer Bonomo quickly made a flier about the missing vessel. The couple spent the rest of their day, and late into the night, with investigators. After alerts were sent to marinas and harbors up and down the

East Coast, James Bonomo got a call from a harbormaster in Newport, R.I., on Wednesday morning.

A boat of a similar description had been found, anchored in the city's North Anchorage, officials have said.

"He said, 'Look, we're going to go check it out. We'll be in touch,'" Bonomo said. "And then literally within 10 minutes, I'm watching the internet blow up with a shoot-out in Newport Harbor."

Police said gunfire erupted Wednesday after a man seen on the

BOAT, Page A6

Moulton's presidential run offers insights into his current campaign

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

Representative Seth Moulton leans heavily on a carefully crafted biography in his Senate campaign, from his combat service in the Marines to his first upset campaign for Congress to his work supporting veterans in politics.

Moulton's most high-profile political endeavor, however, is the one he never mentions: his long-shot run for president in 2020.

That's not surprising, given the topic doesn't offer much for Moulton to brag

about. The Salem congressman joined a crowded Democratic primary field relatively late, failed to pick up traction, and dropped out after four months of campaigning.

Though largely forgotten, Moulton's short-lived shot at the White House is an illuminating lens through which to view his current campaign to unseat Senator Ed Markey, now in its final days before the Sept. 1 primary.

Key aspects of Moulton's presidential campaign still echo through his Sen-

MOULTON, Page A5

Outcome of Clancy case still uncertain

Jurors begin deliberating with several options

By Lea Skene, Shelley Murphy,
and Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — Over the past five weeks, jurors in Lindsay Clancy's murder trial have heard conflicting accounts about the woman accused of killing her three young children.

Was she a doting mother who became psychotic despite her best efforts to get adequate psychiatric treatment? Or was Clancy deeply depressed and tired of the life she built, determined to kill herself and selfish enough to take her children with her?

On Thursday, the jury began deliberations with those opposing images before them. Legal analysts who have followed the trial said the outcome is far from certain, in part because the case lacks a clear motive or convincing rational explanation for the horrific tragedy at its center.

Clancy has pleaded not guilty, arguing she lacked criminal responsibility because she was suffering from a postpartum psychotic break and hallucinated a man's voice telling her to kill her three children. Commonly called an insanity defense, it's a complex legal strategy that makes the jury deliberations more complicated than a typical criminal trial.

"Even though motive is not a requirement for a murder conviction under the law, jurors want to know why this happened," said John Day, a former state prosecutor in New Mexico who now practices as a defense attorney. "I just don't think the prose-

CLANCY, Page A6

MassHousing report confirms fraud findings

Says executive repeatedly lied about conflict of interest

By Joey Flechas and Gordon Russell
GLOBE STAFF

Former MassHousing executive Tony Richards II repeatedly lied about his professional relationship with two real-estate developers who sold him his home and later received grants of state housing funds from him, according to an investigative report released Thursday.

Richards, who resigned in June, violated the quasi-state agency's policies, the lawyers concluded, including rules about conflicts of interest. Investigators referred their findings to the state Ethics Commission in late July, according to the report.

The report, prepared by attorneys from the Mintz law firm, follows a Globe Spotlight Team investigation into a grant program Richards oversaw that aimed to fix up decrepit affordable housing units in Massachusetts mill towns known as Gateway Cities. The agency commissioned the inquiry after the Globe presented its findings to officials in June.

Mintz's conclusions largely echo the Globe's reporting, from the inconsistencies in Richards's explanations on how he knew the developers to the apparent fraud in the projects the developers

HOUSING, Page A7



President Trump signed an executive order to change the name of Lake Ontario to Lake America, carrying out his threat as part of a trade war. **A2.**

Melissa Hoffer, chosen by Governor Maura Healey as the nation's first Cabinet-level climate chief, is leaving to lead the Vermont Law and Graduate School. **B1.**

Baseball card collecting has become a huge part of the culture of the Red Sox. **C1.**

"Coyote vs. Acme" is a loving tribute to the most hapless of all Looney Tunes characters and the many fans who love him, writes Odie Henderson. **G1.**

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Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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YAYOI KUSAMA DIES

— The artist, whose polka-dot-covered paintings and phallic sculptures caused a stir in the 1960s, found more success recently with her "Infinity Room" installations (left, at the ICA in 2019). **C9.**

LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

The Nation

DAILY BRIEFING

Air traffic controllers face scrutiny

WASHINGTON — Two air traffic controllers stepped away early from their posts at LaGuardia Airport, potentially leaving the tower short-staffed before a jet collided with a firetruck in March, killing two people, according to two people familiar with the matter.

Those controllers are now among a dozen nationwide that the Federal Aviation Administration is taking steps to fire, the people said, as the agency investigates a wide range of timecard irregularities at facilities across the country. Early departures that are not recorded as such are considered a form of timecard fraud.

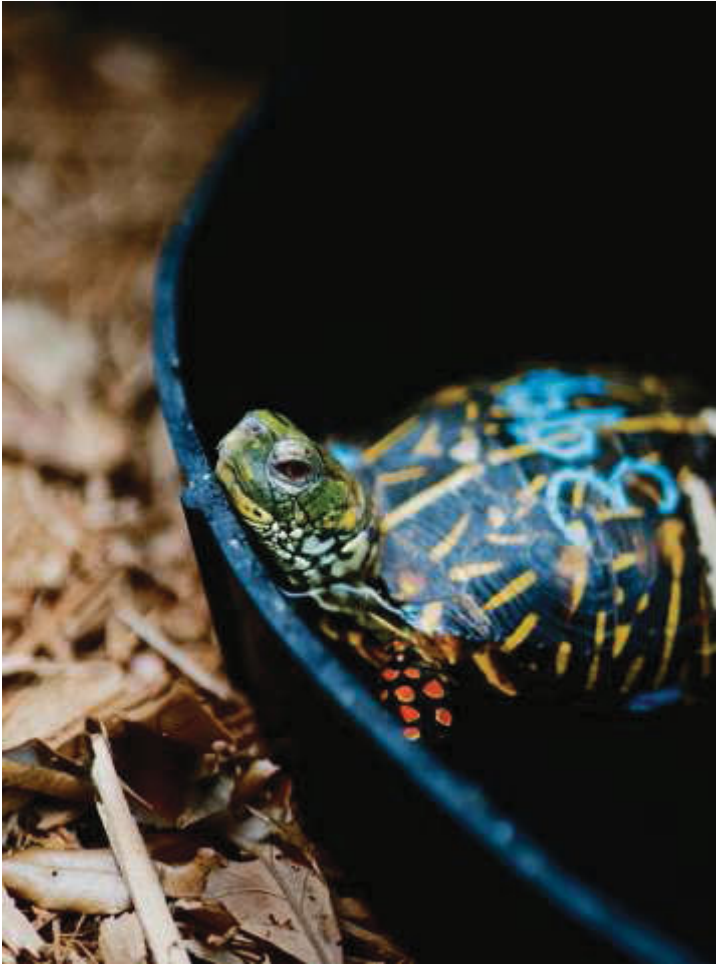
The revelation that the FAA is cracking down on the practice raises questions about whether already short-staffed towers are operating with fewer workers than official statistics suggest.

NEW YORK TIMES

The FAA's moves come as the National Transportation Safety Board continues to probe the cause of the collision between an Air Canada Express jet and fire truck on March 22. A spokesperson for the NTSB declined to comment on the FAA finding.

It was not immediately clear whether the controllers' early departure played a direct role in causing the crash, and when they were supposed to finish their shift.

Some seasoned air traffic controllers are questioning why the FAA is choosing this moment to take such aggressive moves against a practice that shift supervisors have long used as a way of rewarding overtaxed controllers, many of whom are forced to work six days a week to make up for staff shortages.



ELIAS WILLIAMS/NEW YORK TIMES

SAVED FROM SMUGGLERS

A Florida box turtle seized at Kennedy International Airport before smugglers could ship it out was seen at the Bronx Zoo in New York this month. Turtle smuggling has long been a problem at US airports, but trafficking has increased sharply in the past few years,

US charges 80 in gang takedown

SAN JUAN — The Justice Department has charged more than 80 people in the takedown of a violent Puerto Rican gang, Attorney General Todd Blanche announced Thursday during a visit to the island as part of the Trump administration's efforts to highlight its push to tackle violent crime.

Federal prosecutors say the gang known as “Los Baja Deo” for years trafficked fentanyl, cocaine, and other illegal drugs from the west coast city of Mayagüez, generating nearly \$50 million in proceeds. The group is also responsible for shootings, killings, kidnappings, and assaults and the distribution of at least 340 kilograms of fentanyl or fentanyl-laced narcotics, Blanche said.

“Our Homeland Security

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Task Forces around the country are unified and they're unified to end the presence of criminal cartels, foreign gangs and transnational criminal organizations around the United States,” Blanche told reporters from the US attorney's office in San Juan.

Blanche's presence in the US Caribbean territory for the announcement underscores the Trump administration's efforts to put a spotlight on its work tackling cartels and gangs that fuel drug trafficking and violence in communities across the US. The Trump administration has dramatically reshaped the Justice Department to make tackling illegal immigration and violent crime a top priority.

ICE agent tied to shooting is freed

BROWNSVILLE, Texas — An immigration officer facing state charges in connection with a shooting in Minneapolis was released from jail Thursday after Republican officials in Texas prevailed in an extradition battle with their Democratic counterparts in Minnesota. It is unclear whether the agent will ultimately answer those charges in court.

The officer, Christian Castro of Immigration and Customs Enforcement, had been jailed for the last three months in Cameron County, Texas, while Minnesota officials sought to have him sent north to face as-

sault charges related to a shooting in January that wounded a Venezuelan immigrant.

Sheriff Manuel Trevino of Cameron County said Castro was released just before 7 a.m.

It is rare for federal agents to face state criminal charges for on-duty conduct, and the Trump administration has argued that the charges filed against Castro are illegitimate. It is also exceedingly rare for one governor not to act on a request from another to extradite a criminal defendant, as Governor Greg Abbott of Texas has done.

NEW YORK TIMES

Changes name to ‘Lake America’

By Erica L. Green
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump signed an executive order on Thursday to change the name of Lake Ontario to Lake America, carrying out his threat to rename the easternmost Great Lake as part of an escalating trade war with Canada.

During remarks in the Oval Office, Trump said the order, which directs the Interior Department to update the government's Geographic Names Information System to reflect the name change, was effective immediately.

After signing the order, Trump reiterated his criticism that Canada had been taking advantage of the United States, and that the country “treats us very badly.” He added that Canada was the “worst” to deal with on trade, and he reissued his threat to impose steep tariffs on automobiles made there. “Canada has been ripping us

off for a long time on trade, very sadly,” he said. “Even the military, you know, we defend Canada for nothing. We don't get anything.”

Canada, like the United States, is part of NATO, a security alliance with a mutual defense agreement. Canada is also one of the United States' closest intelligence partners.

Like Trump's order to rename the Gulf of Mexico to the Gulf of America, Thursday's order most likely requires only federal entities to recognize the change, but it does not have to be recognized by other countries. Trump told reporters that the administration had “filed all the necessary papers, documents” and “notified all of the various people that we have to notify” to make the change.

“So we've done everything that you have to do,” he said, “and this is official, effective immediately.”

Canadian and US officials have rebuffed Trump's attempt to rename the body of water.

New York Governor Kathy Hochul dismissed Trump's

threat earlier this week as “silly talk.” And on Thursday, she reposted the White House's new directive on social media, and said the state, which borders the lake, will not comply. “New York won't be calling it that,” she wrote.

Wab Kinew, the premier of Manitoba, likened Trump's actions to a has-been rock group replaying songs from its heyday.

“He thought he had a real hit, a real golden oldie, with the Gulf of Mexico, and he's trying to bring that back,” Kinew told reporters Thursday afternoon. “He's trying to play the hits for his base, but I think everybody here thinks it's a little sad, and it's not his best work.”

Prime Minister Mark Carney also weighed in, saying in a social media post: “We know that America is changing. Their trading relationships, their foreign policies, their national monuments, their hydronyms. Canadians also know that naming reality means calling it Lake Ontario — then, now and always.”

Trump first announced in a social media post earlier this week that the United States was giving “serious consideration” to changing the name of Lake Ontario after trade talks between the two countries fell apart.

Canadian officials walked away from what they publicly described as deal-breaking demands from the United States. In the social media post, Trump said the name change was being considered because “we don't expect to be doing much business with Ontario any longer.”

Trump then continued to troll Canada on Wednesday by posting a photo of a map with Lake Ontario crossed out in red ink, and a video of him swiping through the name with a pen and writing “Lake America” in its place. On Thursday, Trump displayed a large poster board depicting the new “Lake America” that blared “Making the Great Lakes Even Greater.” Associated Press writer Rob Gillies in Toronto contributed to this report.

GOP caught in a bind as midterms near

By Tim Balk, Shane Goldmacher, and Maggie Haberman
NEW YORK TIMES

President Trump has been the most potent force in Republican primary elections, elevating allies and foiling foes with endorsements, social media posts, and rally appearances.

But as the end of primary season draws near and the sprint to the general election begins, Trump may soon be something entirely different for Republican candidates. A liability.

The president's approval rating is well underwater, dragged down by rising prices and an unpopular war. And Democrats have made clear that they hope to target Republican candidates in battleground races by tying them to Trump, believing they can ride voter anger with his administration to congressional majorities.

Yet Republicans in competitive contests may still need him. Even as they look for ways to distance themselves from Trump to appeal to swing voters, they must also weigh the president's hold on their party's base and his tendency to lash out at Republican dissenters.

“It's a difficult one,” said Brendan Steinhauser, a Republican strategist in Texas, adding that the president's approach to the primaries had probably made the dilemma harder for candidates, but predicting they would increasingly seek separation from him. “I think it'll be very subtle. I think it'll be district by district.”

Many Republicans are hoping for financial support from the president's well-funded but tightfisted super political action committee, MAGA Inc., which came to the rescue of Senator Darline

Graham in her hotly contested Republican runoff this week. The group flooded the contest with more than \$800,000 worth of voter calls and text messages.

There are signs of deeper involvement to come in races against Democrats. At a meeting in the Oval Office this month, Trump met with senior advisers and a small number of ad-makers who had signed up with MAGA Inc., according to two people briefed on the meeting, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe a private conversation. The existence of the meeting was first reported by The Atlantic.

The gathering included a discussion about Democrats' plans to make the election a referendum on Trump, and the president made clear that he wanted the advertising to include a robust defense of his record, according to the people briefed on the meeting. It was unclear how big of a share commercials focused on Trump would take of a fall ad campaign.

Spending by the group could be a welcome development for Republicans. As political headwinds have strengthened against them in the spring and summer, they have been holding out hope that MAGA Inc. would begin to invest in a challenging midterm cycle. But a rush of spending could also offer another way for the president to tighten his grip on the party — and on candidates who are angling for a measure of independence.

Trump, who has managed to revive his standing after past spells of widespread unpopularity, has started to put himself at the center of the midterms. He has urged supporters to “pretend” he is on the ballot and suggested he will spend significant

campaign cash reserves.

Democrats are just as eager for him to play a starring role. Representative Jamie Raskin, a Maryland Democrat, argued that congressional Republicans had been boxed in by the president and rendered little more than a rubber stamp for his agenda.

“Donald Trump controls the

‘Donald Trump controls the Republican caucus in Congress like a bunch of trained seals.’

REPRESENTATIVE JAMIE RASKIN, *Democratic lawmaker from Maryland*

Republican caucus in Congress like a bunch of trained seals,” Raskin said Wednesday as he headed to a campaign event for Abdul El-Sayed, a candidate for Senate in Michigan. “This is essentially what the November elections are about.”

One of the biggest variables on the minds of Republicans is money. The president has kept them guessing about how MAGA Inc. might deploy its massive war chest.

Trump continues to fundraise, but he has been far less willing to part with the record sums he has accumulated.

“I'll be spending a lot of that money and my own money,” Trump told reporters last week, though he has not spent any of his personal funds on politics in a decade. “But I'll be spending a lot of that money for candidates that I think are good.”



PABLO MARTINEZ MONSIVAIS/ASSOCIATED PRESS

ALLOWING FREEDOM TO RING — Workers installed bulletproof glass around the podium at the Lincoln Memorial in Washington in preparation for Friday's anniversary of the March on Washington.

The World

Russian sanctions fuel Canadian car thefts

Thousands end up on black market

By Jane Bradley and Michael Schwartz
NEW YORK TIMES

A yearslong car theft epidemic in Canada has gotten so bad that, despite a police crackdown, thieves break into homes just to steal car keys. Thousands of cars vanish each year.

The phenomenon, records and interviews show, is driven in part by an unexpected source: a booming black market for Western vehicles in wartime Russia.

While Western export bans have severed Russia from much of the auto market, they have not tempered the demand for brand-name SUVs and trucks. That has given rise to a sophisticated network of criminals that steals cars, hides them in shipping containers and sends them to Russia, often by way of the Middle East.

“A forbidden fruit is always sweet,” Daniil Aleynik, a Russian national, said during an interview from a Ukrainian jail, where he was being held on charges of participating in an international car theft scheme. “There are a lot of cars in Canada, and stealing them there is very convenient.”

Interpol, the international police organization, received 4,798 reports that stolen Canadian vehicles had been found in Russia from February 2024 to July 2026, according to data obtained by The New York Times and confirmed by two law enforcement officials who spoke on the condition of anonymity because it is considered sensitive.

Pickup trucks like Dodge Rams, Toyota Tundras, and Ford F-150s are in particularly high demand.

The Interpol figures significantly undercount the problem, but Russia is by far the top international destination for Canadian cars reported to Interpol, according to the Royal Canadian Mounted Police.

The number of cars stolen from Canadian streets, parking



NASUNA STUART-ULIN/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Canadian Border Services Officer Frédéric Bonsaint after searching a shipping container in Montreal recently.

lots, and driveways is a measure of how Western sanctions have had surprising, and at times undesired, consequences. Just as a network of smugglers and dilapidated tankers expanded to evade oil embargoes, criminal groups moved to fill the void when Western automakers left the Russian market and many countries banned auto exports there.

“The stolen cars are not by chance,” said Renato Schipani, who oversees Interpol’s stolen vehicle database. “They are stolen to order.”

Demand for pricey Western cars has always been high in Russia. The sanctions unintentionally incentivized sellers to find illicit ways to supply the market, driving up prices and making the cars even more of a status symbol, Aleynik said at the Chortkiv detention facility in western Ukraine.

The Interpol records are imperfect. Cars can sometimes inadvertently be counted twice, and some countries, including the United States, do not reliably report thefts to Interpol. Others do not report recovered cars. But law enforcement officials say the figures reflect trends and offer an important snapshot of how stolen cars move internationally.

Since Canada’s car theft epidemic began in 2021, officials have introduced policing overhauls and invested tens of millions in tackling the crime. Theft

rates have fallen, but stolen vehicles still flow through Canadian ports.

“The majority of the high value vehicles are still being stolen for export — that’s where the money is,” said Bryan Gast, a former police officer who is now intelligence lead for the nonprofit antifraud group Équité Association.

Canadian officials recognized early that stolen cars were ending up overseas. But at first, they eyed the wrong countries.

Car thefts surged in Canada after COVID lockdowns were lifted in 2021. With the global supply chain in turmoil, criminals spotted an opportunity. Within a year, auto theft rates in Canada had reached historic highs and continued to climb.

“It was the Wild West,” said Scott Cresswell, a detective at York Regional Police just outside Toronto. “People were having multiple cars stolen. Toronto would have been having 30 cars stolen a night.” Police recovered cars as often as they could, but thousands disappeared every year. In the hot spots of Ontario and Quebec, nearly half of the stolen cars vanished.

In August 2023, authorities recovered several stolen cars in Toronto. Their investigation led them to a transnational crime network that was exporting stolen vehicles using bogus paperwork.

After the discovery, the Cana-

‘There are a lot of cars in Canada, and stealing them there is very convenient.’

DANIIL ALEYNIK, *charged with participating in car theft scheme*

dian border agency shifted its approach. Officials had primarily focused on investigating what was arriving in Canada. They began taking a closer look at what was leaving.

Agents began raiding shipping containers. As they did, they realized how lucrative the trade in stolen cars had become.

Frédéric Bonsaint, an officer at the border agency, said that every week, his team searched about a dozen containers at the Port of Montreal and discovered 20 to 30 stolen cars worth in total up to \$2 million. Similar checks are carried out at other ports.

One day in June, Bonsaint cracked open a 40-foot shipping container and peered in with a flashlight. Sandwiched between old mattresses, boxes of household goods and two legal cars was a gleaming white stolen Land Rover. The vehicle was worth about \$125,000 new but would most likely sell for nearly double that, Bonsaint said.

“Vehicle theft is so lucrative for criminals because property theft is not as penalized like other crimes, say trafficking drugs,” Bonsaint said.

The flood of car thefts coincided with the financial sanctions and export bans that Western governments hoped would punish Russia for the full-scale invasion of Ukraine. That made Western vehicles more valuable.

The Russian black market did not create Canada’s criminal gangs or smuggling networks. Those ingredients were already in place, said Aleynik, the Russian who faces car theft charges. The sanctions merely increased demand and profits.



NIRANJAN SHRESTHA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Rescuers carried a victim of flash flooding to safety along the Trishuli River in Nepal’s Nuwakot district Wednesday.

For many in Nepal, a sudden disaster left little time to react

By Binod Ghimire, Anupreeta Das, Leo Sands, and Michael Levenson
NEW YORK TIMES

KATHMANDU, Nepal — It was already too late when the call came.

Rajan Khatri, 41, a police officer, was working at his station in a mountain village in northern Nepal when a friend rang Wednesday morning to warn that a flash flood was thundering downriver in his direction. As soon as he hung up, giant waves slammed into the station.

“I cannot explain how big the waves were,” Khatri said from a hospital bed in Nepal’s capital, Kathmandu, on Thursday. “They engulfed several meters-high buildings in a fraction of seconds. It wasn’t just water. It was a combination of boulders, sand, and thick sludge.”

The onslaught flung Khatri out of the building, and he lost consciousness and suffered chest injuries. Two of his colleagues survived, but four were missing on Thursday.

They were among the more than 1,400 people missing in the devastating deluge of rock, ice, trees, mud, and water that blasted through river valleys on the border between Nepal and Tibet, washing away bridges, smashing homes, schools, and hydropower plants, and swallowing people who tried to run away.

On Thursday, emergency workers climbed across steep Himalayan valleys and used helicopters to ferry shocked survivors to safety as they carried out a sprawling search for anyone who had managed to escape the flood.

Nepali officials said at least 389 people had been killed, while the authorities in China, where far less information was being released, reported three deaths in the Tibet region of China. The death toll was expected to rise.

In Nepal, more than 900 people, including about 500 foreign visitors, were unaccounted for, the country’s disaster management agency said. The missing foreigners included at least 288 from India, as well as travelers from the United States, Australia, Britain, Canada, and Malaysia.

In Tibet, at least 558 people were missing in Gyirong County, including 260 foreigners, Chinese state media reported. China’s Foreign Ministry said 100 Chinese citizens were missing in Nepal.

The US State Department

said in a statement that about 90 citizens “may be impacted by the floods” and three had been rescued in Nepal. It said it was not aware of any Americans who had died.

Survivors described having almost no time to react before giant waves came roaring down the Bhotekoshi and Trishuli rivers.

Smriti Ojha, 17, said she had been getting ready for school Wednesday morning when she felt the ground shaking. She ran out of her house, believing an earthquake had struck. Then she saw the flood. She said her immediate family had survived, but four of her relatives were missing.

“It was terror,” Ojha said from a hospital bed in Kathmandu. “I cannot believe everything was swept away before my eyes.”

Officials and aid organizations were still assessing the scale of the destruction in the remote region, renowned for its high-altitude lakes and steep peaks.

New York Times journalists traveling with the Nepali military Thursday surveyed the devastating aftermath. One highway, near the Bhotekoshi River, had mostly disappeared. Scars on hillsides showed that in some places, the river had risen more than 650 feet during the flood.

Rescue efforts were being hampered by communication lines that had been cut and the destruction of dozens of bridges and about 25 miles of roads, Nepal’s government said.

The Nepali army’s search-and-rescue base was packed with hundreds of army personnel and survivors, some of whom wept after arriving by helicopter. The area had no electricity or phone networks after the flood, and soldiers and other rescuers were using military radios to communicate.

President Trump, speaking in the Oval Office, said he had offered US aid to Nepal. “We are sending aid, and we’ve spoken to the leadership, and we let them know anything they want will happen,” he said.

Scientists piecing together satellite imagery and seismological data said that a high-altitude landslide coinciding with a glacial collapse most likely caused the flash flood. The collapse happened on the north face of Langtang Lirung, a Nepalese mountain near the border with Tibet, at an elevation of around 17,000 feet, scientists said.

US set to pull troops from Nigeria

WASHINGTON — The Pentagon is preparing to withdraw about 200 troops from Nigeria who were deployed this year to help fight Islamic militants, wrapping up a mission that US officials say could serve as a model for future operations in Africa.

At a time when some 50,000 US forces are involved in the war against Iran, US and Nigerian officials say the relatively small deployment to the West African nation had outsized results, including the killing of a top leader of the Islamic State group.

But the mission appears to have had limited success. The terrorists are a long way from being defeated and are still carrying out major attacks across the country.

In recent days, gunmen killed more than two dozen people, including an imam, in northwestern Nigeria, and at least 25 people in an attack on a village in the central part of the country, according to news media reports. On Saturday, terrorists launched a large assault on a military base in the northeast.

NEW YORK TIMES

Tropical storm nears Caribbean

Tropical Storm Dolly formed Thursday and was moving toward the Eastern Caribbean, with the potential to deliver damaging winds and heavy rain in the next few days, forecasters said.

Forecasters expect the storm to be short-lived. Dolly may strengthen slightly Thursday but will soon move into an area near the Caribbean Islands where atmospheric conditions typically shred tropical systems apart.

But Dolly could still pack a punch. Rather than dissipating completely, the storm could

transition into a post-tropical system powered not by warm ocean waters, but by colliding masses of cool and warm air. That transition could allow Dolly to maintain damaging winds as it approaches the islands over the weekend.

The storm’s name, just two days after the death of country music icon Dolly Parton, is coincidental. Forecasters were quick to point out that Dolly has been on the official rotation of names since 1996 and has been used every six years in the Atlantic since then.

NEW YORK TIMES

Zambian opposition leader detained

LUSAKA, Zambia — Police in Zambia detained the country’s main opposition leader Thursday over alleged treason after he handed himself over for questioning after having sought refuge at a United Nations building following a disputed election two weeks ago.

Brian Mundubile, who challenged President Hakainde Hichilema in the Aug. 13 election, surrendered to police alongside his running mate, Makebi Zulu.

They both recorded “warn and caution statements,” according to police — a procedure that normally comes before for-

mal charges are filed. They are being held in custody, police said in a statement.

Hichilema was declared the winner of an unusually troubled presidential election in the copper-rich southern African nation that has a history of largely peaceful votes. Hichilema is expected to be inaugurated for a second five-year term next week.

Mundubile has rejected the result, claiming irregularities in the vote. He said he went into hiding after disputing the election results in fear for his life.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



FRANCISCO SECO/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A firefighter walked next to a destroyed warehouse after Russian drone attacks in Kyiv, Thursday. John Ratcliffe, the US CIA director, made a secretive visit to Moscow this week to share his assessment of the war against Ukraine, officials said. A4

DAILY BRIEFING



PHOTOS BY ASANKA RATNAYAKE/GETTY IMAGES

KEEP CALM AND WADDLE ON

Above, a lone penguin walked up from the shore before being corralled into a holding pen as visitors looked on from an underground viewing bunker on Wednesday in Phillip Island, Australia, home to the world’s largest little penguin colony. At right, a ranger painted the toe of another penguin to indicate it had been vaccinated.



CIA chief urges Russia to cut Ukraine deal

Shares private appraisal of war

By Adam Entous and Julian E. Barnes
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — John Ratcliffe, the CIA director, made a secretive visit to Moscow this week to privately share his bleak assessment of the state of the Russian war against Ukraine and to urge the Russians to cut a deal before their military and economic situation gets worse, current and former officials said.

Ratcliffe delivered the message to Alexander Bortnikov, the head of Russia’s FSB intelligence service, and made no threats about potential consequences for the Russian side should President Vladimir Putin ignore the CIA director’s assessment and choose to continue fighting.

CIA analysts have long questioned whether Putin’s advisers have given him honest assessments of the war’s trajectory.

The CIA has long maintained communications channels with the FSB and Russia’s foreign intelligence service, which is known as the SVR.

Officials said Ratcliffe’s intelligence channel with Bortnikov runs parallel to separate channels that President Trump’s envoy, Steve Witkoff, and Jared Kushner, the president’s son-in-law, have established with other senior advisers to Putin.

Some officials said they hoped that Putin, a former intelligence officer himself, would see a message from the CIA director as more urgent and credible than communications through normal diplomatic channels.

For much of last year, Trump and some of his top advisers appeared to hold the belief that a Russian battlefield victory over Ukraine was inevitable because of Russia’s larger population.

But the Russians have suffered massive losses, and their battlefield gains have stalled.

It is not clear whether Rat-

cliffe’s message presaged any change in US policy toward Russia or Ukraine.

Ratcliffe’s visit was the latest effort by the Trump administration to breathe new life into stalled negotiations. It has become increasingly clear that Ukraine is not going to give up its fight in the east, even with reduced US military support.

Given what he presented as the bleak military and economic reality for Russia, Ratcliffe told Bortnikov that he believed it was time for Moscow to engage in serious negotiations to end the war.

Since Trump’s return to office, the United States has scaled back its military support to the Ukrainians, forcing them to rely more heavily on European allies.

The CIA has maintained its close intelligence partnerships with the Ukrainians, which began more than a decade ago.

The private message that Ratcliffe delivered to Bortnikov about Ukraine echoed some of the director’s public statements.

Last month, Ratcliffe spoke out pointedly about Russian troop losses during the war and Moscow’s inability to advance on the battlefield. He noted that the life expectancy of a Russian soldier on the front lines was less than 35 minutes.

And he added that Russia had gained only about 1 percent of Ukraine’s total territory in the 18 months since he became CIA director, a development he attributed to Ukraine’s “mastery” of drone technology.

Before Ratcliffe met with Bortnikov in Moscow, he spoke with his Ukrainian counterparts, assuring them that he would be exploring Russian positions, not making concessions on behalf of the Ukrainians.

European diplomats believe there may be an opening to secure a peace agreement in the coming months, given the largely stalled Russian offensive in the Donbas region, and because of Ukraine’s ability to impose deep costs with its drone warfare.

Saudis poised to renew war with Houthis

Goal of escalation remains unclear

By Vivian Nereim
NEW YORK TIMES

RIYADH, Saudi Arabia — After weeks of attacks by Yemen’s Houthi militia on Saudi ships, airports, and oil facilities, Saudi Arabia appears to be preparing for a renewed war against the group, analysts say, potentially deepening the turmoil in the Middle East.

It is unclear what Saudi Arabia’s goals would be if it were to go back to full-blown war with the Houthis. But it could open a new front in the US war with Iran — the Houthis’ primary backer.

When the kingdom last embarked on a bombing campaign against the Houthis, in 2015, it turned into a decade-long quagmire that entrenched the group’s rule in northern Yemen and resulted in the deaths of hundreds of thousands of Yemenis from violence, hunger, and disease.

Few observers or officials believe there is a realistic path to routing the militia entirely. Instead, Saudi Arabia could aim to weaken the group and pressure it to negotiate a resolution to Yemen’s civil war that is more favorable to the kingdom and its Yemeni allies, analysts say.

Channels that were kept open for years between the two sides appear to have broken down. “I am not seeing a political off-ramp at this point,” said Mohammed al-Basha, a Yemen-focused political analyst based in Washington. “War is coming.”

Earlier this week, the Houthis claimed responsibility for a ballistic missile attack on a Saudi oil tanker as well as two attacks on Saudi-backed forces inside Yemen, with the group’s military spokesperson, Yahya Saree, promising to confront any escalation with “stronger and more severe strikes.”

A Saudi official, speaking on condition of anonymity in line with government protocol, said the kingdom prefers peace, but is ready for war with the Houthis, and will protect itself by any means necessary.

If the Houthis continue to escalate their attacks, he added, the kingdom would be willing to conduct airstrikes to support the Yemeni government — effectively, a motley coalition of anti-Houthi forces — in its battle against the militia.

The last Saudi intervention in Yemen was an effort to restore the internationally-recognized government, which the Houthis had ousted from the Yemeni capital,

Sanaa, with Iranian support. The fighting brought the country to the brink of famine and ultimately failed to rout the Houthis.

After a truce in 2022, the Houthis emerged with the conviction that they had won. Saudi officials turned to dialogue, hoping to contain the militia on their southern border and garner influence over it.

That approach appeared to work, until the US-Israeli war against Iran turned into a regionwide conflagration, shifting the Houthis’ calculus.

Yemeni analysts say the militia is acting in part to aid Iran, but that it is also pushing to consolidate its power and secure access to Yemen’s oil resources after years of political stalemate. The group is increasingly describing itself as a legitimate state, and demanding to be treated as such.

Tensions between the kingdom and the militia began to escalate last month, after the Houthis accused Saudi Arabia of bombing Yemen’s main international airport to prevent an Iranian plane from landing, which the kingdom denied. The Houthis then declared a maritime blockade on Saudi ships in the Red Sea.

Since then, Saudi Arabia has carried out limited airstrikes in Yemen, and the Houthis have launched missile and drone attacks inside Saudi Arabia, in addition to attacking Saudi ships in the Red Sea.

Inside Yemen, clashes between the Houthis and the Saudi-backed Yemeni government have escalated sharply in recent weeks.

The Houthis say that their attacks are preemptive, accusing the Saudi and Yemeni governments of amassing forces in preparation for a ground offensive against them.

Analysts say that there are now signs of a broader military buildup on both sides.

Ahmed Nagi, a senior analyst for Yemen at the International Crisis Group, said Saudi Arabia has improved military coordination between different anti-Houthi factions. It is also providing those forces with advanced weaponry, which “has never been the case in the past,” Nagi added.

Experts and diplomats fear that any escalation will increase the suffering of tens of millions of people in Yemen, which is already engulfed in one of the world’s worst humanitarian crises.

“No party controls where escalation leads,” the United Nations envoy to Yemen, Hans Grundberg, warned in a briefing to the UN Security Council on Aug. 13. “The only certainty is that the Yemeni people will pay the price.”

Trump administration to expand deportation flights to Haiti

By Hamed Aleaziz and Zolan Kanno-Youngs
NEW YORK TIMES

The Trump administration plans to step up deportation flights to Haiti as soon as this week, according to documents obtained by The New York Times, a move intended to more quickly expel thousands of Haitians whose legal status expired this summer with the end of a humanitarian program.

The administration aims to increase the pace of flights from once a month to once a week, the documents show, potentially allowing for the deportation of hundreds more people per month. The flights are expected to continue weekly in the near term, though a US official cautioned that the plans were still being finalized.

The push comes after the Supreme Court ruled in June that the administration was free to end Haiti’s Temporary Protected Status, a program that blocks the deportation of people from designated countries deemed too dangerous to return its citizens to. The Trump administration concluded that Haiti is safe enough to be removed from the protected list, despite widespread lawlessness and gang activity in the country.

The State Department has warned US travelers not to visit

Haiti “due to the risk of crime, kidnapping, terrorism, unrest and limited healthcare.” The Federal Aviation Administration banned commercial airlines from landing in the country’s capital, Port-au-Prince, earlier this year, citing “ongoing instability.” There have been reports of gangs firing on aircraft trying to land at the Port-au-Prince airport.

“There is not even a vestige of a state in control,” said Daniel Foote, the Biden administration’s special envoy to Haiti, who resigned in 2021 over the deportations of Haitian migrants. Foote, who remains in contact with people on the ground in Haiti, said the deportations would likely include many Haitian immigrants who have spent most of their lives in the United States and will now be sent to a dangerous environment.

“Not only has it not gotten better, it hasn’t stabilized,” Foote said. “It just continues to get worse and worse and worse.”

Foote questioned how the Trump administration assessed that Haiti was now safe enough for an increase of deportations. In fact, internal emails and documents obtained by the Times indicate that the Homeland Security Department decided to terminate the protections in June 2025 without obtaining input from the State Department,

After gang attack kills 47, a demand for answers

By Evens Sanon
ASSOCIATED PRESS

PORT-AU-PRINCE, Haiti — Haiti’s National Police faced mounting criticism Thursday over why authorities failed to prevent a recent gang attack in which 47 people were killed and more than 50 kidnapped.

Police spokesperson Garry Desrosiers took only a handful of questions from journalists at a news conference Thursday, just days after gangs attacked Kenscoff, a once-peaceful farming community nestled in the hills near Port-au-Prince.

Asked what police are planning to do about those kidnapped, Desrosiers said he could not answer that question publicly.

“We cannot talk about any

plans,” he said.

One gang leader has threatened to execute all the hostages if any gang members are killed as police work to secure Kenscoff.

Desrosiers expressed condolences to those affected by the violent attack on Sunday.

More than 2,600 people were displaced, according to the UN International Organization for Migration, and anger and frustration are mounting. Desrosiers said police are working on helping them return home, but he did not provide specifics.

One journalist questioned whether there was any intelligence gathered prior to the attack, with Desrosiers responding that authorities have been working on gathering intelli-



CLARENS SIFFROY/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

People reacted Monday following overnight violence in which 47 people were killed by gangs in Kenscoff, Haiti.

gence.

He added that police are aware that one gang leader is threatening to attack Tabarre, a neighborhood within Port-au-Prince where the US embassy is located.

Vladimir Paraison, head of Haiti’s National Police, was not present at the news conference. He recently defended security measures in Kenscoff and said that an investigation was underway to establish the truth about the attack “whether due to complicity or negligence.”

“The federal courts have ordered the Haitian illegals must leave the US and we have generously made free flights available,” said Lauren Bis, a White House spokesperson, who declined to provide specific details on deportation flights to Haiti.

Seeking safer ways to land aircraft than arriving at Port-au-Prince, US officials have flown migrants about 120 miles away to the city of Cap Haitien, which is where the new flights will land. Immigration and Customs Enforcement has been flying Haitians to the much smaller city once a month.

which typically is responsible for assessing the conditions in foreign countries.

Deporting hundreds more to Haiti will hasten deportations, but it will still take time to reach the more than 300,000 Haitians who had been allowed to legally live and work in the United

States under the expired protected status. The administration will most likely need to further increase the pace to expel every Haitian now in the country illegally. The administration has offered people in the country illegally a plane ticket and \$2,600 in cash to self-deport using an app.

White House construction cited in report on near collision

WASHINGTON — Construction at the White House may have contributed to an incident this month in which the president’s helicopter

came dangerously close to a commercial jet over Washington, according to a new report from the National Transportation Safety Board.

According to the report, work to build a new ballroom at the White House forced officials to move the helicopter’s takeoff location temporarily from the South Lawn to the Ellipse, the park south of the White House. But the new location may have been less optimal for communicating with air traffic controllers, leading to communication glitches, the report said.

Technicians “conducted a coverage analysis and determined that there was not adequate line-of-sight to ensure communications” between the Ellipse and the tower “while construction was ongoing at the White House,” the board’s report reads.

The report chronicled how garbled communications caused the airport controller to miss multiple warnings from the helicopter crew that they were minutes from takeoff — a notification that would have signaled to the controller to temporarily ground planes while the helicopter passed through the area. Instead, the controller allowed an Envoy Air jet bound for Pensacola, Fla., to depart from an airport runway just as Marine One was about to take off, resulting in the plane and the helicopter passing each other less than one mile apart.

The board’s findings are pre-

liminary, and its investigation of the incident is ongoing.

Representatives for the White House did not address questions about the role that the White House ballroom construction may have played in the incident.

Under current procedures, controllers are expected to keep the congested skies around National Airport clear of traffic when the president’s helicopter is traversing the area.

In the wake of the Aug. 4 incident, Sean Duffy, the transportation secretary, said the president was never in any danger because the two aircraft’s flight paths would not have converged. He blamed the incident on faulty telecom issues, and earlier this week, Bryan Bedford, who leads the Federal Aviation Administration, said his agency had made changes to communication procedures and relocated an air traffic antenna to help fix the problems.

NEW YORK TIMES

Stars and Stripes staffers file lawsuit over firings

WASHINGTON — Three staff members from the Stars and Stripes military news outlet are suing to challenge their recent firings by the Pentagon, accusing the Trump administration of violating their First Amendment free speech rights to speak out against government interference in their work.

Stars and Stripes publisher Max Lederer, editor-in-chief Erik Slavin, and Middle East reporter Lara Korte are named as plaintiffs in the federal lawsuit filed Thursday in Washington.

The Pentagon, which partially funds the news outlet, fired them last week. A Pentagon



JIM WATSON/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

LAST WORD — An aide adjusted a necklace as White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt prepared to speak on Fox News Thursday, her final day as press secretary, outside the White House.

spokesperson declined to comment on the suit’s allegations.

Slavin says he was dismissed for insubordination after giving an interview to CBS News in which he objected to potential censorship by the US military. Korte participated in the same interview. Their lawsuit says they were punished in retaliation for publishing a report on deteriorating conditions aboard the USS Abraham Lincoln.

“Stripes’ historical editorial independence is critical to its core mission of gathering and providing unbiased, credible journalism to the US military community, particularly service-members and their families stationed overseas,” the suit says.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Senator seeks details on Israel’s actions in West Bank

WASHINGTON — Senator Chris Van Hollen, Democrat of

Maryland, was planning to introduce a resolution that would order the Trump administration to provide Congress with a detailed accounting of Israel’s human rights practices in the West Bank, laying the groundwork to force a vote on the matter in coming weeks.

The measure, the latest bid by Democrats in Congress to challenge the policies and actions of Israel’s government, invokes a provision of the Foreign Assistance Act that allows lawmakers to request information from the State Department about the human rights record of any country receiving US security assistance.

Cosigned by 10 Senate Democrats, the resolution is privileged, meaning that Van Hollen could force a vote on it even if Republican leaders refuse, as expected, to bring it to the floor. That could lead to yet another

vote in Congress showcasing Democrats’ divide over Israel as a growing contingent in the party turns against the Jewish state.

“We’ve seen ongoing human rights violations on the West Bank, but we’re going from bad to abysmal,” Van Hollen said in an interview.

The resolution focuses on at least nine US citizens who have been killed in the West Bank since January 2022, including Shireen Abu Akleh, a Palestinian American journalist killed in 2022, and Aysenur Ezgi Eygi, who was fatally shot by an Israeli soldier in 2024. It argues that Israeli authorities have failed to punish those responsible and that US agencies have failed to conduct their own independent investigations or provide substantive information about existing ones.

“If the United States Senate shines a spotlight on this, we will save lives,” Van Hollen said. “We will save the lives of American citizens. We will also save the lives of Palestinian civilians.”

The issue has prompted unusually sharp criticism from Israeli officials. Yechiel Leiter, Israel’s ambassador to the United States and a longtime settler, said earlier this year that extremist settler violence was a “stain” on Israel and was costing the country support in Washington. He said the Israeli government was taking this seriously.

NEW YORK TIMES

ICE signs \$16.7m contract for shock gloves

US Immigration and Customs Enforcement has awarded a \$16.7 million contract to purchase 6,000 pairs of gloves that

can deliver painful electric shocks, saying officers would use them to control detainees and protesters who resist.

ICE moved forward with the purchase despite opposition from civil rights advocates and Democratic members of Congress, who said ICE officers cannot be trusted to use them appropriately.

A notice published in a federal database Thursday said ICE entered into a no-bid contract to purchase the gloves from Compliant Technologies LLC, a Kentucky-based firm that manufactures them. The deal includes acquiring 6,000 of the devices along with support equipment and services over the next six months.

Civil rights advocates have said ICE officers already face criticism for their use of force with little oversight or accountability while enforcing President Trump’s immigration crackdown.

ICE published the notice hours after a group of US senators, led by Democrat Catherine Cortez Masto of Nevada, urged the agency to cancel its plan to buy the gloves. In a letter to ICE’s acting director Thursday, Cortez Masto and 15 of her colleagues in the Democratic caucus questioned ICE’s need for the devices.

“The blatant and tragic misuse of force in Los Angeles, Chicago, Minneapolis, Houston, Maine, and other locations around the country raises significant skepticism about the agency’s professional capability to safely deploy a new tool that could be used to harm Americans without cause,” the letter said.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Moulton’s presidential run offers insights into current race

► MOULTON

Continued from Page A1

ate bid, none more so than his emphasis on “generational change” in the ranks of the country’s leadership. But stark differences separate the Moulton of 2019 from the Moulton of 2026, reflecting changing political climates — as well as Moulton’s shifting ambitions.

Seven years ago, Moulton explicitly ran as a moderate counterweight to high-profile progressives, like Senators Bernie Sanders and Elizabeth Warren, who he worried would push the party too far left and risk handing President Trump a second term. He openly sparred with them over their support for an annual wealth tax on multimillionaires and their framing of the Green New Deal.

Now, Moulton is recasting himself as a reliable, true-blue progressive for the next generation. He is embracing some ideas he rejected as a presidential candidate, like the Warren-style wealth tax, which he has held up as a way to pay for his sweeping, progressive-style “affordability” agenda. (Moulton previously supported other measures to close tax loopholes benefiting the rich, and has claimed his issue with Warren and others was how they talked about the issue, not what they proposed.)

In an election year when Democratic primary voters nationwide are gravitating to combative progressives, Moulton’s repositioning might be seen by critics as simply cold calculation. Whether Massachusetts voters buy it remains unclear, but the fact that he has picked up momentum in the race indicates that he may have learned lessons from the biggest campaign he never talks about.

In an interview with the Globe, Moulton said that after the 2020 campaign ended, he and his advisers put together an “after-action review” to assess what worked and didn’t. The biggest takeaway, he said, is that he entered the race too late.

But afterward, Moulton said, he quickly moved on. “I’m not someone who spends a ton of time Monday morning quarterbacking,” he said.

Others see Moulton’s most consistent focus as the clearest sign that he didn’t learn much at all from the 2020 campaign.

“He always argues ‘generational change,’” said longtime Massachusetts Democratic strategist Mary Anne Marsh.



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Representative Seth Moulton campaigned in Manchester, N.H., in 2019. He was in the presidential race for four months.

Moulton made that argument in his 2014 victory over former representative John Tierney and in his push to oust Nancy Pelosi as Democratic leader. That’s why he ran for president in 2020 and for the Senate now.

But those calls are only successful if paired with a strong, broader message, Marsh said, and argued that this has been a missing ingredient for Moulton.

“If he doesn’t win this Senate seat, that is the common denominator,” said Marsh.

Moulton’s allies acknowledge he doesn’t talk about the 2020 campaign much, but not because it wasn’t a valuable experience for him.

“I think he saw he could have a broad platform beyond his own district,” said Marie Harf, who was Moulton’s deputy presidential campaign manager.

Harf also mentioned Moulton’s decision to speak openly on the 2020 campaign trail about having post-traumatic stress disorder from his military service—which, she says, spurred him to push successfully for legislation to create the 988 national suicide and mental health crisis hot line. “That was a direct line from the presidential campaign to today,” she said.

Another common thread in Moulton’s career is a high appetite for risk. But if he began his 2014 and 2026 campaigns as an underdog, he entered the presidential race as something worse: an afterthought.

Moulton began testing the waters of a presidential bid with visits to early primary states in February 2019 but remained coy about his ultimate plans, even as candidates with larger profiles

had already entered the primary.

After finally stating he was “exploring” a bid, Moulton began to attract some real hype — and from unexpected corners. Hugh Hewitt, the conservative pundit, called Moulton “the perfect challenger” to Donald Trump and compared him favorably to Robert F. Kennedy.

In April, Moulton officially launched his presidential campaign, becoming the 20th Democratic candidate in the race.

With other notable Democrats competing for progressive primary votes, Moulton positioned himself as a pragmatic moderate with the military background and national security chops to build a coalition to beat Trump. “There’s a feeling

that there’s a hole in this race,” Moulton told McClatchy soon after his launch. “That we aren’t talking enough about how we’re going to make the country strong and secure.”

On paper, he wasn’t wrong. But by waiting so long to get into the race, he allowed another contender with a Harvard degree, military service, and center-left politics to catch fire: then-South Bend, Ind., mayor Pete Buttigieg. Then, just three days after Moulton’s announcement, his news cycle was overshadowed by Joe Biden’s long-expected campaign launch.

“Moulton’s theory of the case was not totally crazy,” said Jesse Leich, who was Hillary Clinton’s 2016 spokesperson on foreign policy and now hosts a podcast on the emerging 2028 primary. “But the combination of it being a crowded field, having no name ID, Buttigieg becoming a darling, left him with very little room to operate.”

Another problem: Moulton’s unsuccessful push to remove Pelosi as House Democrats’ leader soured his reputation in the party base. When he landed an interview on Rachel Maddow’s influential show, his precious introduction to millions of primary voters was clouded by the host admitting she had weath-

ered significant backlash from viewers simply for inviting him.

By summer, Moulton failed to qualify for any of the televised debates, which required candidates to meet polling and fundraising benchmarks. In New Hampshire, where he had campaigned most aggressively, he was polling at exactly zero percent in July 2019.

On Aug. 23, 2019, Moulton ended his campaign. In exit interviews, he quickly pivoted to warning against a progressive candidate. “I’ve always said that veering too far left could result in us losing this election, and that Trump will be harder to beat than most people think,” Moulton told The New York Times.

In December, just before Democrats began casting votes, that concern prompted Moulton to make the decision that is arguably most at odds with his current Senate bid: endorsing Biden for president. The former vice president was already drawing concern about his advanced age and health, even as he was seen as the candidate best positioned to defeat Trump.

Asked how the Biden endorsement squares with his emphasis on generational change, Moulton called it a “fair question” but stressed that “the most

important factor I weighed” in his endorsement was who could win. (Later, in July 2024, Moulton was one of the first House Democrats to call for Biden to abandon his campaign.)

Even if his short-lived 2020 bid helped him grow, it didn’t raise his political stock in a lasting way, argued Leich. And combined with his past campaigns and attention-getting pushes for new leadership, it may have helped solidify negative perceptions about him.

“If you’re a young talented politician with a bunch of upside and the world in front of you,” he said, “you can create an image for yourself as a desperate political climber.”

Moulton, for his part, has no regrets — and dismissed a question about whether the 2020 run was humbling at all after his early political success. “Nothing is more humbling than watching people die in Iraq,” said the former Marine captain.

“Like, did it hurt my ego or something?” he asked. “This is not about me and my ego; this is about, ‘How can I best serve the country?’ and it’s always been that.”

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GREG DERR/THE PATRIOT LEDGER/POOL

Defense attorney Kevin Reddington made his closing arguments Thursday. He repeatedly attacked the credibility of the prosecution’s expert witnesses.

As jurors get Clancy case, outcome still uncertain

►CLANCY
Continued from Page A1

cution did a masterful job of giving them that.”

Prosecutors allege Clancy, 36, carefully planned the killings because she wanted to kill herself and didn’t trust anyone else to care for her children.

Clancy has admitted to killing Cora, 5, Dawson, 3, and Callan, 8 months, by strangling them with exercise bands in the basement of their Duxbury home in January 2023. She then slit her neck and wrists and jumped out a second-story window.

While the facts of the killings alone could bolster the prosecution’s case, legal analysts said the defense has successfully portrayed Clancy as a loving, devoted mother who began experiencing serious mental health issues after giving birth to her third child.

Before both sides delivered closing arguments Thursday morning, the judge instructed jurors on the applicable law and range of verdicts before them: first-degree murder, second-degree murder, or manslaughter. The question is whether Clancy should be held criminally responsible for her actions, which requires jurors to consider the legal definition of insanity under Massachusetts law.

First, they must decide whether Clancy was suffering from a “mental disease or defect” at the time of the killings.

But that alone is not enough to establish a lack of criminal responsibility. If the jury does find Clancy was seriously mentally ill, then there are two additional queries before it: Did her mental illness render Clancy unable to appreciate the wrongfulness of her actions in that moment? Or was she unable to conform her actions to the law?

For example, if someone is delusional, they might be complying with voices in their head rather than acting of their own volition, a claim Clancy’s attorney has raised.

As in other criminal cases, the burden of proof falls on the prosecution. Here, prosecutors must prove beyond a reasonable doubt that Clancy should be held criminally responsible.

Indeed, Plymouth Assistant District Attorney Jennifer Sprague began her closing argument by acknowledging Clancy’s mental health struggles.

“There’s no dispute that Lindsay Clancy was suffering from mental illness and that she tried to kill herself,” Sprague told the jury. “That’s not the issue in this trial.”

Nor is the case about “our mental health system or how it treats women,” she continued, but rather about “what Lindsay Clancy did the night of Jan. 24, 2023, and what her mental state was at the time.”

Sprague argued Clancy mismanaged her psychiatric treatment in search of a quick fix, all the while “controlling her behavior” and hiding certain symptoms. Finding her efforts unsuccessful, Sprague said, Clancy gave up. She became suicidal and planned the murders, according to prosecutors.

Defense attorney Kevin Reddington presented a contrasting theory.

During his closing argument, he gestured toward Clancy, paralyzed from her suicide attempt and seated in her wheelchair at the defense table, clutching a crumpled tissue.

“This is a prosecution that has ripped the soul out of this girl,” Reddington said.

He held up two photos: one showing Clancy smiling with her husband and children, another showing her in a hospital bed after she tried to kill herself. Her mental health started declining around the time she was planning to return to work as a labor and delivery nurse in fall 2022, according to trial testimony.

How could prosecutors seriously argue “that this woman was acting in her right mind when these children were killed,” Reddington said.

He accused them of manipulating the evidence to vilify Clancy in whatever ways they could think of — by suggesting she “faked” her suicide attempt, that she was “doctor shopping” when she sought treatment, that she lied about experiencing “command hallucinations.”

“Watch the manipulation,” he said.

After six alternates were chosen, the jury now consists of nine women and three men. They began deliberating Thursday afternoon and will resume Friday morning.

A first-degree murder conviction, which carries a mandatory life without parole sentence, would mean jurors rejected the entirety of the defense’s case. Second-degree would mean they found Clancy was culpable, but the killings weren’t premeditated; it carries a life sentence with the possibility of parole. And manslaughter would indicate a determination that Clancy should be held responsible for the deaths because her actions were “wanton or reckless.”

A hung jury is also a real possibility in a case this complex and polarizing, analysts said.

There’s also a lot of evidence to consider. Jurors heard from 84 witnesses over 21 days of testimony, including Clancy’s family members and former colleagues, several of her psychiatric providers, and a variety of experts who testified for both sides.

Reddington repeatedly attacked the credibility of the prosecution’s experts by highlighting their lack of experience treating postpartum patients and people in psychosis, a point he reiterated during his closing argument. Those experts included two psychiatrists and one psychologist who testified that they had evaluated Clancy and concluded she should be held criminally responsible for killing her children.

They also defined the postpartum period as up to four weeks after birth; other experts

rejected that timeframe, saying it lasts a year or more.

“You have these men coming in here that don’t even know psychosis from schizophrenia,” Reddington said. Legal analysts interviewed by the Globe agreed their qualifications were lacking.

In contrast, the defense called Dr. Phillip Resnick, a forensic psychiatrist with expertise in postpartum conditions who’s testified in other high-profile murder and insanity cases. He said Clancy was experiencing “command hallucinations” and a “delusion of influence,” the sense of losing control of your body.

“It was almost like she was a puppet and someone else was pulling the strings,” he said. For that and other reasons, she should not be held criminally responsible, Resnick testified last week.

“Of all of the experts, I thought Resnick was in a class of his own,” said local attorney Keith Halpern, who has represented a number of mentally ill defendants charged with murder.

“I think juries pay very close attention to the experts in these cases,” he added.

That’s especially important because a significant amount of testimony focused on whether Clancy was lying about following the commands of a voice in her head.

“The voice doesn’t make sense,” Sprague said in her closing argument, adding that Clancy had never reported hearing it before or since.

Rather than acting “against her will . . . like a puppet,” Clancy methodically planned the killings, Sprague told the jury. She sent her then-husband, Patrick Clancy, to pick up medicine for their daughter and takeout for dinner, calculating the exact amount of time she would have alone with the children, Sprague said, and she “started killing the kids immediately after” he left.

Despite being preoccupied with the murders, she sounded

normal during a brief phone conversation with Patrick Clancy, who called to ask about which medicine to buy from CVS, according to prosecutors. “Because she didn’t want him coming home — because she needed to finish her plan. She still had to kill herself,” Sprague said.

She argued that Lindsay Clancy killed her children because the thought of leaving them behind was preventing her from taking her own life: “It was what she had to do to end her misery.”

But Janice Bassil, a Massachusetts defense attorney whose expertise includes insanity cases, said the motive suggested by Sprague “just made no sense,” which could leave the jury thinking psychosis is the only plausible explanation.

There are plenty of other factors that could influence jurors as well, including their perceptions of Clancy in the courtroom, personal biases, gender stereotypes, and more, said Jessica Salerno, an associate professor of psychology at Cornell University who studies jury decision making.

“Lindsay Clancy’s status as both a woman and a mother could cut both ways with jurors,” she said.

They may judge her more harshly because she violated expectations mothers should be nurturing and protective, Salerno said. Alternatively, they “may have difficulty imagining a mother killing her children unless she was severely mentally ill.”

She said their emotions could also play a role, despite Judge William Sullivan’s clear instruction Thursday that they must set aside bias and decide the case based solely on the evidence.

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Updated COVID vaccines get OK

By Maggie Astor
NEW YORK TIMES

The Food and Drug Administration approved updated COVID vaccines on Thursday, clearing the way for manufacturers to ship doses to pharmacies and doctors’ offices.

Moderna and Pfizer, which make the most commonly used COVID vaccines, are expected to begin shipping soon; Pfizer said it would do so “immediately,” and Moderna has done so within days of approval in past years. Sanofi, which distributes a non-mRNA option called Nuvaxovid, said doses would be available in September.

However, criteria set by the FDA and a legal dispute stemming from past Trump administration actions could complicate access for some people.

As was the case last year, the FDA approved the shots for all people 65 and older, as well as for younger people who have a condition that increases their risk of severe illness from COVID. The Moderna shot is approved for ages 6 months and older; the Pfizer shot for ages 5 years and older; and the Sanofi shot for ages 12 years and older.

About 30 percent to 60 percent of Americans have a qualifying condition, FDA officials estimated last year. Aside from age, a long list of factors can increase the risk of severe illness. They include asthma, diabetes, obesity, physical inactivity, and pregnancy, as well as cancer, immune deficiency, some mental illnesses, and various heart and lung diseases.

People who are not formally eligible may still be able to get vaccinated. Doctors can administer vaccines off label, meaning outside FDA approval criteria.

But there may be logistical hurdles: Because most Americans who get COVID shots do so at pharmacies, not all doctors’ offices stock the vaccine. And pharmacists in some states may be unable, or may decline, to administer shots off label.

Last year, after significant initial confusion, Walgreens and CVS — two of the nation’s largest pharmacy chains — allowed people to self-attest that they met the criteria, without requiring medical documentation. The companies did not immediately respond to requests to confirm what their policies would be this year.

Normally, the CDC’s vaccine panel would recommend the new shots either for everyone or for specific groups. But the panel is in legal limbo after a federal court ruling in March that temporarily invalidated the appointments of members chosen by Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.

The state-by-state landscape will become clearer in the coming days.

Suspected thief of vintage sailboat in N.J. is fatally shot in R.I.

►BOAT
Continued from Page A1

bow of the boat resembling Pathfinder ignored commands as police officers and members of the harbormaster’s office pulled up alongside the vessel.

The man, Brendan Norris, 27, of Newport, fled below deck, “armed himself with a firearm,” and exchanged gunfire with authorities, before he was fatally shot, while a Newport police office was shot, officials said. At a City Council meeting Wednesday night, the officer was identified as Jack Billings.

Thomas Shevlin, a Newport city spokesperson, confirmed on Thursday that Norris was “a suspect” in the theft of the boat. When asked if there were other suspects, Shevlin said that is still under investigation, but Norris was alone on the vessel when it was found.

The officer was released from the hospital later on Wednesday and is recovering at home, police said.

Court records show Norris was arrested in Newport on July 16 on misdemeanor charges of simple assault and/or battery

and disorderly conduct. Additional details were not immediately available Thursday.

He was arraigned in Newport County District Court and pleaded not guilty, posted a \$2,000 surety bond, and was scheduled for a pretrial conference on Sept. 2.

Norris appeared to have been an experienced sailor: In a post on Crewbay.com, an online platform that connects boat owners with prospective crew members, a man who identified himself as Brendan Norris wrote that he worked as both a boat captain in Newport and as an engineer on a luxury power boat, and had extensive marine qualifications as well as experience sailing. (Shevlin said police believe the online profile belonged to the same Norris who died during Wednesday’s shooting.)

In seeking a crew position on a yacht, Norris wrote he had “been on boats my whole life and know my way around one very well.” He described himself as “easy going, drama free, and fun to be around.”

On Wednesday, Newport Po-

lice Chief Ryan Duffy declined to say whether Norris was shot by law enforcement or died by a self-inflicted gunshot. Police are following officer-involved shooting protocols from the Rhode Island attorney general’s office, which is also involved in the investigation alongside State Police, Duffy said.

Bonomo said the shooting was “pretty shocking.”

“My heart goes out to the cop who got shot,” Bonomo said, adding that he was grateful for the law enforcement agencies that pitched in between the two states.

Bonomo did not know Norris, he said.

“I feel bad about this kid who stole it, too,” he added. “I mean, I don’t know why you would do that. It’s a tragic end for just stealing a boat.”

Surveillance video footage from 9:15 p.m. on Saturday shows a man hopping a fence at the Liberty Harbor Marina before he begins to bring provisions aboard the boat, according to Bonomo. The boat left the dock sometime around 11 p.m., he said.



JAMES BONOMO

James Bonomo said that he and his family have owned Pathfinder for 10 years and that it’s “like a family heirloom.”

“The guy definitely knew about boats, and he knew what he was stealing because there’s no way you can operate that boat unless you know something about a classic boat,” Bonomo said. “It’s not just like a new boat where you get on and turn the key. I mean, there’s battery switches, there’s configurations of how you got to get the fuel turned on, and he basically navigated all that without too much problem.”

Bonomo also said the boat was stolen during an ebb tide,

meaning the current in New York Harbor was running seaward, and also when there was a window of clear weather late that night.

Authorities were able to track the boat on cameras around the harbor as it traveled under the Verrazano Bridge before losing sight of it, as its tracking system had been shut off, Bonomo said.

The boat likely would have traveled east, along the south shore of Long Island, before turning north toward New Eng-

land, according to Bonomo.

“It’s not a fast boat, but it’ll get you there,” he said.

For 10 years, Bonomo and his family have owned the vessel, which he described as being “like a family heirloom.” His son, now 20, grew up on it, and the couple has sailed “with hundreds of people” around New York Harbor, he said, adding, “It’s just become part of our life.”

“It’s just like a collector’s item,” said Bonomo, a regional fleet captain in the Bermuda 40 Association, an organization of boat owners dedicated to the heritage of the Hinckley Bermuda 40 sailboat.

“There’s a saying that says, a B40, you don’t ever really own it, you’re just kind of taking care of it for the next person,” he said.

Bonomo said Pathfinder is currently docked in Newport, and he is awaiting word from authorities about what happens to the boat next.

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Not just a job, a crowning moment

►CINDERELLA
Continued from Page A1

carefully choreographed. She walks with her hands crossed in front of her, her steps buoyant and deliberate. But it is her voice that marks the biggest transformation. She raises it several octaves, creating an iridescent, sing-song princess voice — think a little kinder than a hostess at a restaurant.

The pumpkin carriage takes the princess and a handful of lucky guests a short ride up to her castle, where she greets her fans and heads inside. The castle is a single room, with a throne at the far end. Children line up behind velvet ropes to meet Cinderella and snap a picture. Her perpetually pearly smile is the first thing you see when you enter.

From about 10 a.m. to 4 p.m., like a true monarch, she sits greeting her royal subjects in one long, improvised act.

Her performance is ever-changing as the children throw her various curveballs. And when they see Tisdale from across the way, they stop in their tracks as if witnessing a biblical miracle.

In general, there are two types of Cinderella interactions: there are the young girls who arrive in matching dresses and run through the velvet ropes to embrace Cinderella, and the children who shyly meander toward the throne, heads down as their parents nudge them forward for a picture.

“Whatever energy they’re giving me, you have to match it,” Tisdale said. “If a kid’s running up at you, I’m running back to them. If they’re really quiet, I’m gonna walk really slowly. I’ll try to make them smile or compliment them to make them feel comfortable.”

In some cases, the children will recite Cinderella facts about their day — from the rides they went on to the toys they brought — as if they were old friends catching up.

“A lot of kids ask, ‘Are you the real Cinderella?’ And of course, you have to say yes. But something I always like to add is, ‘I’m just as real as you are,’” she said.

More often than not, the interaction ends with a hug, and it’s not like any other. Even the shyest children earnestly embrace her, momentarily forgetting their hesitation and surrendering to the fantasy.

This is Cinderella’s day: a seven-hour improv session without respite. But the role is essential training for Tisdale’s wider career aspirations.

Back in her changing room, she opens up about those.

She was a musical theater major at the University of Miami. She barely had time to



hang up her graduation gown before she received the call that she had gotten the job at Story Land. She booked it to New Hampshire; soon she hopes to move to New York City to pursue a different stage.

“I really want to be a professional performer. The goal for me is to work on Broadway,” she said.

And what better place to prepare than at an all-day acting bootcamp where she’s at the mercy of New England’s youngest and most honest critics?

In another magical kingdom not that far, far away, Becca Collins gets ready for her turn at playing Cinderella.

She is preparing for “Cinderella’s Topsy Turvy Show,” a live, interactive experience where children celebrate Cinderella’s birthday alongside the Mad Hatter, played by Brett Holland.

Collins’s Cinderella presents a different kind of regal behavior. She is poised and a little Type A at her birthday party, but she also levitates as she dances around the room with an air of sophistication. This Cinderella gets to sing, too, and the children are enchanted by her voice.

There is enough material in the show to entertain both children and adults. In one memorable moment, Cinderella is choosing the color of her birthday cake. When she picks orange — the color worn by the New York Knicks basketball team — she breaks character just long enough to shout “Go Knicks!”

Indeed, adults seem to have just as much fun with the performance as the children do. One grandmother arrived dressed in a full Cinderella cape and carrying a magic wand, threatening to turn any misbehaving children into mice.



“It’s about magic, power, transcendence, and resilience,” said Kathy Green, who brought her 4-year-old niece to meet Cinderella.

For Collins, the role is also an opportunity to flex her musical-theater muscles. She dances, prances, and blows bubbles, encouraging the children to get up and join her. After the party, she poses outside with the Mad Hatter for a photo op, while the children press Cinderella with their burning questions, including “Where is Prince Charming?”

Collins has similar aspirations to Tisdale. She started her life in musical theater at the age of 4 in Bridgewater. She studied it for years before moving to New York City to pursue her Broadway dreams and, apparently, become a Knicks fan.

The opportunity is especially meaningful to Collins, a New Englander who grew up visiting Story Land and its various Cinderellas.

“When I meet someone, whether it’s an adult or a child, that totally brings me back to why I’m doing this,” Collins said.



“You can really impact someone’s day by doing this. Even though it seems silly, you really can affect these kids’ days and their whole summer.”

Collins shared the story of 10-year-old Gabby.

Gabby comes to Story Land every Sunday, and her parents pay extra for her to have dinner with the princesses as part of an exclusive experience.

At first, the actors wondered why Gabby kept coming back. But after spending time with her and her parents, they

Clockwise from above: Becca Collins greeted passengers aboard the pumpkin coach; Jordan Tisdale slipped on a shoe, then hopped in the coach; Collins was in place for a happy visitor.



learned she is mostly nonverbal, except that when she’s around Cinderella, Peter Pan, and the other characters of Story Land, she starts to talk.

At the end of the day, Cinderella gathers all of her friends for a special musical sendoff.

The song? “Abracadabra.” Yes, the one by Lady Gaga. As the Mad Hatter, Red Riding Hood, and Alice in Wonderland (played by Collins) begin performing, Tisdale stands behind a gate a short distance away, preparing for her grand fi-

nale.

When she steps out, the kids erupt with glee as she takes center stage and sings the Gaga song, complete with a few notable lyric changes.

“Hold me in your heart tonight,” she belts out.

It’s a tune so irresistibly catchy that even the Old Lady Who Lives in a Shoe — yes, there is a lady in a shoe at Story Land — is dancing along to the beat.

And tomorrow, they’ll do it all again.

Story Land’s Cinderellas have been known to be spotted outside of work, unwinding over a beer at a local bar in full make-up. They say plenty of children recognize them but seem to take little issue with seeing their favorite characters off the clock.

They’ll likely also see them again, years later, looking back at family photos — Tisdale’s or Collins’s bright faces beaming next to their younger selves — a small piece of childhood magic preserved in time.

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MassHousing says executive repeatedly lied about conflict

►HOUSING
Continued from Page A1

were supposed to be completing with the public’s money.

After reviewing several years’ worth of emails and interviewing several of Richards’s subordinates, the Mintz team concluded Richards was “untruthful” about the extent of his relationship with the two developers, Gary Acquah and Reggie Woods, who received \$1.4 million in grant money from Richards’s department.

The two sold Richards a West Roxbury home in December 2022 for \$204,000 less than the original listing price. Months later, in early 2023, Richards approved the grants, which were supposed to cover renovations to four apartment buildings in Pittsfield and Worcester.

The Mintz report concludes there is no evidence Richards used his position to secure a discount on the house. It also says there is no evidence the grants awards were improperly influenced by Richards, though he and his boss, MassHousing chief executive Chrystal Kornegay, had the final sign-off.

Acquah and Woods left a trail of shoddy and incomplete repairs at their properties. According to the Mintz report, in October 2024, the state’s Office of Inspector General began seeking records related to the awards a few months after MassHousing had taken notice of the poor work.

That investigation had not been previously reported. A spokesperson for the inspector general said Thursday that she could not confirm or deny the existence of an investigation.

At the time, MassHousing’s top lawyer, Colin McNiece, immediately alerted Richards about the state investigation, according to the Mintz report. Four weeks later, Richards told McNiece and Kornegay that after after reviewing his paperwork he realized the developers were the same pair who had sold him his home.

Richards’s claim of a sudden discovery was contradicted by one employee who told Mintz’s investigators that Richards had told her around the time of the 2022 sale he was aware the home sellers also did business with MassHousing.

MassHousing’s board held a special meeting Thursday to discuss the inquiry. Shortly after, the agency published the report on its website. MassHousing chair Jeanne Pinado said in a statement the report details “failures of ethical disclosure and a disheartening lack of candor by a former employee toward Agency leadership.”

“The review also identified weaknesses in MassHousing’s administration and oversight of the Gateway program,” Pinado said. “MassHousing takes responsibility for those shortcomings and welcomes all recommendations for strengthening program controls and oversight.”

The Mintz report also confirmed fraudulent invoicing in the grant program that was first brought to light by the Globe in June.

Acquah and Woods submitted fake invoices to trigger payments for work that was either done poorly or not at all. But in interviews with the Globe, at least nine subcontractors denied doing work attributed to them, for which Acquah and

Woods collected reimbursement. Two more said invoices the developers attributed to them were inaccurate.

Several of those contractors also confirmed the inaccuracies with the Mintz investigators.

As the Globe investigated Richards’s conflict of interest, MassHousing officials initially defended him. They urged the Globe to drop a public records request for his emails from the time of the home sale, saying it would be overly burdensome to collect and review them.

McNiece, the agency’s top lawyer, earlier told the Globe then that Richards had come clean about his conflict as soon as he became aware of it.

However, the emails the Globe sought and obtained showed Richards corresponding warmly with Acquah and Woods about real-estate financing opportunities through MassHousing around the time of the home purchase.

The emails led MassHousing’s leaders to change their posture. Days before publication of the Globe’s first story, McNiece told reporters the agency would be launching an

internal audit of programs under Richards’s purview.

Mintz’s email review found communications between Richards and Woods as far back as 2019, when Richards was serving as a top aide to then-governor Charlie Baker. Investigators wrote that the professional relationship between Richards and the two developers began as early as 2021, and deepened in 2022 and 2023. Richards began working at MassHousing in September 2021.

Three weeks after the Globe report was published, Richards, who earned about \$255,000 annually, voluntarily resigned. He and his attorney have not responded to multiple requests for comment since June.

The Mintz report outlines discrepancies in what Richards told Kornegay and McNiece, two of the top leaders at the agency.

In August, Spotlight detailed a second instance of apparent fraud in a separate grant program under Richards’s oversight. The grants funded the installation of fire sprinkler systems in sober homes across the state.

In that case, MassHousing officials had directed sober home operator Hunter Foote to return more than \$400,000 that officials said he improperly billed for even though the work was incomplete. In addition to sending Foote demand letters, they referred the matter to Attorney General Andrea Campbell.

Mintz did not examine the fire sprinkler program in its inquiry.

Campbell’s office confirmed it is investigating both programs. None of the disputed money has been returned, and Foote denies he did anything wrong.

Critics, including state Auditor Diana DiZoglio, note Mintz has close ties to MassHousing, having served as the agency’s bond counsel for more than 30 years. McNiece, the agency’s top lawyer, worked at Mintz for 11 years before joining MassHousing.

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INBOX

Senate primary stirs health care debate

Moulton’s universal plan with private option is the better approach

Re “Health care debate is more than semantics: Senate candidates differ over extending coverage” (Page A1, Aug. 23): I recently entered my ninth decade. I have been on Medicare for decades, plus a managed health care plan and third-party supplemental health and prescription drug insurance plans. I am also the wife of a retired primary care physician who worked 100 hours a week when paperwork was added in and who was clearly burned out.

I can affirm what Samantha J. Gross writes in her article about the “somewhat similar script” from which Senator Ed Markey and Representative Seth Moulton are reading in the Democratic Senate primary: “Health care, as currently constructed, isn’t working.”

The Markey-Moulton debate raises issues as to which proposed option would expand access and work better — Markey’s “Medicare for All” single-payer system or Moulton’s multi-payer “universal health care,” which would offer public insurance to people who want it while keeping private plans available.

From what I’ve seen, the clear winner is Moulton’s plan. Under Medicare, as Moulton asserts, if consumers encounter arbitrary, politically influenced, or unreasonable actions, they are simply out of luck; federal plans preempt more supportive state regulations. The experience of people participating in similar approaches in Canada and Britain shows that citizens are highly dissatisfied, with 91 percent of Canadians surveyed wanting change and public satisfaction in Britain at record lows.

Much more successful health care plans that are closer to Moulton’s proposal exist in Germany and the Netherlands, where universal public access is balanced with private-sector flexibility. The real-life experience is out there, and the winner is not Medicare for All.

LOIS KARFUNKEL
Plymouth

Current system is crushing us — Markey’s Medicare for All is solution

The editorial board cites Representative Seth Moulton’s position on health care as one of its reasons for endorsing him against Senator Ed Markey in the Democratic Senate primary, mentioning a public option as a “first step toward the progressive goal of Medicare for All.”

But Markey, who was a lead fighter in Congress during the Steward Health Care crisis, continues to push for Medicare for All, not just another “first step.” Moderation on this issue is not a virtue when the “moderate” position has left families and working people rationing medicine or avoiding the doctor and crushed under rising health care premiums, deductibles, and prescription costs.

This is a question of priorities. Markey has long backed Medicare for All and has not wavered in that effort. Democratic voters should demand that kind of leadership.

REAGAN SUTHERLAND
Mission Hill



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Supporters of Ed Markey and Seth Moulton held signs before a debate at WCVB in Needham on Aug. 20.

Take it from an unenrolled Bush family member: Moulton’s a breath of fresh air

Like many Americans, I am desperate for elected leadership with vision, courage, and energy to listen to and serve their whole constituencies and break out of the bondage that has officials walking in lockstep with party leadership. Thank you to the Globe for endorsing Representative Seth Moulton, a loyal Democrat who is willing to be an outsider in his own party (“Seth Moulton for Senate,” Editorial, Aug. 19).

While I loathe the fact that I’ve become an unenrolled voter, I’m glad it allows me to vote for Moulton in the Democratic primary. I disagree with several of his positions but I value his courage to speak his mind and I agree with the general direction of his leadership.

A registered Republican for 40 years and virtually a genetic one — George W. Bush is my cousin — I exited the party when its state leadership threw its support to Donald Trump 11 years ago. There are thousands like me who, having left both parties for lack of any clear vision, would be willing to support politicians like Moulton who are willing to vote their minds.

Like so many elected officials from both parties, Senator Ed Markey has become a crony. His campaign is aggressively selling a progressive agenda that is out of touch with many voters. Whatever his accomplishments, 50 years in the swamp is not enough reason to let him stay there.

JAMIE BUSH
Hingham

We need Markey’s seniority in Senate

I was shocked at the Globe’s endorsement of Representative Seth Moulton in the Democratic Senate primary. Bringing younger people into positions of political leadership is important, but we need Senator Ed Markey’s still-sharp mind to combat the grift and chicanery of the current administration. Above all, we need the benefits that his seniority in the Senate affords him. As a freshman senator, Moulton would have far less power. Let Markey see us through the last two years of this chaotic Trump term and steer us ahead. He’s an excellent navigator.

PAM COOPER
Cambridge

Opinion

BOSTONGLOBE.COM/OPINION

ENDORSEMENT

Brian Shortsleeve in the Republican primary for governor

Since 2023, when Republican Governor Charlie Baker left office, Massachusetts has been a bastion of one-party rule. Democrats hold all five statewide elected offices and have super majorities in the Legislature.

Could the GOP begin to turn things around this year? The answer could be partly answered by the outcome of Tuesday’s GOP primary for governor.

That contest is a face-off between two candidates, Mike Minogue and Brian Shortsleeve, who are both military veterans and have run companies. Both have made the state’s anemic economy, high taxes and cost of living, and expansive regulatory regime the focus of their campaigns. But they differ in important ways.

Minogue is against abortion rights, while Shortsleeve supports them. Minogue’s experience is entirely in the private sector, most recently as chief executive of a medical devices firm, Abiomed, the sale of which made him a very wealthy man. Shortsleeve has worked in finance but also has more political and public sector experience, as political director for Mitt Romney’s successful 2002 gubernatorial campaign, and more recently, as the top transit advisor to Baker.

And while both men voted for Donald Trump in 2024 — only to distance themselves in 2026 — Minogue’s support for the president and his running mate was more fulsome: In 2024 he hosted future Vice President JD Vance at a fund-raiser and contributed \$250,000 to Trump’s 2025 inauguration fund.

For these reasons, and others, the Globe editorial board believes Shortsleeve sits more squarely within the proud tradition of moderate Republicanism embraced by the state’s most recent GOP governors. Those five governors demonstrated that Massachusetts is indeed capable of healthy mixed-party government — for roughly 24 of the last 35 years.

Massachusetts deserves a competitive race for governor that yields a robust debate over such urgent issues as the state’s economy, housing development, utility costs, tax rates, and job creation. If Shortsleeve is the GOP nominee, that’s more likely to happen, while a race against Minogue would be more likely to devolve into a fight over abortion rights and his contributions to Trump.

Our support for Shortsleeve in the primary does not imply opposition to Democratic Governor Maura Healey in the general election. It is vigorous debate between incumbent and challenger that we want to encourage now.

“I’m the type of Republican who can win in Massachusetts,” Shortsleeve told the editorial board in a recent interview. “I am a prochoice candidate. I am a social moderate. I am pragmatic on those issues. Those are the sorts of candidates here that win on the Republican side.”

He’s right that history is on his side. The last time the GOP nominated a right-winger for governor, he lost in a landslide. But the state’s Democratic-leaning electorate has shown ample willingness to support moderate Republican governors as checks on the Legislature.

After graduating from Harvard, Shortsleeve, 53, served in the Marine Corps, leaving as a captain. He started his business career in strategic consulting and investing, including several years at Bain & Company. Later, he would create his own investment firm, M33 Growth. But he is perhaps best known for his public service as chief administrator and then general manager at the MBTA under Baker.

Shortsleeve’s two-year tenure leading the T was at times controversial. The agency was facing a \$300 million operating deficit, which he aggressively tackled by ordering audits, closely tracking costs, and increasing the transparency of its pension board. He also raised fares, privatized some jobs, and cancelled late-night service. Though many of his actions were unpopular and the agency remained far from fixed, it became a more efficient and fiscally responsible place under his guidance.

“We got costs under control,” he told the editorial board. “At the state level, we’ve got to do the same thing. Our state budget is up at \$65 billion now. That’s almost 50 percent larger than it was six years ago.”

He contends he would bring the same approach

to running state government, where in his view a bloated budget has overly burdened taxpayers and small businesses. His priorities would include stripping state-mandated fees from utility bills and rolling back income and other taxes. “I would immediately focus broadly on regulatory and red tape relief,” he told the board.

On energy, Shortsleeve wants to import natural gas from Pennsylvania, which he sees as more practical (“When it got cold in January and February, the windmills weren’t turning and the solar panels were covered in snow,” he told the board). Not a fan of offshore wind, he does support expanding onshore wind and solar power, asserting he would bring energy bills closer to 20 cents per kilowatt hour from the

The Globe editorial board believes Shortsleeve sits more squarely within the proud tradition of moderate Republicanism embraced by the state’s most recent GOP governors.



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

GOP gubernatorial candidate Brian Shortsleeve, right, shook hands with his running mate, New Bedford City Councilor Shawn Oliver, left, in July.

current 35 cents.

Our greatest disappointment with Shortsleeve is his call for rescinding the MBTA Communities Act, the landmark 2021 law supported by Baker that is intended to encourage high-density housing development along mass transit routes. Shortsleeve contends it is an unfunded mandate that has fueled resistance in many towns, and he calls for using state-owned land to build new housing as an alternative strategy.

For his part, Minogue, 59, has run a credible, heavily self-funded campaign. After graduating from West Point and serving for about four years as an Army infantry officer, he went to work in a health care unit of General Electric Healthcare before joining Abiomed, a Danvers-based company that produces miniature heart pumps, where he served as chief executive and president until Johnson & Johnson acquired it for nearly \$17 billion in 2022.

Minogue, the front-runner in polls, has refused to debate Shortsleeve and his campaign has urged Shortsleeve to quit the race, arguing that the primary has spotlighted intraparty divisions while draining resources that would be better spent attacking Healey.

But our view is that vigorously contested primaries can help candidates clarify their policy goals, hone their public messaging, and engage the attention of independent voters. They are more often than not a sign of a party’s strength, not weakness.

Will this be the year the Mass GOP shows it can play on the same field as the Democrats? For a party that has lost its way nationally under the vindictive and self-dealing policies of the Trump administration, Massachusetts could help lead the way back toward a saner, more pragmatic, and less hard-right future.

We believe that process begins with the election of Brian Shortsleeve as the Republican candidate for governor.

The Boston Globe

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Many of Boston’s public-facing clocks are off these days, including outside South Station (left), the Old State House (center top), inside South Station (center bottom), and the Custom House Tower (right).

JASON MARGOLIS/
GLOBE STAFF

JASON MARGOLIS

Boston’s clocks can’t keep time

Earlier this month, I was taking a break on the downtown roof deck in the building that houses the Globe when I glanced up at the Custom House Tower clock. I quickly panicked, thinking I was late for a meeting. Fortunately, my anxiety was short-lived: Boston’s largest clock was running eight minutes fast.

A couple weeks later, it was 30 minutes slow. Turns out, this was not a one-off — a lot of public-facing clocks are off. The Old State House is about two minutes slow. In a great irony, the analog clock outside of South Station is two minutes fast, while the analog clock inside the terminal is four minutes ahead. (Or perhaps that’s by design to keep commuters on time?)

Clocks used to be critical public amenities, and providing them was a basic function of local governments. In the age of smart phones, those days are long gone. Still, prominent clocks that are wrong can be a source of confusion, even if temporary. On the flip side, as I came to learn, inaccurate public timepieces are also a cool quirk of history.

I reached out to the man responsible for taking care of many of our public-facing clocks, David Hochstrasser, to see what the problem was.

He estimates that he’s reset the temperamental Custom House clock, the 45th largest in the world, about a dozen times a year for the past 29 years. “It can gain seven minutes one week, and lose three the next,” he said.

The clock, 22 feet in diameter and just a foot less than London’s Big Ben, gets battered by snow, wind, and rain coming off Boston Harbor. Since New England’s second-biggest clock — Ayer Mill in Lawrence nudges out the Custom House by a tenth of a foot — began ticking on April 6, 1916, keeping accurate time has been a constant battle.

“The clock is being asked to do a lot more than it was engineered for,” said David, who described the Custom House’s undersized motor pushing the four-sided clock’s 13.8-foot minute hands as a “a small Toyota” pulling “a huge trailer.”

“It can do it, but it’s struggling.” So, every month or so, David gets a call from Peter Sugrue, director of engineering for the Marriott Vacation Club at Custom House, which leases the building from the city of Boston to operate a time share and hotel.

Sugrue said he normally rings up David when the clock is three to five minutes off, but the clock will be covered by scaffolding early next week when the Marriott begins some facade work. So, Sugrue figured he’d wait to set the clock until that’s done.

When David does get the call, it takes him about an hour to set things right. He goes up to the 24th floor and starts working among the “escape wheel,” pendulum, gears, and weights that allow the clock to operate by gravity.

Nailing the time, he said, is more art than science. “You can’t expect tremendous accuracy,” David said, describing a 19th-century technology battling the outside elements. “I’ve driven myself crazy up there trying to get it all perfect.”

David got into clock repair by accident. There’s a bit of family dispute over the details of the origin story, but basically, his older brother Ross brought home a couple of mantle clocks in the mid-1970s. One had a broken spring, so the two brothers took it apart and one of them, depending on whom you ask, figured out how to put it back together. Apprenticeships were later landed.

“So that was kind of the beginning of this nonsense,” David said.

Both brothers now own clock shops. David, 63, owns The Clock Shop in Hanover and Ross, 69, owns Ross A. Hochstrasser, Clock Service in Whitman. This fall, David is closing up shop and moving to Texas to be closer to family. Ross will take over the Custom House job and is grooming a young man to learn the craft.

I asked the brothers: What is it about large clocks that captivate us?

“We’re keeping a piece of history operating up there,” Ross said.

Back in the 1800s, municipalities in the Commonwealth were required by law to provide clocks so people knew what time it was. “It wasn’t that people liked them, it was that they were a necessity,” Ross said.

The brothers take care of a lot of clocks across the state — on towers, city halls, historic buildings, and churches. Back in the day, municipalities put clocks on the highest point in town, which often meant church steeples.

There’s a reason some of those clocks aren’t accurate: They’re simply not regularly maintained. A town often owns a clock, but the church owns the steeple, and it’s not always clear which party agreed to maintain the clock 200 years ago.

Ross said people occasionally grumble that the public-facing old clocks aren’t accurate enough. His response: “You don’t hop into a Model T Ford made in 1913 and expect to do 85 miles an hour on the highway.

“If you need to know the exact time, look at your phone.”

Jason Margolis can be reached at jason.margolis@globe.com.

KARA BETTIS CARVALHO

Lindsay Clancy is an outlier. But when should women worry?

On Aug. 20, hundreds of people — mostly women clad in pink — rallied at the Plymouth Superior Court to demonstrate their support for Lindsay Clancy. The trial of the 36-year-old Duxbury mom who strangled her three children allegedly while experiencing postpartum psychosis has garnered national and international attention.

Thousands of people have been tuning into the trial daily via livestream channels, and on some days, the number tops more than 100,000. The courtroom, too, has been packed with both media and members of the public.

The fascination with this case is in part due to what my colleague Marcela García observed as the unfortunate TikTokification of a deeply tragic situation. But I wonder *why* we are so drawn to this case, besides true crime. In part, it may be because many women can relate. Several of my young mom friends have told me that they can relate to Clancy — they, too, experienced extreme anxiety, depression, or intrusive thoughts that scared them after giving birth. On the other hand, others told me they couldn’t imagine how a mother could kill her children in cold blood.

If anything good can come from plastering Clancy’s private journal entries, text messages, and confidential conversations with family and friends all over tabloids and media, it might just be that society destigmatizes the conversation around postpartum mental illness. Many experts have said that they hope this case will bring more attention to it and that more women will seek help. The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention estimates that about 1 in 8 women experience postpartum depression and about half who have it are not diagnosed. (A different condition known as baby

The CDC estimates that about 1 in 8 women experience postpartum depression and about half who have it are not diagnosed.

blues is a normal hormonal adjustment period after birth that usually resolves naturally within 3 weeks postpartum.)

The focus on the trial seems to be generating mostly helpful attention to postpartum mental health. Some support groups and resource centers for maternal mental health have seen a surge in referrals. The Postpartum Support International helpline has experienced a 30 percent increase in contacts — phone calls, texts, and online inquiries — in the past six weeks and a 50 percent increase in contacts just from Massachusetts, according to Andrea Clark, deputy chief executive officer of Postpartum Support International.

The National Maternal Mental Health Hotline, too, has seen a nearly 70 percent increase in monthly contacts since May, according to preliminary data. In the first three months of 2026, the hotline received more than 9,200 inquiries through phone calls, texts, and webchats — about 2,000 more than the same time period the previous year. Many were calling because they felt overwhelmed (26 percent), but many reported anxiety (11 percent) or depression (12 percent).

A national study found in 2023 that postpartum psychosis slightly but steadily increased from 2016 to 2019, though rates remain low (1 to 2 women in 1,000). While there’s no way to determine cause and effect, there are benefits to women seeking help for their feelings and symptoms.

Dr. Uruj Kamal Haider, an academic perinatal psychiatrist and medical director of Massachusetts Child Psychiatry Access Program for Moms, pointed out that at least half of women with postpartum psychosis have no prior psychiatric history.

Psychiatrists have a few recommendations for when to seek help. First, any feeling of being “off” or not feeling like oneself should not be dismissed. Any new mother, or their family and friends, should look for what Haider calls “pink flags” — the early signs of postpartum psychosis that can be easily missed. These include mood changes, visible confusion, and feeling energized despite significant sleep deprivation. Pink flags can be “where lives can be saved,” Haider said.

Red flags — signs of a psychiatric emergency — include loss of insight, delusions, hallucinations, marked confusion or disorganization, paranoia, or a significant change in mental status. These require immediate psychiatric evaluation.

Haider has two other recommendations. She thinks the conversation needs to include the essential role of caregiving help and sleep. Caregiving help, especially from family and friends, is essential to provide women support since sleep deprivation can worsen or precipitate psychiatric symptoms, particularly in people vulnerable to mania or psychosis. “The key thing is talking about restorative, uninterrupted sleep for parents as much as possible, and protecting them during that time period,” Haider said.

My hope for new moms watching the trial and worried about their own health, or wanting to process past experiences, is that you’ll talk to a trusted friend or family member and, if necessary, pursue help from a medical professional.

And for those of us obsessed with live streaming the trial, we might consider turning our time spent on voyeurism into supporting the new mothers in our lives through the earliest and most vulnerable child-rearing years. It might just save lives.

Kara Bettis Carvalho can be reached at kara.carvalho@globe.com. Follow her on X @karabettis.

For a cancer patient, the day is a series of waiting rooms

By Joan Wickersham

Joan Wickersham’s latest book is “No Ship Sets Out To Be A Shipwreck.” She is a contributing Globe Opinion writer.

At 7 o’clock on a Thursday morning, the second-floor waiting room at Dana-Farber Cancer Institute is crowded. There are couples, old people with a grown-up son or daughter, one or two younger people with a parent, a few people sitting alone. I am here with my friend “Gail,” who was diagnosed two years ago with ovarian cancer. Like all the other patients sitting around us, she is waiting to get her blood drawn.

Every minute or so a nurse comes out and calls for the next patient: first name and last initial. The door opens and closes with a loud clunk; with each clunk the waiting room seems to hold its breath — who will be called next? Some people stride over to the nurse, some walk slowly, or walk with a cane, steadied by a husband’s hand. A few are in wheelchairs. Some wear wigs or caps. The nurses are brisk — this is an efficient place. The doctors upstairs need to see the blood results before they see the patients.

The door clunks open and Gail’s name is called. She is in and out within minutes, and then she and I are in the elevator heading to the 10th floor.

The day is a series of waiting rooms. The 10th-floor one is light and quiet, set against a wall of windows and divided by etched glass partitions into smaller sections. We sit, and Gail sends out some work emails. I read and look out the window, at the construction site below where a new clinical care building is just starting to go up.

We talk. We’ve been friends for more

than 30 years. She doesn’t say it, but I know she’s nervous about meeting with her oncologist. She had a series of scans last week and the results were encouraging, but if the blood results are too far from where they should be, she won’t be able to get her chemo infusion today.

But her doctor is excited about the bloodwork as well as the scans. “You’re doing great — all your numbers look great.” Gail’s treatment is part of a clinical study,

Like Gail, everyone here has spent the morning waiting to be screened, to be seen by a doctor, to receive treatment.

testing a new drug and its side effects. The fact that she’s doing so well is good news not just for her but also for the data about the drug’s potential.

She and the doctor talk a little about the Pan-Mass Challenge bicycle ride, a big fund-raising event for Dana-Farber research, which had happened the previous weekend. Gail’s son had taken part for the first time, riding 162 miles from Wellesley to Provincetown. The doctor says she rode in it a few times, “but that was years ago.”

We take the elevator down to a waiting room on the sixth floor, where Gail will get her infusion. The Pan-Mass Challenge is a subject of conversation here too: A young woman in a wheelchair is talking with her parents about Bruce Springsteen, who made a video to kick off this year’s ride, praising the hospital and its research. His wife, Patti Scialfa, has been treated at Dana-

Farber for several years.

Another woman in the waiting room gets up when her name is called and says, “The Boss is the best” as she walks by the family.

Over the past year Gail has spent a lot of time in these waiting rooms. She felt incredibly lucky to be there, but at first everything seemed big and overwhelming to her. That changed as the humanity of the place started to sink in. Her doctor and her regular infusion nurse made Gail feel not just cared for but also seen and known.

She also became deeply aware of what a wide variety of people she was part of in these rooms. No matter who they were, no matter what their circumstances or how far they’d traveled to be there, cancer was what they all had in common. In one sense it was the great leveler. But all of them were individuals as well, with different diagnoses and different lives, and they were each trying to deal with it in their own way.

Gail’s name is called and we are taken into a curtained cubicle where the infusion nurse gets Gail settled. Nausea has been a problem after each treatment, but last time they added a steroid to the mix and it helped a lot. Fingers crossed that it will work today as well.

We can hear sounds from the surrounding cubicles. On one side a conversation in a language I don’t recognize; on the other side a man coughing. Along with cancer, the other common denominator here is waiting, knowing what will happen and also having to tolerate not knowing. Like Gail, everyone here has spent the morning waiting to be screened, to be seen by a doctor, to receive treatment. Then there is waiting for today’s treatment to be finished, and waiting to walk out the door of the hospital and just get on with life.

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LEGAL NOTICES

MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue of and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain mortgage given by Paul R. Boyd to Bank of America, N.A., dated October 30, 2006 and recorded in Suffolk County Registry of Deeds in Book 40693, the "Mortgage" of which mortgage U.S. Bank Trust National Association, not in its individual capacity, but solely as Trustee of Citigroup Mortgage Loan Trust 2021-RP3 is the present holder by Assignment from Bank of America, N.A. to Green Tree Servicing LLC dated June 26, 2013 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 51768, Page 97, and Assignment from Green Tree Servicing LLC dated February 4, 2019 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 60717, Page 242, and Assignment from New Residential Mortgage LLC to U.S. Bank Trust National Association, not in its individual capacity, but solely as Trustee of Citigroup Mortgage Loan Trust 2021-RP3 dated September 2, 2021 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 66223, Page 62, for breach of conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same, the mortgaged premises located at 84 Moreland Street, Roxbury, MA 02119 will be sold at a Public Auction at 12:00 PM on September 11, 2026, at the mortgaged premises, more particularly described below, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage, to wit:

The land in Roxbury, County of Suffolk, Massachusetts Bounded and described as follows:

A certain parcel of land with the buildings thereon situated on Moreland Street in that part of Boston formerly called Roxbury, bounded and described as follows:

Southwesterly: By Moreland Street forty-five and 10/100 (45.10) feet, more or less; Northerly: by land now formerly of William Barton one hundred thirty (130) feet, more or less;

Northeasterly: in part by land formerly of Baldwin and in part by land formerly of Blodgett, eighty-nine and 30/100 (89.30) feet, more or less;

Southeasterly: by land formerly of Bailey, thirty (30) feet, more or less; then turning at right angles and running Northerly: on land of Garrett H. Byrne, forty-four (44) feet, more or less; then turning at right angles and running

Southwesterly: on land of said Byrne one hundred (100) feet to Moreland Street and point of beginning.

Containing 7,040 square feet of land, more or less. Be any part of said premises and contents more or less, or however otherwise said premises may be measured, bounded or described.

For mortgagor's title see deed recorded with the Suffolk County Registry of Deeds in Book 33685, Page 100.

The premises will be sold subject to any and all unpaid taxes and other municipal assessments and liens, and subject to prior liens or other enforceable encumbrances of record entitled to precedence over this mortgage, and subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, reservations and conditions of record and subject to all tenancies and/or rights of parties in possession.

Terms of the Sale: Cashier's or certified check in the sum of \$5,000.00 as a deposit must be shown at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder (the mortgage holder and its designees) are exempt from this requirement; high bidder to sign written Memorandum of Sale upon acceptance of bid; balance of purchase price payable by certified check in thirty (30) days from the date of the sale at the offices of mortgagee's attorney, Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street, Suite 3102, Lowell, MA or such other time as may be designated by mortgagee. The description for the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of a typographical error in this publication.

Other terms to be announced at the sale.

U.S. Bank Trust National Association, not in its individual capacity, but solely as Trustee of Citigroup Mortgage Loan Trust 2021-RP3 Korde & Associates, P.C. 900 Chelmsford Street Suite 3102 Lowell, MA 01851 (978) 256-1500 Boyd, Estate of Paul R., 25-049369

LEGAL NOTICE

MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue of and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain mortgage given by Amy L. Wegryzn to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for Newelliance Bank, its successors and assigns, dated October 17, 1949, made by Arnold Schaler, C.E. recorded in Suffolk County Registry of Deeds in Book 18494, Page 189 (the "Mortgage") of which mortgage Arvest Bank, Successor in Interest by Merger to Arvest Central Mortgage Company (aka Central Mortgage Company) is the present holder by Assignment from Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc. to Central Mortgage Company dated October 24, 2012 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 51768, Page 97, and Assignment from Central Mortgage Company dated October 24, 2012 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 51768, Page 97, for breach of conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same, the mortgaged premises located at 6 Pondview Drive, Chicopee, MA 01020 will be sold at a Public Auction at 12:00 PM on September 11, 2026, at the mortgaged premises, more particularly described below, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage, to wit:

The land in the City of Chicopee, County of Hampden, Commonwealth of Massachusetts, together with the buildings thereon, bounded and described as follows:

Being known and designated as Lot #94 (ninety-four) as shown on a plan of said premises recorded in Suffolk County Registry of Deeds, Book of Plans 60, Pages 106 and 107, and being more particularly bounded and described as follows:

SOUTHWESTERLY by Pondview Drive, one hundred thirty-eight and 94/100 (138.94) feet;

NORTHWESTERLY by Lot #95 (ninety-five) as shown on said plan, ninety (90) feet;

NORTHEASTERLY by land of owner unknown, one hundred twenty-eight and 05/100 (128.05) feet; and

SOUTHEASTERLY by Memorial Drive, ninety and 66/100 (90.66) feet.

For mortgagor's title see deed recorded with the Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 18494, Page 187.

The premises will be sold subject to any and all unpaid taxes and other municipal assessments and liens, and subject to prior liens or other enforceable encumbrances of record entitled to precedence over this mortgage, and subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, reservations and conditions of record and subject to all tenancies and/or rights of parties in possession.

Terms of the Sale: Cashier's or certified check in the sum of \$5,000.00 as a deposit must be shown at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder (the mortgage holder and its designees) are exempt from this requirement; high bidder to sign written Memorandum of Sale upon acceptance of bid; balance of purchase price payable by certified check in thirty (30) days from the date of the sale at the offices of mortgagee's attorney, Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street, Suite 3102, Lowell, MA or such other time as may be designated by mortgagee. The description for the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of a typographical error in this publication.

Other terms to be announced at the sale.

Arvest Bank, Successor in Interest by Merger to Arvest Central Mortgage Company (aka Central Mortgage Company) Korde & Associates, P.C. 900 Chelmsford Street Suite 3102 Lowell, MA 01851 (978) 256-1500 Wegryzn, Amy L., 20-036923

Notice of Request for Proposals for Utility Bill Management Platform Services

PowerOptions, Inc., a non-profit energy buying consortium, is soliciting proposals from interested providers to develop a utility bill management platform for the members of the PowerOptions consortium, which is comprised of over 800 non-profits and governmental organizations throughout Massachusetts. To receive the Request for Proposals (RFP), email PowerOptions at the address below. The RFP will be sent to all requesters on September 11th, 2026.

PowerOptions, Inc.
129 South St 6th floor
Boston, MA 02111
Telephone (617) 856-0233
ubmRFP@poweroptions.org

Completed proposals must be received no later than 5:00 p.m. EST, October 16th, 2026 at the above email address. PowerOptions reserves the right to reject any and all submissions deemed incomplete or unresponsive.

LEGAL NOTICES

MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue of and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain mortgage given by Josue I. Garces to Citizens Bank, N.A., dated September 26, 2023 and recorded in Hampshire County Registry of Deeds in Book 2168, Page 253 (the "Mortgage"), as affected by a Loan Modification Agreement dated July 6, 2024, and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 25507, Page 240 of which mortgage Citizens Bank, N.A. is the present holder, for breach of conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same, the mortgaged premises located at 33 Merrill Road, Southfield, MA 01119 will be sold at a Public Auction at 10:00 AM on September 11, 2026, at the mortgaged premises, more particularly described below, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage, to wit:

Certain real estate situated in Springfield, Hampden County, Massachusetts, known and designated as Lot #153 (one hundred fifty-three) as shown on a plan of lots entitled Floral Park and recorded in Book of Plans 21, Page 60, said lot being more particularly bounded as follows:

WESTERLY by Merrill Road, fifty (50) feet;

NORTHERLY by Lot #152 (one hundred fifty-two) as shown on said plan, one hundred (100) feet,

EASTERLY by Lot #144 (one hundred forty-four) as shown on said plan, fifty (50) feet; and

SOUTHERLY by Lot #154 (one hundred fifty-four) as shown on said plan, one hundred (100) feet.

For mortgagor's title see deed recorded with the Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 25168, Page 250.

The premises will be sold subject to any and all unpaid taxes and other municipal assessments and liens, and subject to prior liens or other enforceable encumbrances of record entitled to precedence over this mortgage, and subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, reservations and conditions of record and subject to all tenancies and/or rights of parties in possession.

Terms of the Sale: Cashier's or certified check in the sum of \$5,000.00 as a deposit must be shown at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder (the mortgage holder and its designees) are exempt from this requirement; high bidder to sign written Memorandum of Sale upon acceptance of bid; balance of purchase price payable by certified check in thirty (30) days from the date of the sale at the offices of mortgagee's attorney, Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street, Suite 3102, Lowell, MA or such other time as may be designated by mortgagee. The description for the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of a typographical error in this publication.

Other terms to be announced at the sale.

Citizens Bank, N.A. Korde & Associates, P.C. 900 Chelmsford Street Suite 3102 Lowell, MA 01851 (978) 256-1500 Garces, Josue I., 24-045337

LEGAL NOTICE

MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue of and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain mortgage given by Virginia A. Teta to Wachovia Mortgage, FSB, dated February 8, 2008 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 17148, Page 474 (the "Mortgage") of which mortgage Wells Fargo Bank, N.A. s/b/m Wachovia Bank, N.A. s/b/m Wachovia Mortgage, FSB is the present holder, for breach of conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same, the mortgaged premises located at 27 Hazel Street, West Springfield, MA 01089 will be sold at a Public Auction at 11:00 AM on September 11, 2026, at the mortgaged premises, more particularly described below, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage, to wit:

Property Address: 27 HAZEL STREET, WEST SPRINGFIELD, MASSACHUSETTS 01089

The land in West Springfield, Hampden County, Massachusetts, more particularly bounded and described as follows:

Certain real estate situated in West Springfield, Hampden County, Massachusetts, being known as Lots #5 (five) and #7 (seven) as shown on a plan of lots recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book of Plans 27, Page 83, said lots being more particularly bounded and described in one parcel as follows:

Bounded:

NORTHERLY by Hazel Street, one hundred fifty-eight (158) feet;

EASTERLY by Lot #3 (three) on said plan, one hundred five (105) feet;

SOUTHERLY by lots #4 (four), #6 (six) and #8 (eight) on said plan, one hundred fifty-eight (158) feet; and

WESTERLY by lot #9 (nine) on said plan, one hundred (105) feet.

SUBJECT to water right, if any, as set forth in instrument recorded as aforesaid in Book 2022, Page 44, and in Book 2034, Page 363.

For mortgagor's title see deed recorded with the Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 14742, Page 501.

The premises will be sold subject to any and all unpaid taxes and other municipal assessments and liens, and subject to prior liens or other enforceable encumbrances of record entitled to precedence over this mortgage, and subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, reservations and conditions of record and subject to all tenancies and/or rights of parties in possession.

Terms of the Sale: Cashier's or certified check in the sum of \$5,000.00 as a deposit must be shown at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder (the mortgage holder and its designees) are exempt from this requirement; high bidder to sign written Memorandum of Sale upon acceptance of bid; balance of purchase price payable by certified check in thirty (30) days from the date of the sale at the offices of mortgagee's attorney, Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street, Suite 3102, Lowell, MA or such other time as may be designated by mortgagee. The description for the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of a typographical error in this publication.

Other terms to be announced at the sale.

Wells Fargo Bank, N.A. s/b/m Wachovia Bank, N.A. s/b/m Wachovia Mortgage, FSB Korde & Associates, P.C. 900 Chelmsford Street Suite 3102 Lowell, MA 01851 (978) 256-1500 Teta, Virginia A., 25-049158

COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS LAND COURT DEPARTMENT OF THE TRIAL COURT DOCKET NO. 26 SMJ02718 ORDER CE NO. 2026-001

To: Colleen Sydey Gardner

and to all persons entitled to the benefit of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act, 50 U.S.C. c. 50 §3901 (et seq.)

HSBC Bank USA, National Association, as Trustee for the holders of the Deutsche Alt-A Securities Inc., Mortgage Loan Trust, Series 2006-AB1, Mortgage Pass-Through Certificates, Series 2006-AB1

claiming to have an interest in a Mortgage covering real property in Boston (Roxbury), numbered 100 Harborside Street, given by Sylvia Gardner to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for GreenPoint Mortgage Funding, Inc., its successors and assigns, dated November 16, 2005, and recorded in Suffolk County Registry of Deeds in Book 38499, Page 207, and now held by the Plaintiff by assignment, has/have filed with this court a complaint for determination of Defendant's/Defendants' Servicemembers status.

If you now are, or recently have been, in the active military service of the United States of America, then you may be entitled to the benefits of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act. If you object to a foreclosure of the above-mentioned property on that basis, then you or your attorney must file a written appearance and answer in this court at **Three Pemberton Square, Boston, MA 02108** on or before 10/5/26 or you may lose the opportunity to challenge the foreclosure on the ground of noncompliance with the Act.

Witness, GORDON H. PIPER Chief Justice of this Court on 8/24/2026.

Attest: Deborah J. Patterson, Recorder

LEGAL NOTICES

MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue of and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain mortgage given by Manish Vashisht to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for Quicken Loans Inc., its successors and assigns, dated August 25, 2016 and recorded in Middlesex County (Southern District) Registry of Deeds in Book 67945, Page 372 (the "Mortgage") of which mortgage Rocket Mortgage, LLC f/k/a Quicken Loans, LLC f/k/a Quicken Loans Inc. is the present holder by Assignment from Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for Quicken Loans Inc., its successors and assigns to Rocket Mortgage, LLC f/k/a Quicken Loans, LLC f/k/a Quicken Loans Inc. dated July 21, 2023 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 81816, Page 113, for breach of conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same, the mortgaged premises located at 15 Aldrich Street, Somerville, MA 02145 will be sold at a Public Auction at 11:00 AM on September 25, 2026, at the mortgaged premises, more particularly described below, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage, to wit:

Land Situated in the City of Somerville in the County of Middlesex in the State of MA

THE LAND IN SAID SOMERVILLE WITH THE BUILDINGS THEREON, BEING PARTS OF LOT NO 19 AND NO 20 AS SHOWN ON A "PLAN OF LAND IN SOMERVILLE, BELONGING TO ARTHUR W. TUTTLES AND OTHERS - CHARLES D. ELLIOTT CIVIL ENGINEER AND SURVEYOR, DATED MAY 1886, BEING DULY RECORDED WITH MIDDLESEX SOUTH DISTRICT DEEDS, BOOK OF PLANS 51, PLAN 32, BOUNDED AND DESCRIBED AS FOLLOWS:

NORTHEASTERLY: BY VIRGINIA STREET, FORTY-FOUR (44.85) FEET SOUTHEASTERLY: BY ALDRICH STREET, THIRTY-SEVEN (37.77) FEET SOUTHWESTERLY: BY LAND NOW OR FORMERLY OF PATRICK F. O'LOUGHLIN, FORTY-ONE (41.25) FEET, AND NORTHWESTERLY: BY AND NOW OR FORMERLY OF N. H. REID, THIRTY-SIX (36) FEET.

Commonly known as: 15 Aldrich Street, Somerville, MA 02145-3902

For mortgagor's title see deed recorded with the Middlesex County (Southern District) Registry of Deeds in Book 57409, Page 480.

The premises will be sold subject to any and all unpaid taxes and other municipal assessments and liens, and subject to prior liens or other enforceable encumbrances of record entitled to precedence over this mortgage, and subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, reservations and conditions of record and subject to all tenancies and/or rights of parties in possession.

Terms of the Sale: Cashier's or certified check in the sum of \$5,000.00 as a deposit must be shown at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder (the mortgage holder and its designees) are exempt from this requirement; high bidder to sign written Memorandum of Sale upon acceptance of bid; balance of purchase price payable by certified check in thirty (30) days from the date of the sale at the offices of mortgagee's attorney, Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street, Suite 3102, Lowell, MA or such other time as may be designated by mortgagee. The description for the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of a typographical error in this publication.

Other terms to be announced at the sale.

Rocket Mortgage, LLC f/k/a Quicken Loans, LLC f/k/a Quicken Loans Inc. Korde & Associates, P.C. 900 Chelmsford Street Suite 3102 Lowell, MA 01851 (978) 256-1500 Vashisht, Estate of Manish, 23-043092

MORTGAGEE'S NOTICE OF SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain Mortgage given by Marie Chosson to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for Santander Bank, N.A., its successors and assigns, dated April 29, 2019 and recorded with the Norfolk County Registry of Deeds in Book 36755, Page 408, subsequently assigned to Santander Bank, N.A. by Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for Santander Bank, N.A., its successors and assigns by assignment recorded in said Norfolk County Registry of Deeds at Book 41946, Page 158 for breach of the conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing same will be sold at Public Auction at 11:00 AM on September 18, 2026 at 43 Ellis Avenue, Norwood, MA, all and singular the premises described in said Mortgage, to wit:

The land in Norwood, Norfolk County, Massachusetts, with the buildings thereon, being Lot No. 2 on Plan entitled "Plan of a Portion of Ellis Gardens Development, Norwood, Mass. dated Oct. 17, 1949, made by Arnold Schaler, C.E. recorded with Norfolk Deeds as Plan No. 74 of 1950, bounded as follows, according to said plan:

Northeasterly by Ellis Avenue, 80.00 feet;

Southeasterly by Lot No. 3 on said plan, 100.00 feet;

Southwesterly by other land now or formerly of Master-Craft Homes, Inc., 80.00 feet; and

Northwesterly by Lot No. 1 on said plan, 100.00 feet.

Containing, according to said plan, 8000 square feet.

Said above described lot is also shown as Lot No. 2 on plan entitled "Plan of a Portion 1/ Ellis Gardens Development, Norwood, Massachusetts, dated Jan. 9, 1950, made by D. Heard, C.E. recorded with Norfolk Deeds as Plan No. 72 of 1950.

Meaning and intending to describe the premises conveyed to Mortgageors by Deed recorded herewith.

The premises are to be sold subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, encroachments, building and zoning laws, liens, unpaid taxes, tax titles, water bills, municipal liens and assessments, rights of tenants and parties in possession, and attorney's fees and costs.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of TEN THOUSAND DOLLARS AND 00 CENTS (\$10,000.00) in the form of a certified check, bank treasurer's check or money order will be required to be delivered at or before the time the bid is offered. The successful bidder will be required to execute a Foreclosure Sale Agreement immediately after the close of the bidding. The balance of the purchase price shall be paid within thirty (30) days from the sale date in the form of a certified check, bank treasurer's check or other check satisfactory to Mortgagee's attorney. The Mortgagee reserves the right to bid at the sale, to reject any and all bids, to continue the sale and to amend the terms of the sale by written or oral announcement made before or during the foreclosure sale. If the sale is set aside for any reason, the Purchaser at the sale shall be entitled only to a return of the deposit paid. The purchaser shall have no further recourse against the Mortgagee or the Mortgagee's attorney. The description of the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of an error in this publication. TIME WILL BE OF THE ESSENCE.

FinCEN reporting will be required of all successful purchasers, absent a lawful exemption.

Other terms, if any, to be announced at the sale.

Santander Bank, N.A.

Present Holder of said Mortgage, By Its Attorneys, ORLANDS LAW GROUP PLLC PO Box 540540 Waltham, MA 02454 Phone: (781) 790-7800 25-016086

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The Boston Globe

LEGAL NOTICES

MORTGAGEE'S NOTICE OF SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain Mortgage given by Danielle Walker to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as nominee for Guaranteed Rate, Inc., its successors and assigns, dated September 18, 2019 and recorded with the Suffolk County Registry of Deeds at Book 61762, Page 270, subsequently assigned to Fifth Third Bank, National Association by Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc. ("MERS"), as nominee for Guaranteed Rate, Inc., beneficiary of the security instrument, its successors and assigns by assignment recorded in said Suffolk County Registry of Deeds at Book 68051, Page 912, subsequently assigned to Select Portfolio Servicing, Inc. by Fifth Third Bank, National Association by assignment recorded in said Suffolk County Registry of Deeds at Book 67934, Page 237 for breach of the conditions of said Mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing same will be sold at Public Auction at 11:00 AM on September 4, 2026 at 37-59A Edgewood Street, Unit #59A, Boston, MA, all and singular the premises described in said Mortgage, to wit:

Unit No. 59A of the Kananof-Homes Condominium (the "Unit") created by Master Deed dated October 19, 2013, and recorded with the Suffolk County Registry of Deeds (the "Registry") on November 19, 2018 at Book 60430, Page 96 (the "Master Deed").

The post office address of the unit is 37-59A Edgewood Street, Unit No. 59A, Boston, MA.

The Unit is shown on the floor plans of the Condominium recorded with the Master Deed, to which is affixed a verified statement of the form provided by MERS, C-183, set forth in the Master Deed, and with the benefit of the obligations, restrictions, rights and liabilities contained in G. L. 183A, the Master Deed, and the Declaration of Trust dated October 19, 2013, recorded with the Registry in Book 60430, Page 132, all as the same be amended from time to time by instruments recorded with the Registry.

The Unit is conveyed together with the exclusive right and easement to use Parking Space No. 11 as set forth in the Master Deed and shown on the plans recorded therewith.

Each of the units in the Condominium is intended for residential purposes and such other uses as are set forth in the Master Deed.

The undivided percentage interest of the Unit in the common areas and facilities is 5.540%.

For my title, see deed recorded herewith.

The premises are to be sold subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, encroachments, building and zoning laws, liens, unpaid taxes, tax titles, water bills, municipal liens and assessments, rights of tenants and parties in possession, and attorney's fees and costs.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of FIVE THOUSAND DOLLARS AND 00 CENTS (\$5,000.00) in the form of a certified check, bank treasurer's check or money order will be required to be delivered at or before the time the bid is offered. The successful bidder will be required to execute a Foreclosure Sale Agreement immediately after the close of the bidding. The balance of the purchase price shall be paid within thirty (30) days from the sale date in the form of a certified check, bank treasurer's check or other check satisfactory to Mortgagee's attorney. The Mortgagee reserves the right to bid at the sale, to reject any and all bids, to continue the sale and to amend the terms of the sale by written or oral announcement made before or during the foreclosure sale. If the sale is set aside for any reason, the Purchaser at the sale shall be entitled only to a return of the deposit paid. The purchaser shall have no further recourse against the Mortgagee, the Mortgagee or the Mortgagee's attorney. The description of the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of an error in this publication. TIME WILL BE OF THE ESSENCE.

FinCEN reporting will be required of all successful purchasers, absent a lawful exemption.

Other terms, if any, to be announced at the sale.

Select Portfolio Servicing, Inc.

Present Holder of said Mortgage, By Its Attorneys, ORLANDS LAW GROUP PLLC PO Box 540540 Waltham, MA 02454 Phone: (781) 790-7800 23-011524

MORTGAGEE'S NOTICE OF SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain Mortgage given by Robert Gilbertson and Kimberly Gilbertson to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as nominee for Shamrock Home Loans, Inc., its successors and assigns, dated July 29, 2022 and recorded with the Suffolk County Registry of Deeds at Book 73174, Page 202, subsequently assigned to PHH Asset Servicing, L.P., a New Jersey Corporation, by assignment recorded in said Worcester County Registry of Deeds at Book 67994, Page 176 as affected by a Loan Modification recorded on June 30, 2025 in said Registry of Deeds at Book 72189, Page 239, subsequently assigned to PHH Asset Servicing, L.P., a New Jersey Corporation, by assignment recorded in said Worcester County Registry of Deeds at Book 73174, Page 202, for breach of the conditions of said Mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing same will be sold at Public Auction at 11:00 AM on September 11, 2026 at 203 Thayer Street, Milville, MA, all and singular the premises

Metro

B

THE BOSTON GLOBE FRIDAY, AUGUST 28, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/METRO



A bee gathered pollen on a sunflower head at Verrill Farm in Concord.

PHOTOS BY JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

FIELDS OF GOLD

Sunflowers stand tall at 108-year-old Concord farm

By John Tlumacki
GLOBE STAFF

Bees jostle for position on sunflower heads like they’re playing a game of musical chairs at Verrill Farm in Concord.

Dakota Braun, 24, is all but hidden in the field of towering stalks of sunflowers. Some areas are as high as 10 feet, with heads over a foot wide. Braun, from Concord, is camouflaged by the broad green leaves and radiant yellow flowers.

“My office is a sunflower field,” Braun said with a smile, holding bypass pruners in his left hand and a bunch of long-stemmed sunflowers in his right.

He slogs in straight lines through the dusty soil in search of the perfect sunflowers to cut and arrange, which he sells. Minutes go by before Braun emerges from the field, proudly holding a large sunflower bouquet above his head as if it were a championship trophy.

“It’s been fantastic; there hasn’t been better than this year,” Braun said.

July and August were very dry months, and the sunflowers at Verrill Farm don’t receive any supple-



“My office is a sunflower field,” Dakota Braun said.

mental irrigation, but they’re resilient, Braun said. Six different varieties of sunflowers were planted in early June on four acres of the 108-year-old farm.

Young sunflowers track the sun with their heads, moving from east to west during the day. Mature

sunflowers permanently face east to warm up faster in the morning sun, attracting more bees.

“Sometimes you come here early in the morning, and the bees appear sleeping and loaded with pollen and covered with dew on the sunflowers,” said Jen Robinson, a

floral manager.

Robinson said she was only stung once during her 24 years on the farm.

“The bees don’t care because you end up smelling like a flower by the time you’re in the field for five minutes,” she said.

Jury begins deliberating Clancy’s fate

Will weigh starkly conflicting arguments

By Shelley Murphy and Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — Jurors began deliberating the fate of Lindsay Clancy on Thursday after five weeks of trial and impassioned final arguments over whether she was suffering from postpartum psychosis when she killed her three children or guilty of premeditated murder.

The jury of nine women and three men spent about 3½ hours going over evidence before being sent home for the day. Deliberations will resume Friday morning

at Plymouth Superior Court in the case that has garnered international attention.

Clancy’s attorney, Kevin Reddington, showed jurors two poster-sized photographs of Clancy during his closing argument. “How does this,” he asked, “turn into this?”

One depicted a happy family, with Clancy smiling broadly as she stood alongside her husband and children. The other showed her lying in a hospital bed, paralyzed from the waist down, with tubes coming out of her body. It was taken hours after she strangled 5-

year-old Cora, 3-year-old Dawson, and 8-month-old Callan in the basement of their Duxbury home on Jan. 24, 2023, then slashed her neck and wrists and jumped out a second-story window.

“How?” said Reddington, who has accused medical providers of prescribing medications that made Clancy’s postpartum mental health issues worse and led to a psychotic break. “Because of the damn medicine and the lousy medical care she got.”

He urged jurors to credit the testimony of a forensic psychiatrist who evaluated Clancy for the defense and concluded “she was in a state of psychosis” when she

killed her children and should not be held criminally responsible.

But, in her closing argument to jurors, Assistant District Attorney Jennifer Sprague said prosecutors don’t dispute that Clancy was suffering from mental illness and tried to kill herself, but insisted she was given appropriate medical care.

“This case is not about our mental health system,” Sprague argued. “That’s a distraction.”

Sprague argued that Clancy was depressed, exhausted, and “didn’t want to try anymore” after the birth of her third child and chose to kill herself and her

CLANCY, Page B3

If jurors choose ‘guilty,’ they have several options

In each instance, burden of proof is on prosecution

By Lea Skene and Shelley Murphy
GLOBE STAFF

Jurors in the Lindsay Clancy case started deliberating Thursday, after both sides delivered closing arguments and the judge provided legal instructions.

Clancy has entered what’s com-

monly called an insanity plea, which makes the jury considerations more complex than a typical murder case.

Clancy, 36, admitted that she strangled 5-year-old Cora, 3-year-old Dawson, and 8-month-old Callan with exercise bands in the basement of their Duxbury home on Jan. 24, 2023. But she has pleaded not guilty to three counts of first-degree murder, alleging she suffered a postpartum psychotic break and heard a man’s voice telling her to kill the children and her-

self.

Prosecutors allege the slayings were premeditated by Clancy, who was depressed and overwhelmed after the birth of her third child. They assert that she decided to kill herself and take the children with her because she didn’t trust anyone else to care for them.

The judge in the case has instructed the jurors on the applicable law and potential guilty verdicts they may consider: first-degree murder, second-degree murder, or manslaughter for the

slaying of each child.

As in other criminal cases, the burden of proof for a conviction falls on the prosecution.

Here is what the jury must decide to determine criminal responsibility:

First, whether Clancy was suffering from a “mental disease or defect” at the time of the killings.

If they find she was, they then must consider two additional points. Did that mental illness render Clancy unable to appreciate

JURY, Page B3

Healey’s climate chief to resign

Melissa Hoffer to take job leading Vermont law school

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

Melissa Hoffer, a former Biden administration official whom Governor Maura Healey tapped as the nation’s first Cabinet-level climate chief, is leaving her administration to lead the Vermont Law and Graduate School as its next president.

She will begin her new role on Dec. 1, the school announced Thursday.

Healey celebrated Hoffer’s appointment in 2023, which her administration said made Massachusetts the first state in the nation to create such a position.

The job began as a campaign promise during Healey’s first gubernatorial campaign, during which she also set ambitious climate goals to achieve 100 percent clean electricity supply by 2030 and to electrify public transportation with clean power by 2040.

Healey said that creating the position within her inner circle would help foster a “whole-of-government response” to climate change in Massachusetts.

But with President Trump’s return to the White House last year and the rollback of federal climate regulations and funding, the state’s progress in some areas has stalled. Now, Hoffer is preparing to leave as Healey seeks a second term in office on a message that’s increasingly focused on making life here more affordable for residents, including their energy costs.

In a statement Thursday, Healey said Hoffer “has been an extraordinary partner and climate leader for Massachusetts.”

“I knew we needed someone with the expertise, determination and vision to make climate action a whole-of-government priority — and Melissa delivered on that mission,” Healey said.

Healey will name a successor before Hoffer departs, her office said.

Hoffer came to Beacon Hill after stints at the Environmental Protection Agency and the state attorney general’s office, where she led Healey’s lawsuit against ExxonMobil alleging the company deceived the public about climate change risks.

Hoffer, who currently makes \$173,123 a year, **HOFFER, Page B4**



Melissa Hoffer served as the first climate chief.

More Mass. voters ditching party labels

Thousands said to have left

By Kelly Garrity
GLOBE STAFF

Do you want to be a Democrat or Republican? Massachusetts voters are increasingly picking door No. 3: neither.

Both major parties shed thousands of voters over the past 18 months, according to new data from Secretary of State William F. Galvin’s office, continuing voters’ years-long drift away from the political parties and toward a version of independence.

Since early February 2025, more than 46,000 voters have left the Democratic Party, while more than 15,600 decamped from the GOP, according to the data released this week.

The share of registered voters affiliated with each party has slipped, too. Democrats now make up about 24 percent of the state’s more than 5.1 million registered voters. Republicans have fallen below 8 percent, their lowest share since at least 1948. (Official data online doesn’t go back further.)

In turn, the state’s already outsized proportion of unenrolled (or independent) voters has hit a new high, accounting for just over 67 percent of the state’s total. The electorate itself is also growing. Nearly 160,000 voters have been added to the rolls since February 2025, according to the data.

That means there are even more voters who can opt to pull either a Democratic or Republican primary

VOTERS, Page B3

INSIDE

Festival safety

Boston’s police commissioner urged people not to bring weapons, drugs, or alcohol to Saturday’s Jouvvert parade and Caribbean Carnival. **B2**



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Adults and youngsters alike showed off colorful costumes as they marched in the annual Caribbean Carnival parade through Roxbury in August 2025. In previous years, the festivities have been the backdrop for several violent incidents.

Police on alert for Caribbean festivities

Public urged not to bring weapons, alcohol, drugs

By Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Boston Police Commissioner Michael Cox Thursday urged attendees not to bring weapons, drugs, or alcohol to Saturday’s J’ouvert parade and Caribbean Carnival.

“We want to address the over-night activities sometimes associated with these events,” Cox said at a press conference at police headquarters. “Every summer we tend to see most violence associated with late-night parties.”

Cox said public drinking, marijuana use, fireworks, guns, and violence of any kind will not be tolerated at the parade and carnival, which together rank among “the largest cultural events” the city hosts each summer.

Scooters are also prohibited, and the roads around Franklin Park will be closed to traffic and parking.

The Caribbean Carnival, a parade that begins at 1 p.m. at Warren Street and MLK Jr. Boulevard in Roxbury, will travel up Blue Hill Avenue before reaching Franklin Park, Cox said.

The event will have a firm cutoff time of 6 p.m., he said.

The carnival is preceded by another parade, known as J’ouvert, which begins at 6:30 a.m. at Shattuck Hospital, cutting through Franklin Park before ending at 10 a.m. at the parking lot of the Franklin Park Zoo.

In previous years, the morning procession has been the back-



drop for various violent incidents, most notably in 2023 when eight people were wounded from gunfire between two rival groups.

Mayor Michelle Wu and community leaders denounced the violence at the time.

That followed fatal J’ouvert shootings in 2015 and 2014, which also happened in the hours just before or during the parade.

After the 2023 shooting, officials changed the parade route to avoid Talbot Avenue, where some of the previous shootings had taken place, Cox said. Now the festivities cut through Franklin Park, he said.

“Since we’ve moved it from Talbot Avenue, I don’t think we’ve had any incidents associated with it,” Cox said.

The carnival has also been marred by violence. In 2022, a man was killed when a gunman

drove into a crowd and opened fire as people dispersed from the event following an earlier verbal altercation.

The shooter was later sentenced to 15 years in prison, the Globe reported.

Cox said police will continue to implement safety measures during the carnival.

Ahead of the city’s annual Dominican Parade on Aug. 16, Cox made a similar pledge, saying police would be out in force to prevent violence.

After that event concluded, police near Franklin Park apprehended a 20-year-old Dorchester man who was allegedly trying to conceal a loaded gun.

Police reported no violence during the parade.

Cox said that the training that helped officers make that arrest will prove critical again Saturday.

“The goal is for people not to bring [guns] here in the first place,” he said. But “our officers are trained on how to both observe folks that might be having them and then more importantly how to retrieve it from them in a safe way.”

Addressing a rise in stab-bings in the city, Cox said that officers are aware of the threat.

“If you think there are a lot of guns in the world I would say there are exponentially more knives,” he said. “You can make a weapon out of anything. The reality is it’s a choice, and that’s what we’re trying to tell people — don’t make that choice.”

John R. Ellement of the Globe Staff contributed to this report. Bryan Hecht can be reached at bryan.hecht@globe.com. Follow him on Instagram @bhechtjournalism.

Bridgewater couple faces new fraud charges

Pair also accused of GoFundMe account theft

By Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

A Bridgewater couple previously indicted for allegedly stealing nearly \$18,000 from a GoFundMe account they set up for a homeless man is facing 20 new fraud charges in an unrelated scheme to receive benefits they did not qualify for from Social Security, SNAP, and MassHealth, prosecutors said Wednesday.

Rachel Kadis and Brian G. Ferreira are accused of stealing \$267,000 from state and federal programs to acquire “free food and extra income for a more comfortable life,” the office of Plymouth District Attorney Timothy J. Cruz said in a statement.

Kadis, 32, and Ferreira, 34, who have four children, were ineligible to receive the needs-based benefits, prosecutors said.

Kadis and Ferreira were arraigned in Plymouth Superior Court Wednesday. Kadis pleaded not guilty to 17 counts ranging from larceny and forgery to giving false statements.

Ferreira pleaded not guilty to three charges, receiving stolen property, misleading a criminal investigation, and conspiracy to defraud MassHealth, court records show.

They were released on their own recognizance.

Kadis’ court-appointed lawyer said there was no fraud and his client legitimately applied for the benefits after the couple’s “marriage fell apart.”

Ferreira was deployed to Kabul with the US Army, returned with significant PTSD, and the couple broke up, attorney Ryan Matthews said in a telephone interview Wednesday night.

“It’s shameful the way this poor lady has been treated,” he said. “She’s looking forward to her day in court.”

Ferreira’s lawyer did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Before the couple was charged in the GoFundMe case, they were featured in a Boston Globe story published March 24, 2025.

The Globe story profiled Greg Bobst. He was 65 and struggling with chronic homelessness.

The story quoted Kadis saying how her 13-year-old daughter told her about “the man living in a tent,” and how she located Bobst and invited him to

stay in their home during a torrential rainstorm and set up a GoFundMe account for him titled, “Support Greg’s Journey to Stability.”

The story said Kadis worked as a nanny and Ferreira was a disabled Army veteran and robotics engineer who served in Afghanistan.

Fewer than three months after the story was published, Bobst went to Bridgewater police on June 8 to report that the couple was fraudulently raising money under the guise of helping him.

He said the GoFundMe had raised \$17,800 but Kadis and Ferreira wouldn’t give him any of the money.

Bobst died July 1, 2025 without ever receiving any of the funds.

Kadis denied withholding any of the money from Bobst. She told the Globe she could prove that all of the money she raised was either spent helping Bobst, or returned in full to GoFundMe.

The couple was indicted on charges of larceny over \$1,200 by false pretenses, embezzlement, and conspiracy.

They pleaded not guilty in August 2025 and were released on their own recognizance.

The new indictment was handed up Aug. 12.

Prosecutors allege that Kadis posed as an unwed single mother living alone with four children to receive state and federal benefits.

They say she forged the couple’s lease to eliminate Ferreira’s name, gave false sworn testimony and submitted false written statements about her resources, living arrangements, marital status, and family composition to make it appear that she qualified for the benefits.

“In actuality, the investigation found that Ferreira lived with his family, earned a decent income, had employer-provided access to family health benefits, received additional monthly payments from the Veteran’s Administration, and took paid leave to care for his wife and children,” Cruz’s office said.

Investigators estimate the couple allegedly stole \$45,500 from Social Security Income; \$34,600 from the SNAP food assistance program; \$167,000 from MassHealth; \$6,200 from Mass SSI State Supplement Program; \$14,500 from Rental Assistance for Families in Transition.

The couple’s next court date is set for Sept. 28.

Tonya Alanez can be reached at tonya.alanez@globe.com. Follow her @talanez.

Police say 3-year-old shot himself in the arm

By Jane Miller
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A 3-year-old boy accidentally shot himself in the arm while sitting in a parked car Wednesday evening in Hooksett, N.H., police said.

Hooksett police responded to a residence on Whitehall Road about 6:30 p.m. and found the boy inside a car parked in his family’s driveway,

police Captain James Bradley said.

“When our officers arrived, the boy received medical care, and then our Hooksett Fire and Rescue showed up not long after,” said Bradley.

The boy was taken to Elliot Hospital in Manchester for treatment of serious injuries that were not life-threatening, said Bradley.

He was then flown to a hospital in Boston.

“We believe he was med-flighted to Boston just because the Manchester Hospital couldn’t give the intensive care, the pediatric intensive care, that he needed,” said Bradley.

“Right now, all involved parties are cooperating with the police, and it’s still an active criminal investigation,” said Bradley,

referring to the parents of the child.

Police did not disclose whether the parents were present when the shooting took place.

Once the investigation is completed, charges are likely, Bradley said.

Jane Miller can be reached at jane.miller@globe.com.

This day in history

Today is Friday, Aug. 28, the 240th day of 2026. There are 125 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Actor Ken Jenkins is 86. Former MLB manager and player Lou Piniella is 83. Former MLB pitcher Ron Guidry is 76. Former US poet laureate Rita Dove is 74. Artist Ai Weiwei is 69. Olympic gold medal figure skater Scott Hamilton is 68. Actor Jennifer Coolidge is 65. Film director David Fincher is 64. Country singer Shania Twain is 61. “Pokemon” creator Satoshi Tajiri is 61. Actor Jack Black is 57. Hockey Hall of Famer Pierre Turgeon is 57. Olympic gold medal swimmer Janet Evans is 55. Country singer Jake Owen is 45. Country singer LeAnn Rimes is 44. Rock singer Florence Welch of Florence and the Machine is 40. Actor Quvenzhané Wallis is 23.

►In 1845, the first issue of Scientific American magazine

was published; it remains the oldest continuously published magazine in the United States.

►In 1862, the Second Battle of Bull Run began in Prince William County, Va., during the Civil War; the Union army retreated two days later after suffering 14,000 casualties.

►In 1898, pharmacist Caleb Bradham of New Bern, N.C., changed the name of the carbonated beverage he’d created five years earlier from “Brad’s Drink” to “Pepsi-Cola.”

►In 1955, Emmett Till, a Black teenager from Chicago, was abducted from his uncle’s home in Mississippi by two white men after he had allegedly whistled at a white woman four days earlier; he was found dead three days later.

►In 1957, US Senator Strom Thurmond of South Carolina notched the longest speaking filibuster in Senate history (24

hours and 18 minutes), seeking to stall passage of the Civil Rights Act. (Democratic US Senator Cory Booker of New Jersey delivered the longest continuous Senate floor speech from March 31 to April 1, 2025, speaking 25 hours and 5 minutes against President Donald Trump.)

►In 1963, during the March on Washington, the Rev. Martin Luther King Jr. delivered his “I Have a Dream” speech before an estimated 250,000 people in front of the Lincoln Memorial.

►In 1968, police and anti-war demonstrators clashed in the streets of Chicago as the Democratic National Convention nominated Hubert H. Humphrey for president.

►In 1988, 70 people were killed when three Italian Air Force stunt planes collided during an air show at the US air base in Ramstein, West Germany.

►In 2005, New Orleans Mayor Ray Nagin ordered a mandatory evacuation as Hurricane Katrina approached the city.

►In 2013, a military jury sentenced Army Major Nidal Hasan to death for a 2009 shooting rampage at Fort Hood that claimed 13 lives and left 30 people injured.

►In 2015, a jury in Concord, N.H., acquitted Owen Labrie, a graduate of St. Paul’s School, of rape but convicted him of committing lesser sex offenses against a 15-year-old freshman girl in a case that exposed a tradition in which seniors competed to see how many younger students they could have sex with.

►In 2016, six scientists completed a yearlong Mars simulation on the Big Island of Hawaii, where they emerged after living in a dome in near isolation on Mauna Loa.

The Boston Globe

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Lottery

THURSDAY MIDDAY 0457
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)
EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits \$5,666
First or last 3 \$793
Any 2 digits \$68
Any 1 digit \$7

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits \$236
First 3 \$132
Last 3 \$132

THURSDAY NIGHT 9070
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)
EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits \$5,389
First or last 3 \$754
Any 2 digits \$65
Any 1 digit \$6

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits \$449
First 3 \$126
Last 3 \$251

MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE
Aug. 26 3-25-51-54-56
Millionaire Ball 4

Jackpot: \$1 million per year; no winners
MASS CASH
Aug. 27 1-3-13-22-32
Jackpot: \$100,000; winners
MEGABUCKS
Aug. 26 1-6-19-28-31-32
Jackpot: \$28.3 million; no winners
PREVIOUS DRAWINGS

Midday Night

Wednesday 3419 1195
Tuesday 6385 6159
Monday 4371 3601

THURSDAY NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND
Maine, N.H., Vermont
Day: 3-digit 546 4-digit 8316
Eve: 3-digit 144 4-digit 9394
Wed. Tri-State Megabucks
16-20-25-26-30-6
Rhode Island 3852
Wednesday's Powerball
12-32-45-50-58
Powerball 2

Jury will weigh starkly conflicting arguments

►CLANCY
Continued from Page B1

children because “it was what she had to do to end her misery.”

The prosecutor argued that Clancy’s claim that she suddenly heard a man’s voice telling her to kill her children and herself, just after sending her husband, Patrick, to pick up medication for their daughter and takeout for dinner, “makes no sense.”

She told jurors it’s “red flag” that Clancy claims that she only heard the voice once and immediately obeyed it, without locking herself in a bathroom, calling for help, or alerting her husband when he called her from a nearby pharmacy minutes after leaving their house.

She argued that Clancy demonstrated control, judgment, and deliberate premeditation as she decided which child to kill first, what weapon to use, and where to do it.

She said Clancy was “completely indifferent” to the suffering of her children in the moment as she strangled them with exercise bands.

“She didn’t see them in that moment as human beings” with rights, dreams, and futures, Sprague said. Her voice cracked with emotion as she added, that after killing the children, Clancy left them “discarded” on the basement floor “like broken toys.”

Clancy, 36, who sat quietly with her hands folded on the defense table in front of her during most of closing arguments, began crying as Sprague described the suffering of her children and the confusion they must have felt as she hurt them.

Clancy has admitted killing her children but has pleaded not guilty, asserting an insanity defense. She has argued she was in the throes of a postpartum psychotic episode and should not be held criminally responsible.

On Thursday, Reddington, urged jurors to focus on evidence that Clancy was a loving and dedicated mother whose mental health began to deteriorate in September 2022 when she sought help for



Lindsay Clancy and her attorney, Kevin Reddington, listened to closing arguments from prosecutor Jennifer Sprague in court Thursday. Below, Judge William Sullivan held up the jury slip as he gave jurors final instructions.

postpartum depression, anxiety, and insomnia four months after the birth of her third child.

He rattled off the names of more than two dozen medications she was prescribed in the months leading up to the slayings and cited journals, texts, and medical records that showed her mental health deteriorated.

Clancy complained to medical providers about intrusive thoughts and suicidal ideation, made two trips to emergency rooms, called suicide hot lines twice, and voluntarily checked herself into McLean Hospital for five days weeks before the slayings.

“My God, what does she have to do?” Reddington asked jurors. “She was reaching out for help and she’s not getting it.”

Sprague countered that “it wasn’t the fault of the



PHOTOS BY GREG DERR/THE PATRIOT LEDGER/POOL

If jury members choose ‘guilty,’ they have several options

►JURY
Continued from Page B1

the wrongfulness of her actions, or unable to conform her conduct to the law? For example, if someone is delusional, they might be complying with voices in their head rather than acting of their own volition, a claim Clancy’s attorney has raised.

The burden is on the prosecution to convince the jurors that neither of those scenarios apply. Prosecutors have asserted that Clancy was able to con-

trol her actions and understood that they were wrong. Simply having a “mental disease or defect” is not enough to not establish a lack of criminal responsibility.

If the jury decides she should not be held criminally responsible, Clancy would then be committed to a state psychiatric hospital. She would be evaluated periodically and could be released some day if authorities conclude she doesn’t pose a threat to the community.

If the jury decides she should not be held criminally responsible, Lindsay Clancy would then be committed to a state psychiatric hospital. She would be evaluated periodically.

If the jury agrees with the prosecution — even if she was suffering from a mental illness — then they will choose her lev-

el of culpability.

A first-degree murder conviction, which carries a mandatory life without parole sen-

tence, would mean jurors rejected the entirety of the defense’s case. Second-degree would mean they found Clancy was culpable, but the killings weren’t premeditated; it carries a life sentence with the possibility of parole. And manslaughter would indicate a determination that Clancy should be held responsible for the deaths because her actions were “wanton or reckless.”

A manslaughter verdict would carry a maximum sen-

providers” that Clancy was struggling, arguing “they were doing the best they could with the information she provided them.”

She urged jurors to consider evidence that Clancy didn’t take all of the medications she was prescribed, and didn’t tell the psychiatrist and nurse practitioner who were treating her that she was hearing voices or had thoughts of harming her children.

Reddington urged jurors to look at records presented during the trial that show Clancy was googling various medications she had been prescribed as she suspected they were making her worse.

He also urged jurors to credit the testimony of Dr. Phillip Resnick, a renowned psychiatrist with expertise in postpartum disorders and malingering, or fabricating symptoms. He evaluated Clancy for the defense four months after the slayings and concluded that she was suffering from “postpartum psychosis” when she killed her children.

The judge instructed jurors that the burden is on prosecutors to prove beyond a reasonable doubt that Clancy was not suffering from a mental disease or defect, or if she was, she was able to appreciate the wrongfulness of her actions and conform her behavior to the requirements of the law.

During closing arguments, the prosecutor pushed for first-degree murder convictions, while the defense argued Clancy is not guilty based on lack of criminal responsibility due to her mental illness.

Sprague cited the suffering and confusion of the children as “their mom is the one that’s killing them,” telling jurors, “that’s extreme atrocity and cruelty.”

Reddington argued, “This woman is not guilty for killing her children because she was suffering from a disease, and they are not going to be able to prove otherwise.”

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tence of 20 years in prison for each conviction, but there is no required minimum.

Plymouth Superior Court Judge William Sullivan would ultimately decide the sentence, likely after a sentencing hearing.

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Thousands of Mass. voters have ditched party labels ahead of primary

►VOTERS
Continued from Page B1

ballot on Tuesday. Galvin said at a Thursday news conference that he expects turnout for the primaries to be similar to, if not slightly exceed, that from the 2022 primaries.

He projected that 800,000 people would vote in the Democratic primary, headlined by the US Senate matchup between Senator Ed Markey and Representative Seth Moulton, with more than 270,000 having already cast ballots as of Thursday.

Galvin said he expected 280,000 to weigh in on the GOP primary, whose marquee matchup is the fight for the party’s gubernatorial nomination between Michael Minogue and Brian Shortleeve. As of Thursday, 73,000 voters had already voted in that primary, which Galvin said was slightly ahead of the pace from four years ago.

With fewer registered voters in each party, however, there are also fewer dyed-in-the-wool party-goers that can participate in caucuses, help fill local political committees, or hit state conventions.

Party leaders say they aren’t pressing the panic button.

Despite the tens of thousands



Secretary of State William Galvin projected that 800,000 people would vote in the Democratic primary on Tuesday. More than 270,000 have already cast ballots as of Thursday, he said.

of voters leaving the party, state Democratic Party chair Steve Kerrigan said he’s “heartened” that when Massachusetts voters do cast ballots, they “are voting overwhelmingly for Democrats

in Massachusetts.” (Democrats hold every statewide elected office, every seat in the state’s congressional delegation, and super majorities in both chambers of the state Legislature.)

Still, Kerrigan acknowledged that “partisan politics has become a pretty ugly business.”

“Average, every-day voters out there are trying to find leaders to vote for who are going to

try to solve their problems,” he said.

Republicans, meanwhile, are putting their own spin on the numbers.

“Voters are tired of the extremism, dysfunction, and corruption that have defined one-party rule in Massachusetts for too long,” Haley Jones, the executive director of the state Republican Party, said in a statement. “Party registration is changing because Massachusetts is changing. Voters are looking for something different.”

The rise of the independent voter in Massachusetts isn’t new. The share of voters without a party affiliation has been climbing for years, something that’s been borne out on the ballot. Many of the Republicans running for statewide office, for example, had left the party and only re-enrolled with the GOP shortly before they launched their campaigns.

But the latest exodus comes amid a broader wave of anti-institutional sentiment, said Peter Ubertaino, a Stonehill College political scientist.

“There’s not a lot of public trust in a whole slew of institutions, and political parties are not immune to that,” Ubertaino said.

There are also a few less existential explanations. Massachusetts’ primary system gives unenrolled voters more options. They can walk into the voting booth on Election Day and choose which party’s primary they want to participate in. Registered Democrats and Republicans? They’re locked into pulling their party’s ballot unless they change their registration ahead of time.

Also a factor: a 2018 law that automatically registers eligible residents to vote when they get or renew their driver’s licenses, or join state health insurance. The law has pushed thousands of people on the rolls without a party designation.

If the broader trend away from party affiliation continues, there’s a chance it could eventually change more than just the registration numbers.

“I would expect to see more conversation about the way that we structure our election,” Ubertaino said.

Case in point: the so-called all-party primary ballot question set to go before voters in November that would eliminate party primaries as we know it.

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State Climate Chief Melissa Hoffer, pictured in 2024 during a visit to the greenhouse at Eastie Farm in East Boston, saw her role as a place to advance the governor's climate goals.

Healey’s climate chief to resign

►**HOFFER**
Continued from Page B1

saw her job in state government as a means to collaborate with other state agencies and aim to find ways they could play a role in advancing the governor's climate goals.

She prepared a 90-page report of recommendations for the administration, an edict that was spelled out in the executive order creating her position.

“It’s important to have somebody who is within the governor’s office, who’s been tasked and directed specifically by the governor to undertake this task,” Hoffer told the Globe in a 2023 interview. “It gives us not only authority, but it gives us tremendous responsibility.”

In her time as climate chief, Hoffer worked on financing the transition to clean energy in the state, established a disaster and relief fund during the 2023 Connecticut River floods, and launched the state's first Youth Climate Council. Healey recently named the state’s first ex-

treme heat chief, presented as a response to soaring temperatures across the world.

In a statement Thursday, Hoffer said she is “honored and thrilled” to start her new position at the Vermont Law and Graduate School, and that “the institution is uniquely positioned to lead in this time of momentous and intersecting challenges.”

State Senator Michael Barrett, a Lexington Democrat who helped author the state's ambitious 2021 and 2022 climate laws, said he is “sad to see” Hoffer leaving, especially in the wake of the Department of Public Utilities chair Jamie Van Nostrand’s departure to the University of Pennsylvania last year.

“She has been fiercely committed to steering a steady course on this climate stuff,” he said. “She is not one of these folks who trims her sails as soon as the going gets complicated.”

Barrett said that her departure is a signal to him that the

Healey administration failed to empower Hoffer, including giving her more staff and statutory powers.

“I don’t think the climate chief was given the tools she needed,” said Barrett, who chairs the Telecommunications, Utilities and Energy Committee.

Before her work at the attorney general’s office, Hoffer worked at the Conservation Law Foundation and was an environmental lawyer at Wilmer-Hale.

Rishi Reddi, Massachusetts’ vice president at the Conservation Law Foundation, said in a statement that Hoffer was “dedicated to holistically aligning all of state government against the escalating damage of climate change at a time when that work was never more important — and never more under attack.”

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Boston-bound Delta flight diverted over sick captain

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

The captain of the Delta Air Lines flight that diverted en route to Boston on Tuesday experienced “stomach pains” before the plane made an emergency landing, a Delta spokesperson said.

The copilot of the Boston-bound flight from Los Angeles stepped in to land the plane at Detroit Metropolitan Wayne County Airport, Delta spokesperson Drake Castañeda said.

The captain, whom Delta did not identify, radioed air traffic control to say he needed to land the plane, according to an audio recording posted on Facebook by Flight Simulator Fantasy, which tracks real air traffic control audio recordings, the Globe previously reported.

The plane made an emergency landing at 5:43 p.m.

“This is the captain; I’m the one that’s ill,” he said in the audio. “I’m going to taxi the jet to the gate, and then I need to go to the hospital.”

The Globe previously reported that firefighters in Detroit re-



MICHAEL DWYER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

On Tuesday, the captain of the diverted Delta flight radioed air traffic control to say he needed to land the plane.

sponded to a report of a person having a medical situation on the flight and took the individual to the hospital.

The pilot was replaced in Detroit, and the rest of the flight crew reboarded the plane, Castañeda said. It was carrying 147 passengers and took off again at 7:17 p.m., before landing at Logan International Airport at 9:04 p.m.

“We apologize to our customers for this disruption in their travels,” Delta wrote in a

statement.

Delta did not provide additional details about the captain’s condition. A spokesperson for the Massachusetts Port Authority, which operates Logan, said officials there did not have more information on the matter.

Correspondent Adam Sennott contributed to this report. Diti Kohli can be reached at diti.kohli@globe.com. Follow her @ditikohli_.

Firefighter faces child endangerment charge

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF

An Andover firefighter has been placed on leave as he faces charges of child endangerment and assault in Londonderry, N.H., after an infant was brought to a hospital with injuries, according to officials and court records.

Adam Cole, 33, of Londonderry, surrendered to local police on Tuesday and was arraigned in Derry District Court on charges of endangering the welfare of a child and second-degree assault on a person under 13, court records show. He pleaded not guilty and was re-

leased on \$5,000 bail.

Records show the charges stem from an investigation that began in July when the state’s Division for Children, Youth and Families notified Londonderry police of a 3-month-old who was brought to a hospital after having a seizure and was later found to have a brain bleed.

The child was admitted to Boston Children’s Hospital, where it was determined the injuries were likely “non-accidental,” according to court records.

An attorney for Cole could not immediately be reached for comment. He is due back in

court Sept. 23.

Police said Cole is a firefighter in Andover. In a statement, Andover officials said they are “aware of the circumstances involving an Andover firefighter” and have “placed the employee on administrative leave pending further review.”

“The town respects the legal process and, because this involves an ongoing criminal proceeding and personnel matter, will not provide further comment at this time,” the statement said.

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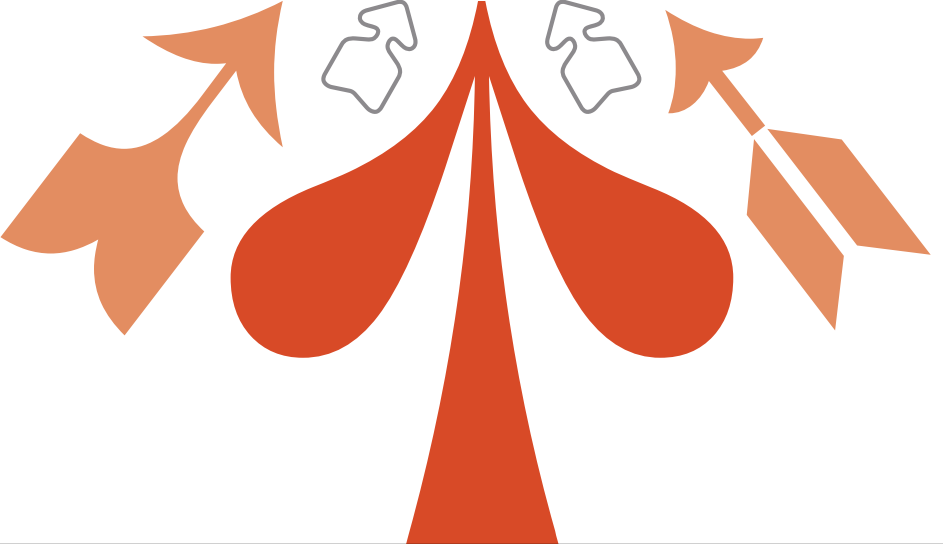
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Business

Daisy Chain delight

A partnership with Olivia Rodrigo has catapulted this New Hampshire Etsy artist into the spotlight



PHOTOS BY JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Kaylie Lathrop showed off the pressed floral bookmarks made in collaboration with musician Olivia Rodrigo for the Daisy Chain music festival.



Kaylie Lathrop said, “I was like, ‘There’s no way Olivia Rodrigo saw my bookmarks.’”

By Karyna Cheung
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

For New Hampshire native Kaylie Lathrop, the opportunity of a lifetime began in May with a vague message from Etsy about the chance to work with an unnamed “talent.” “It was just, ‘Hey, we have this opportunity for you to work with a talent,’” said Lathrop, who runs an Etsy shop selling handmade floral bookmarks and other bookish accessories from her home in Rochester. “I was really busy at the time, so I was like, I don’t know if I even have time to take something like this on.” She decided to respond anyway, and when Etsy asked her to sign a nondisclosure agreement, she realized the project might be “a little bigger” than she initially thought. On an ensuing video call, she learned the “talent” was musician Olivia Rodrigo. “I nearly passed out,” Lathrop said. “I was like, ‘There’s no way Olivia Rodrigo saw my bookmarks.’” Lathrop’s business, Kaylie Reads, was one of 10 women-owned small businesses on Etsy that Rodrigo selected to create merchandise for her all-women Daisy Chain Fields Music Festival in Irvine, Calif., on Aug. 29. The sold-out festival is widely seen as a successor to Sarah McLachlan’s Lilith Fair festivals in the 1990s and 2000s

ETSY, Page B7

TRENDLINES

Higher ed crisis also hits the workforce

Several factors take toll on employment

By Larry Edelman
GLOBE COLUMNIST

Higher education in Massachusetts is stuck in a vice. Hostile Trump administration policies, the looming demographic decline in high school graduates, and a growing perception that a college degree isn’t worth the money are cranking it tighter. This month, as part of The Boston Globe’s “Mass. Mojo” series examining the challenges facing the Massachusetts economy, reporter Diti Kohli detailed how colleges and universities are turning “what were once career jobs into de facto temporary positions they can cycle in and out as the budget demands.” The result: higher ed employment in the state inched lower last year, the first decline since 2018 except for the pandemic year of 2020. But the turmoil poses another, harder-to-quantify downside for the region’s economy. Trump’s cuts to federal research funding, along with new restrictions on student loans and international student visas, threaten to shrink the pipeline of highly educated graduates that has long given Massachusetts a

TRENDLINES, Page B6



JOHN TLUMACKI/BOSTON GLOBE/FILE

Encore Boston Harbor casino in Everett has attracted a higher-end, “luxury” clientele since it opened in 2019.

Contract talks with unions stall as Encore casino faces competition, slow growth

Revenue has dipped each of the last two years, but profits remain strong

By Karyna Cheung
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

As contract negotiations with some 1,300 employees stall out and a strike looms at Encore Boston Harbor casino in Everett, union workers argue that the casino resort has the money to pay them more. But is that really true? Overall, Encore and its operator, Las Vegas-based Wynn Resorts, have

been more financially stable than many other gaming operators. But brick-and-mortar casinos face a variety of pressures from growing land-based competition and mounting online gambling options. And Encore is not immune. With \$847 million in revenue last year, Encore is by far the largest casino in Massachusetts, and has been since

ENCORE, Page B8

POWER PLAY

Healey administration gets a 2nd chance on rest stops

Bidding process differs greatly from original plan that fell apart last year

By Jon Chesto
GLOBE STAFF

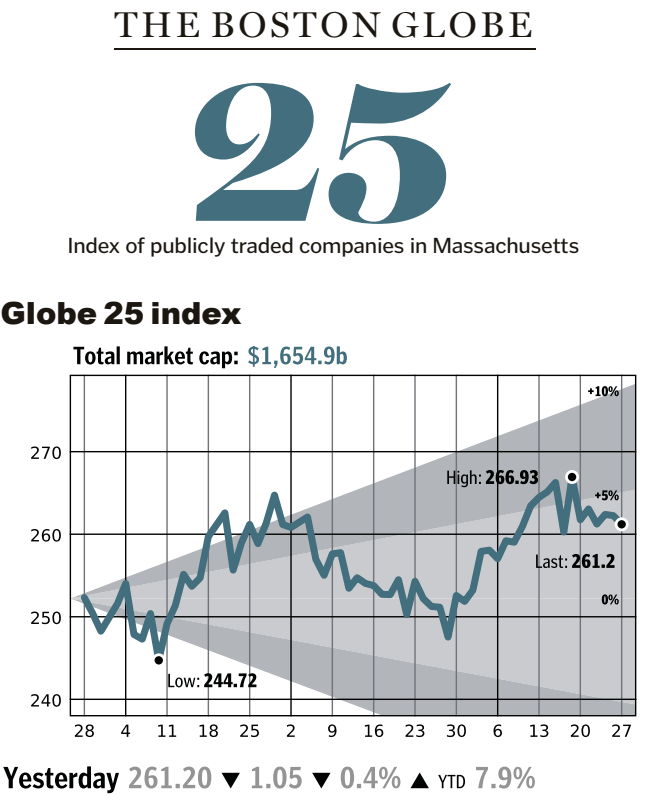
After Massachusetts highway officials spent two hours outlining their plan to redo 18 service plazas, the head of a newly reassembled state commission summed it up with four words. “It’s a stark change.” That must have been music to the ears of the MassDOT execs gathered in Worcester on Monday to start the bidding process for the plaza projects. Kevin Sullivan, who chairs the Public-Private Partnership Commission, was referring to changes between the RFPs his panel received this week for its evaluation and the ill-fated plaza

procurement that crashed and burned a year ago. In other words: Governor Maura Healey has a good shot to get it right this time. There’s a lot riding on this for MassDOT after the botched first effort. Most of these plazas — 11 on the Pike and seven in other spots — badly need to be renovated or rebuilt. We’re talking hundreds of millions of dollars, if not \$1 billion-plus, in investment. Truckers want better parking; EV drivers want additional chargers. Motorists crave more food options. And small businesses desire new places to peddle their wares.

POWER PLAY, Page B6



Get in the loop with a twice-weekly dive into the power players and moves driving business in Massachusetts. Sign up for The Boston Globe’s scoop-driven Power Play newsletter, authored by prominent Globe columnists Shirley Leung and Jon Chesto.

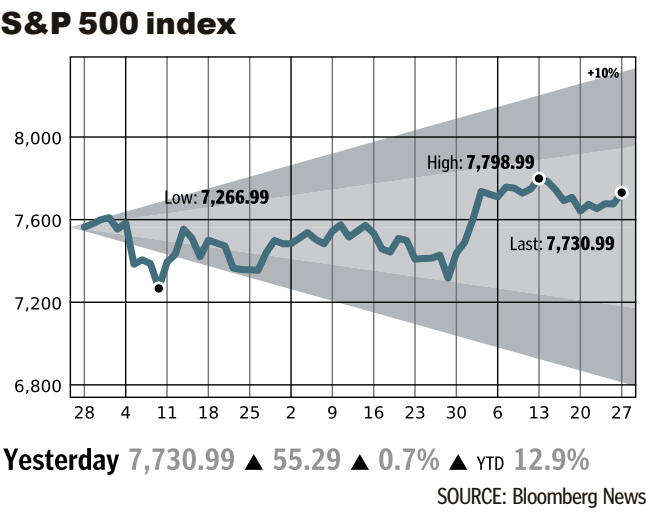
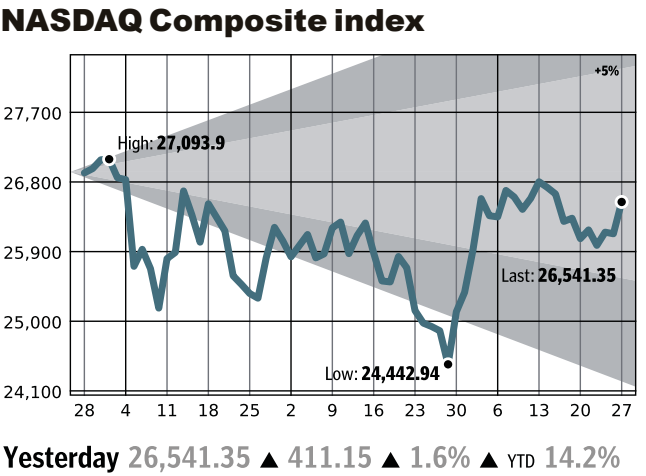
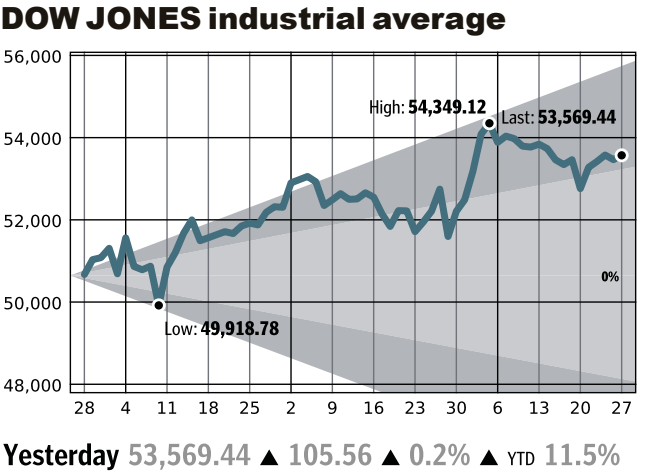


	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	953.83	+0.74	+0.1	254.0
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	630.70	-3.01	-0.5	233.2
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	374.52	+2.72	+0.7	181.5
TJX COS INC (TJX)	134.22	-2.61	-1.9	148.3
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	547.55	+0.26	+0.0	138.8
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	174.16	-1.57	-0.9	81.2
BOSTON SCIENTIFC (BSX)	46.67	-1.50	-3.1	67.6
TERADYNE INC (TER)	372.06	+8.97	+2.5	58.2
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	142.77	-6.89	-4.6	57.0
STATE ST CORP (STT)	193.37	-0.25	-0.1	53.1
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	31.88	-0.33	-1.0	43.4
WATERS CORP (WAT)	421.26	+7.09	+1.7	41.4
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	122.69	+1.26	+1.0	36.5
BIOGEN INC (BIIB)	221.50	+0.43	+0.2	32.7
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	236.56	-2.44	-1.0	31.7
EVERSOURCE ENERG (ES)	70.92	-0.75	-1.0	26.7
SYMBOTIC INC (SYM)	41.14	+0.53	+1.3	24.9
VERALTO CORP (VLT)	98.37	-0.32	-0.3	24.0
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	145.51	+3.05	+2.1	22.2
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	277.15	+4.49	+1.6	21.2
MKS INC (MKS)	270.99	-0.76	-0.3	18.3
PTC INC (PTC)	158.95	+7.34	+4.8	17.2
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	311.81	-1.86	-0.6	16.5
AKAMAI TECHNOLOG (AKAM)	111.24	+3.18	+2.9	16.0
VICOR CORP (VICR)	203.64	+6.41	+3.2	9.4

Markets

Nvidia, Salesforce power rally

Technology stocks led Wall Street on Thursday after Nvidia, Salesforce, and others reported even fatter profits for the spring than analysts expected. Nvidia was the strongest force pulling the market higher, and the chip giant rallied 8.7 percent after once again delivering stronger profit and revenue for the latest quarter than analysts expected. More importantly for Wall Street, it also gave forecasts for upcoming revenue growth that topped analysts' estimates, suggesting demand remains strong for chips to power AI projects. "AI has reached its inflection point," Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang said. "It's doing useful work. Its tokens are productive and profitable." That helped calm some of the worries that have built around AI stocks generally, which have been under pressure recently. Another big tech company, Salesforce, jumped 22.6 percent after it said that AI helped it deliver one of its best quarters in history. Salesforce, which helps companies manage their customers' data, also raised its forecast for revenue over the full year. It's notable because Salesforce's stock struggled earlier on worries that competitors powered by AI could ultimately steal away customers. — ASSOCIATED PRESS



Moderna to raise, reinvest \$2b

By Kelly Gilblom and Charles Capel

BLOOMBERG

Moderna Inc. plans to raise \$2 billion from selling notes that can be exchanged for shares, which it will use to invest in its cancer vaccine business and repay debt.

The Cambridge-based biotechnology company will sell \$2 billion worth of convertible senior notes due in 2032, with an option to sell a further \$300 million, according to a statement Thursday.

Moderna shares soared 177 percent on Aug. 19 — a record one-day jump that added \$44.5 billion to its market value — af-

ter the company announced positive results from a late-stage trial of a personalized mRNA vaccine developed with Merck & Co.

With Moderna's stock now trading near the more than three-year high reached last week, the company can set a higher conversion price for the notes. Fewer shares will be issued later if the debt converts, reducing future dilution for existing stockholders.

Companies often time convertible offerings after a stock spike to lock in cheaper financing while investor enthusiasm is high.

The timing was right for Moderna, which has been burn-

ing capital as it develops bespoke cancer treatments using mRNA. It reported a \$1.97 loss per share in the second quarter, with about \$1.72 billion in cash on hand. The company is banking on success in oncology to diversify away from respiratory shots.

Moderna's shares fell 4.6 percent in Thursday trading.

The biotech company became a Wall Street darling after developing an mRNA COVID shot that helped contain the global pandemic that killed millions starting in 2020. Analysts and scientists saw the technology underpinning the vaccine as a major medical breakthrough,

which had the potential to prevent diseases from influenza to lung cancer. At its peak in 2021, Moderna was worth more than \$175 billion.

Since then, sales of its COVID vaccine plummeted and many newer shots have disappeared. An immunization approved to prevent respiratory syncytial virus failed to gain traction and its norovirus vaccine study didn't meet the statistical criteria for early success in July.

Even after its huge stock leap earlier this month, the company is still less than a third of its size compared to the height of the pandemic.

State gets a 2nd chance on rest stops

►POWER PLAY

Continued from Page B5

It's hard to forget how round one fell apart. In June 2025, MassDOT awarded plaza redevelopment rights to Irish retailer Applegreen (backed by private equity firm Blackstone) and Suffolk Construction, its well-connected local contractor. In less time than it takes to get past the Bowker Overpass, losing bidder Global Partners cried foul with a full-force PR, lobbying, and legal campaign to paint the process as insider-dealing run amok.

After three hectic months, Applegreen gave up. MassDOT negotiations over the details were hitting impasses. The Global campaign, and the questions it raised, didn't help. Healey's transportation secretary, Monica Tibbits-Nutt, was on the way out, leaving a mess for successor Phil Eng to clean up. The Senate's post audit and oversight committee got involved, as did Inspector General Jeff Shapiro — never a good sign.

Now, responsibility for a new road forward goes to Undersecretary Jonathan Gulliver, Eng's lieutenant.

Healey revived the P3 Commission, a Deval Patrick-era creation that disappeared after it toyed with ideas like using tolls to finance new Cape Cod bridges.

MassDOT determined that to offer a 35-year ground lease for operations along with a "design-build approach" in which contractors get involved early, the law requires P3 Commission oversight. Sullivan, now at Babson College, got called back into state service to chair the reborn commission. (He was transportation and then budget secretary in the Cellucci and Swift administrations.)

So what's so different now? The P3 Commission is new. But so are reviews by Shapiro's office — MassDOT is incorporating his recommendations — and by Attorney General Andrea Campbell. It will likely take two months or so for these to be complete, before final bids go out; winners could be picked five or six months later. That means a big time crunch before the plaza leases expire in mid-2027, so don't be surprised if



ABOVE: BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE/2025; BELOW: JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF/FILE/2025

The Charlton Service Plaza on the westbound side of the Massachusetts Turnpike.



Governor Maura Healey has a lot riding on the new effort to revitalize the rest areas on the Mass. Pike and elsewhere.

those get extended.

MassDOT has now split the plazas into three geographic clusters — west, central, and east, essentially — in the hopes of drawing more competing bids.

The state's financial return will count for 60 percent of the bid evaluation scorecard, much more than last time, with the most weight given to the annual guaranteed rent. "Technical" factors, such as team experience and redevelopment vision, will make up the rest. One MassDOT team will evaluate finances, another will score technical factors. A third will consider the results and pick the winner.

The harder question to answer now: Who

will bid?

Neither Suffolk nor Applegreen want to share their plans at this point.

Global is poised to jump back in. The Newton-based fuel supplier is already a subtenant at the turnpike plazas, operating stores and gas stations, and runs four others outright. Senior vice president Max Slifka says Global has a "Massachusetts-rooted team" ready to reimagine and modernize the plazas, and will evaluate each RFP to decide which cluster to bid on.

If all goes to plan, others will be in the mix. MassDOT drew around 100 people to Ten Park Plaza in March for an "industry day" to discuss the contest. Applegreen and Global were there. So were Nouria, Race-Trac, Irving Oil, and Love's Travel Stops. Plus, a cavalcade of construction contractors: Commodore, Consigli, Gilbane (to name a few), and, of course, Suffolk.

Sure, the state's first-ever P3 project represents a great business opportunity. But it also represents a chance for Healey to put the politically problematic squabbles from round one into the rearview mirror.

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Higher ed crisis also hits workforce

►TRENDLINES

Continued from Page B5

competitive edge over other states.

The Legislature, par for the course, doesn't seem overly concerned. For more than a year it's been weighing a \$400 million bill filed by Governor Maura Healey to support higher ed research.

Why it matters: Massachusetts plays an outsize role in national research and development.

For every 1,000 Massachusetts residents, 52 work in the R&D ecosystem, the highest per-capita level in the country, according to a report earlier this year by the Donahue Institute at UMass Amherst.

Many of those workers were educated at local schools, and the state's ability to retain them is crucial to maintaining a top-notch labor force.

"You need to produce highly competent graduates, particularly in [science, technology, engineering, and math] that can fill the jobs that Massachusetts needs," Marty Meehan, president of the University of Massachusetts system, told me.

The US Census Bureau estimates that domestic outmigration from Massachusetts is largely driven by 25–34-year-olds. Preserving federal research funding and creating more opportunities for graduates would help keep them in the state's workforce.

Catch up: The legal fight over research funding cuts has been

messy, creating chaos for schools and other research organizations.

The White House plan to reduce allowable overhead expenses — which typically cover 25 to 45 percent of a grant — to 15 percent was blocked in court, and Congress largely rejected the president's proposed National Institutes of Health budget reductions.

But the Supreme Court last August affirmed the administration's authority to eliminate more than \$780 million of NIH grants in areas it didn't like, such as diversity, COVID, and transgender health. Now, Trump is pushing a proposal that would require all federal grants to be approved by political appointees and "demonstrably advance the president's policy priorities."

Local angle: At the NIH, 722 out of 820 Massachusetts grants have been restored after initial cancellations that began last year, according to Grant Witness, which tracks funding flows.

But Grant Witness data show a 23 percent drop in NIH grants in the current fiscal year compared with an average of the same period in the prior four years.

Wait, there's more: The One Big Beautiful Bill Act included broad changes to the federal student loan system that could make borrowing more expensive and discourage some people from attending college or grad school.



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE 2023

University of Massachusetts system president Marty Meehan said people need to see the impact of US research policies.

Two provisions of particular concern to Massachusetts schools: new loan caps for graduate and professional students — which a federal judge blocked in June — and elimination of a program that allowed them to borrow without limits.

Last month, the administration changed a longstanding policy for international student visas, limiting how long students can stay in the country without approval from the federal government. The move has been challenged in court.

"It's a terrible policy," UMass's Meehan said. "Our university and the Massachusetts economy rely heavily on international students."

Inaction: Healey's bill would ease some of the pain caused by Washington.

Half the \$400 million from the Discovery, Research and Innovation for a Vibrant Economy Initiative would go to support research at hospitals, universities, and independent research institutions, while the rest would go to public colleges.

Lawmakers cut Healey's so-called DRIVE request in half and tucked it into a big econom-

ic development package that is still being hashed out in conference committee as the formal session winds down.

"I think too many folks in Massachusetts don't understand the economic impact [of Trump's policies] on our research infrastructure in the state," Meehan said. "They don't see the urgency."

The UMass Chan Medical School would be a likely beneficiary of the DRIVE money.

Final thought: The Legislature's complacency is dangerous.

Other states are hitting the gas to make their economies more competitive. Last November, Texas voters approved a ballot measure committing \$3 billion to brain disease research over the next decade. Similar measures are under discussion in New York and California.

To be sure, the research funding picture could improve dramatically after Trump leaves office. But as we've already seen, he can cause a lot of damage in a short period of time.

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Canada offers Harvard, MIT scholars funds to transfer

By Nojoud Al Mallees
BLOOMBERG

Canada has awarded 64 global scholars with \$362 million in funding to relocate their work to Canadian universities and advance projects in areas such as health and artificial intelligence.

Some 48 of the researchers were poached from the US, including from elite institutions such as Harvard University and the Massachusetts Institute of Technology. The other 16 researchers are coming from 12 other countries, including the UK, Germany, China, and Japan.

“While certain countries are cutting research and turning their back on academic freedom, we’re doubling down on science and we’re doubling down on research,” Industry Minister Melanie Joly said in Vancouver on Thursday.

Canada’s effort to lure top research talent contrasts with recent US federal funding cuts that, com-



CHRISTIAN KANTOSKY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Canada has poached nearly 50 researchers from the US, including from such elite schools as MIT and Harvard (above).

bined with tightening immigration policies and clashes between the Trump administration and top-tier universities, have led some scholars to look for opportunities elsewhere.

Joly noted that 23 of the research chairs are also Canadians returning home.

The announcement is part of an

initiative Prime Minister Mark Carney’s government unveiled last year to boost Canadian universities, earmarking \$1.2 billion over 12 years to recruit more than 1,000 researchers. The bulk of that money — \$720 million — was dedicated to attracting as many as 100 world-leading research chairs to schools across the country.

Robert Asselin, chief executive officer of U15 Canada, which represents the country’s leading research universities, said the government’s ability to attract these scholars reflects the strength of Canada’s post-secondary institutions. He also said policy changes in the US left scientists feeling less supported, helping Canada’s effort to attract them.

“That was absolutely a reason why they wanted to come to Canada. So we seized the opportunity and I’m really happy this happened,” Asselin said.

Among the new research chairs

is Sara Seager, a renowned planetary scientist whom the University of Toronto already announced would be leaving MIT to return to her alma mater. Canada has also signed MIT professor James LeBeau, a materials scientist.

Brian Kuhlman, a researcher from the University of North Carolina Chapel Hill, whose work was referenced in connection with the 2024 Nobel Prize in Chemistry, will be joining the University of British Columbia as a research chair.

Also heading to UBC is Curtis Huttenhower, a professor of computational biology and bioinformatics at Harvard whose research focuses on the intersection of microbes and human health.

The Canadian government also promised last year an accelerated immigration pathway for H-1B visa holders after the Trump administration decided to charge \$100,000 for the visas. It has yet to roll out that program.

Other major world economies are also seeking to attract top scholars open to leaving the US. The European Union has also launched its own \$583 million initiative to attract global researchers and scientists.

The new research chairs will receive funding over eight years to work on projects in priority fields set out by the Canadian government, including in health, advanced digital technologies, and the environment.

“New chairs and their teams will advance transformational research projects that can be applied and/or commercialized by connecting with receptors in industry, government, and society, while also developing the next generation of highly qualified personnel,” the government said about the initiative last year.

The government is set to announce the next round of chairs in the coming months.

Contract talks with Encore unions stall

►ENCORE
Continued from Page B5

its opening in 2019. It employs more than 3,000 workers, nearly half of whom are unionized. And between wages and benefits, their compensation averages more than \$95,000 per year, more than the average job in Boston, according to Encore.

But workers say their compensation doesn’t match other unionized hotel workers in Greater Boston, and they’re pushing for wage hikes: an additional \$10 per hour over three years for non-tipped employees, and \$5 per hour for tipped workers. In talks over a new contract, the unions — UNITE HERE Local 26 and Teamsters Local 25 — say Encore is offering increases of less than half those amounts.

Encore claims labor costs at the casino resort have outpaced growth in revenue and inflation since 2022, and revenue at the casino has dipped about 1 percent each of the last two years, according to Wynn’s securities filings.

Why? Well, the gaming industry is changing.

New industry pressures are adding variables to the equation for casinos. The biggest threat to Encore’s business, per Wynn’s SEC filings, is competition from other casinos in New England, notably Connecticut and Rhode Island. And more casinos have opened on the New Hampshire border, catering to residents north of Boston who might be as close to Salem as they are to Everett.

The rapid growth of online sports betting has also had an impact, diverting money that might otherwise be spent at a casino. In 2023, Encore spent \$28 million converting part of a restaurant into a sports bar, and later a sports-betting facility, with minimal success. The goal was to bring sports bettors into the casino, but traffic was so poor Encore president Jenny Holaday admitted the operation would never generate a return on investment.

“You can’t compete with the couch,” Holaday said of the project during a talk at Boston Universi-



ABOVE: STEVEN SENNE/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE; BELOW: PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

ty’s hospitality school in 2025.

To top it off, there have been multiple legislative pushes throughout New England to approve online casino games, or iGaming, which could further eat profits at brick-and-mortar casinos.

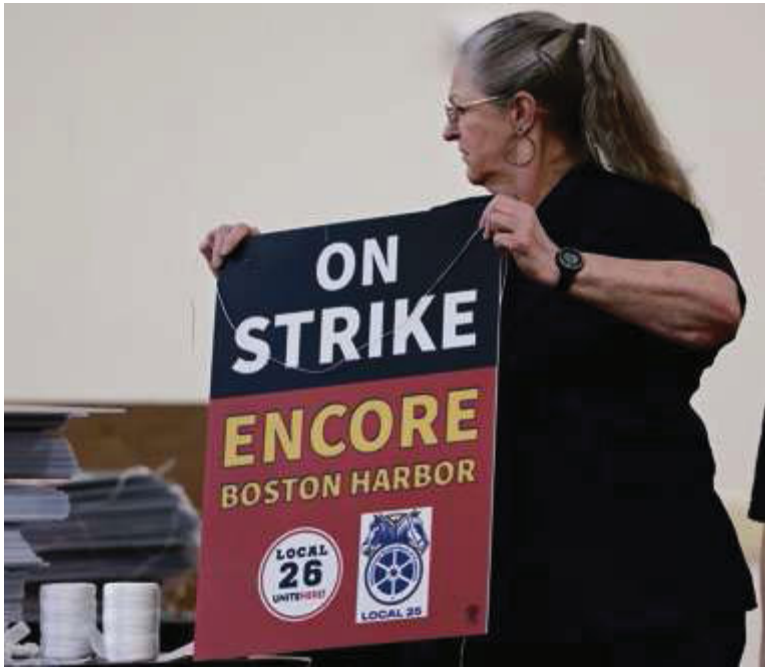
It’s now legal in Connecticut and Rhode Island, with Maine soon following suit. Massachusetts lawmakers have tabled the discussion for now and have ordered studies on the subject, but both Wynn and the city of Everett stand to lose out if iGaming is eventually legalized.

“It’s an industry where there are more and more outlets for the gambling public,” said Richard McGowan, a finance professor at Boston College and gaming industry expert.

All that is weighing on the industry as a whole.

Companywide, Wynn has seen its profit margins fall by more than 30 percent yearly since 2024. Still, it’s doing better than Las Vegas Strip casinos combined; taken together, their net profits fell 81 percent in fiscal year 2025, according to a report by the Nevada Gaming Control Board.

And this most recent quarter, Wynn’s profits and revenue are up year-over-year, though they are slightly down at Encore. Part of Wynn’s resilience as it compares to other casino operators, McGowan



said, is because it typically caters to a higher-end, “luxury” client.

“Wynn and Encore are doing as well as they can be,” he said.

Hundreds of workers going on strike would make that harder. UMass Amherst labor professor Tom Juravich said he believes the unions are well positioned in negotiations, given the timing and circumstances.

“The last thing you want is a disruption,” Juravich said. “I think it’s the last thing the company wants right now.”

With the current contract set to

With nearly half of the more than 3,000 person staff at Encore Boston Harbor casino unionized, employees are asking for an additional \$10 per hour over three years for non-tipped employees, and \$5 per hour for tipped workers as part of a new contract. The casino has claimed labor costs have outpaced growth in revenue and inflation since 2022.

expire Aug. 31, workers are making preparations to go out on strike, even as Encore and Wynn say they’re confident there will be an agreement — one that secures the long-term viability of the casino to weather whatever competition comes next.

“Our focus is on long-term job protection and economic stability,” Encore said on its website. “Short-term proposals that ignore these realities do not protect jobs.”

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Healey to grow behavioral health workforce as access lags

By Alison Kuznitz
STATE HOUSE NEWS SERVICE

The Healey administration rolled out a statewide campaign Thursday to bolster career interest in the behavioral health care sector, where persistent workforce shortages have made it difficult for some Bay Staters to access care.

The campaign, called “Turn Your Compassion Into Your Career,” launched “this summer” and will continue into September with a mix of billboards, digital and social media, videos, and community partnerships, Governor Maura Healey’s office said. The campaign’s website delves into different behavioral health care roles; education and job-training programs; scholarships, grants, and state financial aid programs; and job search and MassHire resources.

“Many people are drawn to work that helps others, but they may not know how many career pathways exist within behavioral health or where to

begin,” said Funmi Agucha, assistant commissioner of the Office of Behavioral Health Promotion and Prevention. “This campaign gives people a clear starting point and connects them with information that can help them turn their compassion, skills, cultural knowledge, and lived experience into impactful work.”

Healey administration spokespeople did not disclose the cost of the campaign. The fiscal 2026 budget called for a \$500,000 mental health workforce pipeline program, aimed at encouraging a “culturally, ethnically, and linguistically diverse behavioral health workforce through collaboration between colleges and behavioral health providers.”

The campaign’s website outlines the types of responsibilities and skills needed for behavioral health jobs, including peer-to-peer professionals, community health workers, mental health counselors, social workers, psychiatrists, and

psychologists. Campaign materials are available in English, Spanish, Brazilian Portuguese, Vietnamese, Arabic, Haitian Creole, and Simplified Chinese, the administration said.

“A diverse workforce helps ensure that behavioral health programs and services are responsive to the needs of the communities they serve and that individuals can access support from professionals who understand and reflect their experiences,” the website says. “As demand for behavioral health programs and services continues to grow, there is a need for people from all backgrounds to help build a stronger, more equitable behavioral health system.”

More than one in five residents reported having a behavioral health care visit in 2025, and more than one in six individuals paid entirely out of pocket for the appointment, according to an annual survey from the Center for Health Information and Analysis. One

in 10 residents had an unmet behavioral health need, which 5.4 percent attributed to the cost of care.

Massachusetts is “facing a behavioral health access crisis” that’s largely fueled by provider shortages “across all settings,” according to a May report from the Health Policy Commission’s Behavioral Health Workforce Center. Multiple inpatient psychiatric facilities and intensive outpatient programs have shuttered since 2020, and more than 25 percent of independent psychotherapy providers accept only cash payment that’s partly due to low insurance reimbursement rates.

Providers with master’s degrees delivered the majority of nonmedical psychotherapy and psychiatric evaluation services but “often received the lowest reimbursement for those services,” the HPC report found. Commercial insurers reimbursed those clinicians for psychotherapy at about 66 percent of the rate for physicians.

Mass. joins suit to block new Title X conditions

Say funding losses would hurt patients

By Daniel Wiessner
REUTERS

A group of mostly Democratic-led US states filed a lawsuit on Thursday seeking to block President Trump’s administration from stripping funding for family planning services for low-income and uninsured people from states and providers that oppose the Republican president’s agenda.

The lawsuit by officials from 23 states, filed in Maryland federal court, claims that new conditions on what is known as Title X funding will unlawfully penalize states and providers that refuse to discourage contraception or provide gender-affirming care to transgender people.

The states in their lawsuit said that losing Title X funding would have devastating consequences for providers and patients.

The Department of Health and Human Services, which administers the funding, did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

The lawsuit is led by New York, Maryland, and Massachusetts, which were joined by California, Illinois, Michigan, New Jersey, and Virginia, among other states.

More than \$6.5 million of Title X family planning service grants went to grantees in Massachusetts in fiscal year 2026, according to the office of Massachusetts Attorney General Andrea Joy Campbell. More than \$5.5 million went to the state’s Department of Public Health, which serves over 100,000 people a year, and almost \$1 million went to Action for Boston Community Development, which serves about 27,000 people a year, the office said.

Created in 1970, Title X provides about \$286 million in annual grants for family planning and related health services such as cancer screenings and treatment for sexually transmitted infections. Under federal law, Title X funds cannot be used to pay for abortion services.

HHS in April announced that, for the first time, it would require applicants for Title X funding to align their programs with the administration’s political priorities. That includes eliminating diversity, equity and inclusion programs, recognizing male and female as the only two sexes, and encouraging abstinence and “natural family planning” instead of contraception.

The states claim the new HHS policy, which was amended last month, conflicts with the law that created the Title X program. That law requires providers to offer a broad range of counseling and prohibits discrimination against patients.

The lawsuit also alleges that the Trump administration adopted the policy without going through the formal rulemaking process required by federal law, which includes publishing a proposal and seeking public comment.

Planned Parenthood, which oversees dozens of clinics that rely on Title X funding, filed a lawsuit against HHS last month making similar claims. That case is pending in Washington, D.C. federal court.

Dana Gerber of the Globe staff contributed to this report.

TV HIGHLIGHTS

Golf: LPGA FM Championship, 9 a.m., Golf
Golf: PGA Tour Championship, 11 a.m., ESPN; 1 p.m., Golf
Baseball: Red Sox-Yankees, 7:15 p.m., Apple TV
WNBA: Sun-Fever, 7:30 p.m., Ion
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Sports

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THE BOSTON GLOBE FRIDAY, AUGUST 28, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS

CHRISTOPHER L. GASPER

Can upstarts sustain their magical run?



Mojo, magic, fate, destiny, luck, vibes. Call it whatever you want, but the reborn Red Sox possess it.

The Fenway Find-a-Ways keep on collecting victories at a remarkable clip thanks to improbable player performances and relentless comebacks.

There's a celestial hardball guiding hand sweeping the Sox toward the playoffs.

The question is, once they get there, will this juju and voodoo from the Andruw Monasterios, Mickey Gaspers, Nick Sogards, Anthony Seiglers, Jahmai Joneses, etc. continue? Or does it carry an inevitable expiration date?

It's harder and harder by the day to doubt these redoubtable Red Sox, as they prepare to rendezvous Friday with the rival Yankees in the Bronx for a crucial series. They've passed every test and cleared every hurdle to teleport from 14 games below .500 to 14 games above it in two months, propelled by a 27-3 stretch. Run Prevention 2.0 is as

GASPER, Page C4



Above, Jahmai Jones (back left), Justin Slaten (front left), and Patrick Sandoval (front right) are among the Red Sox who are into card collecting.



Pitcher Payton Tolle (right) was focused on a Dennis Eckersley card on a recent visit to Sacramento.

PHOTOS BY ALEX SPEIER/GLOBE STAFF

CARD GAMES

Group of Red Sox have bonded off the field over collecting

By Alex Speier
GLOBE STAFF

At the sight of Pedro Martinez in the Red Sox clubhouse in mid-June, relievers Greg Weissert and Justin Slaten giddily bounded across the room. Weissert wielded a cardboard time machine — a signed Dodgers rookie card of the Hall of Famer, which inspired delighted reminiscing for Martinez.

Weissert had procured the card a few weeks earlier at a shop in Seattle in a mystery bag that was guaranteed to include an autographed card of a prominent player. When Weissert pulled Martinez . . .

“We were looking at each other and were like, ‘That’s poetic,’” recounted Slaten.

“Sick card,” beamed Weissert.

Card collecting has become a huge part of the culture of the 2026 Red Sox, with members of the team frequently organizing trips to card shops. It’s been common for the team to arrive with multiple cars filled with players to descend en masse on shops where they can feed their hobby.

In recent years, the Sox have had occasional players dabbling in card collecting, perhaps most notably in

RED SOX, Page C4

LPGA'S FM CHAMPIONSHIP AT TPC BOSTON



DAVID L RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

World No. 1 Nelly Korda lines up a putt on No. 10, her first hole of Thursday's opening round at TPC Boston. She's eight back after an even-par 72.

Pedersen looks like old self with 65

By Emma Healy
GLOBE STAFF

NORTON — The road back to golf has been longer than expected for Emily Kristine Pedersen, who suffered a broken bone in her left wrist at the beginning of the year and spent eight weeks with her arm immobilized in a cast.

After the cast came off, the 30-year-old Dane spent a week trying to return to her normal, day-to-day routine before she could start putting again. After a week of that, she spent a week chipping, and only then could she finally resume hitting.

Pedersen's still not quite the golfer she was before the injury, but Thursday, she felt closer than she has in a long time.

A four-time European Solheim Cup team member, Pedersen has struggled this year, making just two cuts in eight LPGA Tour starts. But after shooting a 7-under 65 in the first round of the FM Championship, Pedersen found herself in a tie for second place at TPC Boston.

“[This round] definitely makes me feel like it's still in there somewhere,” Pedersen

FM CHAMPIONSHIP, Page C3



SEI YOUNG KIM
Leads at 8 under

Legacy will play entire '27 slate in Pawtucket

By Emma Healy
GLOBE STAFF

Boston Legacy FC won't play at White Stadium until 2028 despite a ruling by the state's Supreme Judicial Court that cleared the path for the team and the city to complete renovations on the venue.

The Legacy will instead play their home games during the 2027 NWSL season at Centreville Bank Stadium in Pawtucket, R.I., where they have played since May, before moving to White Stadium in 2028.

Club executives are excited to have clarity on their future, and being able to point to the start of the 2028 season as a

BOSTON LEGACY, Page C6



DAVID RICHARD/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Tommy DeVito played two series for the Patriots on Thursday and was behind one of their better moments, connecting with Kyle Williams on a 45-yard touchdown.

Defensive depth remains concern

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

CLEVELAND — Notes and observations from the Browns' 37-13 drubbing of the Patriots in their preseason finale . . .

1. Defensive depth remains a concern.

In the first half, the Browns did not punt and shredded New England's backups, primarily through the air. Quarterback Dillon Gabriel completed 12 of his 15 passes for 186 yards and three touchdowns. Cleveland opened the game with back-to-back touchdown drives and settled for back-to-back field goals before scoring another touchdown. New England's cornerbacks provided little resistance, giving up significant gains to a group of undrafted wide receivers.

During his halftime interview on the Amazon Prime broadcast, coach Mike Vrabel said he would like to see “a lot more inspiring effort” from the defense in the second half.

Thanks to a strong punt from Matt Haack and tackle from rookie edge rusher Quintavious Hutchins, the Browns started their first drive of the third quarter on their own 2-yard line. The Patriots managed to register their first stop of the night, but almost surrendered a third-and-long conversion to Browns sixth-round draft pick Taylen Green.

On Cleveland's subsequent possession, Haack once again backed the Browns up deep in

PATRIOTS, Page C2

Pro football

Patriots Notebook

Defense not rushing to judgment over stats

By Christopher Price
GLOBE STAFF

CLEVELAND — **Clint McMillan** isn't pushing the panic button yet, and says you shouldn't either.

The Patriots defensive line coach has a blunt message for those who have worried about the performance of New England's run defense this summer.

In a 37-13 loss to the Browns on Thursday, the Patriots allowed 166 rushing yards on 38 carries for an average of 4.4 yards per rush attempt. It worsened what already weren't inspiring numbers — an average of 129.7 rushing yards and 4.37 yards per carry across three preseason games.

And while there's no specific way of quantifying the numbers in the joint practices, Eagles star running back **Saquon Barkley** managed to break off a number of big runs.

At the same time, it's worth noting the in-game totals came against defensive lineups that didn't include starting tackles **Christian Barmore**, **Milton Williams**, or **Cory Durden**.

McMillan asks critics to consider the bigger picture, specific to the regular season.

"Right now, we've allowed zero yards and zero touchdowns," he said. "So everybody's run defense right now, there's no issues.

"We've got to be able to respond when there are problems. We know the way we need to stop the run. We've got to set hard edges, build walls, and then swarm to the ball. And that that's the expectation."

The group set an absurdly high bar last year. No running back broke the 50-yard mark on the ground through the first nine games. Those numbers dropped off, but the Patriots' strong play against the run was one of the defense's calling cards last season.

"Whether [the run defense has] been great in the preseason or poor, it doesn't matter once the season starts," McMillan said. "Whatever it was last year, it doesn't matter. So we got a chance to set the table and don't talk about it. Show what we want the run defense to be."

Linebacker **Christian Elliss** and inside linebackers coach **Vinny DePalma** said training camp and the preseason games allowed a long look at different schemes and personnel packages.

"You're always trying to perfect it, so I think

it's just trying to work at it this time of year," DePalma said. "The fundamentals, understanding how we're fitting each defense, how we're playing with our hands, how we're violent, how we're violently striking guys and getting off blocks. All of that. To me, that's what this time of year is about, and that's what's going to show up in the season.

"The run fundamentals . . . You can have as many schemes [as] you want. But at the end of the day, the run game usually comes down to fundamentals. They know they're going to run the ball. You know you got to stop the run, and the fundamentals are what's going to win. So we just continue to work on that."

"We're doing a really good job, with a lot of new faces, new guys, and getting our identity and how we like to fit the [scheme against the] run, how we like to move our guys, how we like to play ball," said Elliss. "I think we've been doing a great job.

"It leads with our D line. When our D line dominates, we dominate as a defense."

Henderson stays home

Running back **TreVeyon Henderson** should be "good to go" for Week 1 of the regular season. A league source indicated he avoided a serious right ankle injury when he slipped on the turf at practice earlier in the week. Henderson, who missed a practice, didn't travel with the team to Cleveland as a precaution . . . In addition to Henderson, the Patriots had 38 players not dress for the contest: **Christian Gonzalez**, **A.J. Brown**, **Harold Landry**, **DeMario Douglas**, **Craig Woodson**, **Dre'Mont Jones**, **Carlton Davis**, **Drake Maye**, **Mack Hollins**, **Robert Spillane**, **Marcus Jones**, **Eric Butler**, **Kevin Byard**, **Rhamondre Stevenson**, **Brenden Schooler**, **Reggie Gilliam**, **Marcus Bryant**, **Jared Wilson**, **Xavier Holmes**, **Khalil Jacobs**, **Will Campbell**, **Greg Van Roten**, **Mike Onwenu**, **Lorenz Metz**, **Alijah Vera-Tucker**, **Morgan Moses**, **Ben Brown**, **Eli Raridon**, **Hunter Henry**, **Romeo Doubs**, **Elijah Ponder**, **Bryce Baringer**, **Elliss**, **Barmore**, **Durden**, and **Williams**. Newly acquired safety **Jaylen Reed** was with the team, but he also did not dress.

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JASON MILLER/GETTY IMAGES

Browns WR Luke Floriea caught a pair of first-quarter touchdown passes vs. the Patriots.

NFL Notebook

Seahawks, DT Williams agree on three-year, \$90m deal

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Three-time Pro Bowl defensive tackle **Leonard Williams** and the Seahawks agreed on a three-year, \$90 million contract extension that includes \$56 million guaranteed, a person with knowledge of the deal told The Associated Press on Thursday.

The person spoke on condition of anonymity because the team hasn't announced the extension.

The 32-year-old Williams was a second-team AP All-Pro last season when he helped the Seahawks win the franchise's second Super Bowl title.

Williams, a No. 6 pick by the Jets in the 2015 NFL draft out of Southern Cal, has 22 sacks in 2½ seasons with Seattle, and 61½ in an 11-year career spent with the Seahawks, Giants, and Jets.

Williams signed a three-year, \$64.5 million deal with the Seahawks in 2024, after the Giants traded him in October 2023. He was set to become a free agent in 2027.

During training camp earlier this month, Williams said joining the Seahawks "lit a fire within me."

"It just restored all my energy and

love for the game. Just being in a new environment in general changed my perspective," he said. "When [Coach] **Mike [Macdonald]** got hired, it even heightened it because of his principles and things that he has brought to the team."

Packers RB facing charges

Packers running back **Josh Jacobs** is facing misdemeanor charges of battery and criminal damage to property stemming from what police described as a physical confrontation with his girlfriend.

Jacobs was arrested May 26 after police were called to his home to investigate a disturbance and was released from jail the next day. The charges were announced Thursday by Brown County District Attorney **David Lasee**.

Jacobs was back on the field with the Packers for organized team activities less than a week after the arrest, and has been with the team for training camp, though he's been limited by a groin injury.

Jacobs was initially arrested on five criminal charges, including a felony

count of strangulation and suffocation as well as battery, criminal damage to property, disorderly conduct, and intimidation of a victim.

Mendoza has rough night

Raiders rookie quarterback **Fernando Mendoza** saw what it was like to face a strong NFL pass rush, even against a 49ers defense comprised of reserves.

Mendoza was sacked twice and threw an interception in the 49ers' 18-12 preseason victory over the Raiders in Las Vegas.

Eddy Piñeiro made all six of his field goal attempts, including 51- and 54-yarders in the final 1:51 for the 49ers. Mendoza completed 7 of 14 passes for 57 yards, making him 25 of 40 for 240 yards with a touchdown, two interceptions, and four sacks in three preseason games.

Buechele rallies Bills late

Ian Wheeler scored on a 2-yard run with 1:06 left, **Steve Buechele** completed an off-balance pass to **Dante Pettis** for a 2-point conversion, and the Bills

beat the visiting Steelers, 28-27, to complete a 3-0 preseason.

The Steelers' last chance to pull ahead ended with **Drew Allar's** pass sailing behind tight end **Lake McRee** on a fourth-and-7 attempt with 44 seconds remaining. It was a disappointing finish for the Steelers, who squandered a 10-point lead in the final seven minutes, and for Allar, the rookie who was attempting to separate himself from **Will Howard** in the competition for the Steelers' third-string job.

With **Kyle Allen** appearing to have locked up the primary backup job behind **Josh Allen**, Buechele handled the quarterback duties and finished 26 for 38 for 196 yards. The go-ahead score was set up by a 42-yard pass interference penalty against **Tamon Lymum** on Pettis, giving the Bills the ball at the 7.

Rams require WR Atwell

The Rams reacquired veteran receiver **Tutu Atwell** from the Dolphins in a trade for running back **Jarquez Hunter**. The Rams announced the surprising deal before their final preseason game against the Chargers. After no clear-cut

No. 3 receiver emerged behind All-Pro **Puka Nacua** and **Davante Adams** in training camp, the Rams realized they could be thin at receiver, especially if early this season Nacua is suspended by the NFL for his offseason of misdeeds . . . The Colts activated receiver **Alec Pierce** from the physically unable to perform list, two days before their final preseason game against the Lions. Pierce had surgery on his left ankle in March after signing a four-year contract extension worth \$114 million. . . . The Packers addressed their depth issues at tight end by signing veteran **Jonnu Smith** to a one-year contract. Smith caught 38 passes for 222 yards and two touchdowns last season in 17 games with the Steelers, who released him in March. . . . Titans coach **Robert Saleh** called a hit by Bears defensive back **Xavier Woods** that laid out his wide receiver, **Wan'Dale Robinson**, "cheap." Robinson was being evaluated for a concussion after he was hit by Woods while running a route over the middle during a joint practice session in Nashville in advance of Saturday night's preseason game.



JASON MILLER/GETTY IMAGES

Quarterback Behren Morton threw two interceptions and took three sacks on a rough night.

Patriots' lack of depth defensively is concern

►PATRIOTS

Continued from Page C1

their own territory. But on second down, Green was able to evade pressure and scramble for a 30-yard gain. Green picked up three more first downs with his legs on a 15-play, 98-yard drive that ended with running back Davon Booth breaking a tackle en route to the end zone.

The Browns finished with 166 rushing yards on 38 attempts (average of 4.4 yards per carry). Their quarterbacks completed 77.3 percent of their passes for a combined 213 yards. Their 37 points was the highest total of any team so far in the preseason.

Headed into the regular season, the depth at linebacker, edge rusher, and cornerback is concerning. And players that could have improved their chances of making the 53-man roster did not take advantage of the opportunity.

2. Wide receiver Kyle Williams made it look easy on his 45-yard touchdown on New England's opening drive. Williams, as he did last week on his 69-yard score, got behind his defender and seemingly effortlessly hauled in a deep ball from Tommy DeVito.

After the Patriots traded Kayshon Boutte, there should be more opportunities for Williams to grow within the passing attack. He's proven he can pose a deep threat, but can he emerge as a more consistent contributor?

"The hardest thing is to judge how fast he's rolling," DeVito said. "He can roll. He's so explosive at the line of scrimmage with his release package. He's just a vertical threat for these DBs. They have to respect it. That just complements the rest of his routes."

3. A total of 38 Patriots were not in uniform. No snaps from quarterback Drake Maye and the rest of the projected starters. Their first game action will come in Week 1. For what it's worth, Seahawks quarterback Sam Darnold and Seattle's starters also did not play a snap in the preseason.

Browns 37, Patriots 13

New England (1-1-1)..... 7 6 0 0 - 13
Cleveland (1-2)..... 17 10 0 10 - 37
Cle — Floriea 6 pass from Gabriel (Szymyt kick), 11:39.
NE — K.Williams 45 pass from DeVito (Borregales kick), 8:20.
Cle — Floriea 14 pass from Gabriel (Szymyt kick), 4:17.
Cle — FG Szymyt 35, 0:18.
Cle — FG Szymyt 47, 13:28.
NE — FG Borregales 26, 6:15.
Cle — Marshall 7 pass from Gabriel (Szymyt kick), 2:32.
NE — FG Borregales 33, 0:07.
Cle — Booth 8 run (Szymyt kick), 13:44.
Cle — FG Szymyt 23, 2:08.
Attendance: 53,178

	NE	Cle
First downs.....	16	23
Total yards.....	276	379
Rushing yards.....	23-114	38-166
Passing.....	162	213
Punt returns.....	1-10	2-3
Kickoff returns.....	8-190	4-101
Interception returns.....	0-0	2-36
Comp-attempt.....	20-32	17-22-0
Sacked-yards lost.....	3-16	0-0
Punts-avg.....	4-46.5	2-45.0
Fumbles-lost.....	1-0	1-0
Penalties-yards.....	3-48	2-36
Time of possession.....	26:35	34:25

INDIVIDUAL STATISTICS
RUSHING—NE, Haskins 11-38, Hasty 6-37, Morton 2-18, DeVito 2-15, Larson 2-5; Cle, T.Green 8-66, Booth 10-40, R.Sanders 6-29, Marshall 9-24, Larvadain 1-4, Gabriel 4-3
PASSING—NE, Morton 18-28-2-123, DeVito 2-4-0-55; Cle, Gabriel 12-15-0-186, T.Green 5-7-0-27
RECEIVING—NE, Dixon 8-71, K.Williams 2-55, Dippre 2-21, Westover 2-10, Hasty 2-(-3), Palmer 1-9, Dorrner 1-8, DeGennaro 1-4, Arkin 1-3; Cle, Larvadain 5-48, Floriea 3-29, Patterson 2-71, Marshall 2-18, Ryan 2-9, Wilson 1-29, Biber 1-5, Booth 1-4
INTERCEPTIONS—Cle, Jefferson 1-36, Mascarenas-Arnold 1-0

Star cornerback Christian Gonzalez, who acknowledged Tuesday he's frustrated by the lack of progress toward a contract extension, was among the players who traveled to Cleveland but did not suit up. Newly acquired safety Jaylen Reed, who will wear No. 26, was as well.

Running back TreVeyon Henderson, who left Monday's practice early with an apparent ankle/foot injury, did not travel to Cleveland.

Edge rusher Harold Landry (physically unable to perform list) and special teamer Brenden Schooler (non-football injury list) also did not travel, but Vrabel left the door open for them to be activated off their respective lists prior to cutdown day. If either player remains on the list after Sunday, then he must miss a minimum of four games.

"Once you take them off, that's kind of what it is," Vrabel said. "We just want to be careful and smart with them, and not force them into anything.

4. Quarterbacks coach Ashton Grant called the offensive plays from the sideline, with of-

fensive coordinator Josh McDaniels taking a spot up in the coaching booth. Last week, Vrabel also gave four of the coaching assistants an opportunity to call a play. He has previously spoken about the value of using preseason games to develop coaches.

"Josh has called plenty of games in the National Football League," Vrabel said. "We think Ashton is a very, very good, young offensive football coach. We try to look for places to give other coaches opportunities."

5. DeVito stayed on the field for just two drives, with rookie Behren Morton taking over with 13 seconds remaining in the first quarter. Morton threw two interceptions — one that bounced off of CJ Dippre's foot into the hands of a Browns defender, and another that was a bad decision under pressure.

6. Kicker Andy Borregales drilled both of his field goal attempts (26 and 33 yards) in the first half. He didn't misfire in either of the last two preseason games after his poor performance in the opener. Borregales has successfully cooled his seat.

7. Thursday night's crowd was exceptionally sparse, with fans filling only about a quarter (if that) of the seats.

8. On Wednesday, the Patriots took a visit to the Pro Football Hall of Fame. Maye naturally showed up to Huntington Bank Stadium sporting a graphic tee of Adam Vinatieri, the organization's most recent inductee. McDaniels, who grew up in Ohio, had his parents join him.

9. On the decision to trade Boutte, Vrabel said that, barring injuries, Boutte would have been inactive on game days because he doesn't play special teams. Vrabel said he texted Boutte again on Thursday to thank him for his contributions.

"It was one place where we do have some depth," Vrabel said. "I think, for all parties involved, that was probably the best thing."

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Golf



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

The headless golfer is none other than Westborough's Alexa Pano, who had to dig out her errant drive on the 10th hole.

FM CHAMPIONSHIP NOTEBOOK

Big Papi shows love for women’s golf

By Michael Silverman

GLOBE STAFF

NORTON — By calling on **David Ortiz** to deliver some patented Big Papi positivity about women’s golf on Thursday, tournament sponsor FM sank its roots ever deeper into professional golf and New England.

In a low-key panel session held in the Rhode Island-based global commercial property insurer’s corporate suite overlooking the 18th hole, the Red Sox legend bestowed his blessings on women’s golf — not only this tournament, but also the new women’s indoor golf league, WTGL, that will feature FM as the principal partner for the Fenway Sports Group-owned Boston Common squad.

“I’ve got two daughters, I’ve got two sisters, I’m very supportive of women. You guys deserve everything on this planet because without you guys, we are nothing,” said Ortiz. “I’m so happy and proud that Fenway Sports Group now is going to have a women’s golf team, because it’s needed. We need to understand that women are very talented, and whenever they put the effort into something, it comes through.”

Ortiz also addressed the state of his golf game: “I’m a good driver, man.”

The ball, he said, “disappears — poof! But that’s the only thing I can do. The short game, I have issues. I’m a little massive; I need to learn how to control my emotions. We’re working on it. Don’t worry, I’ll get there.”

Eventually. “The problem for me in golf is that my day needs 48 hours so I can play because I’m extremely busy,” he said. “And that sport is very addicting.”

Joining Ortiz briefly on the panel was LPGA golfer **Ina Yoon**, the 10th-ranked South Korean who finished at 2-over 74 in her first round Thursday.

Boston Common is expected to unveil its five-player WTGL roster early next

week.

FM is in its third year of a five-year commitment sponsoring the LPGA’s return to New England, with the next two years already locked into TPC Boston.

Malcolm Roberts, FM chairman and CEO, sounds bullish on a long-term relationship, one that expanded with a \$1 million donation to Boston Children’s Hospital.

“We’re a brand that supports our clients, our business partners, our colleagues and the final piece of the puzzle this year was the community, and that was Boston Children’s Hospital and building an affiliation to them,” said Roberts. “We’re in 130 countries and there’s a global leader’s board every single week and that’s our alignment with LPGA. And WTGL, to me it’s the future of golf — it’s technology. . . [Golf] has been hugely rewarding for us.”

Ready for traffic snarl

With the Savannah Bananas playing baseball Saturday night at Gillette Stadium, less than 12 miles away from the golf course, and a sold-out Pitbull concert at the Xfinity Center next door, Mansfield police already posted a “Saturday = Big Day. Big Crowds. Expect Delays in Foxborough, Mansfield and Norton” advisory on its Facebook page.

The department urged all fans to car-pool or use public transportation, if possible.

An FM Championship official said it is not expecting travel issues for its fans.

Early birds saw stars

Not many spectators were around to watch No. 6-ranked **Lottie Woad** tee off bright and early at 7:33 a.m., along with fellow Brit **Charley Hull** (No. 7) and No. 2 **Jeeno Thitikul** from Thailand. But there were more than last year, said the 23-year-old, whose two tournament wins in her

first two seasons have helped her establish some name recognition.

“We were playing pretty early, so I’m sure tomorrow afternoon there will be more people,” said Woad. “We had a decent crowd following us. It helps when you play with Jeeno and Charley; [they’re] always going to get some good crowds.”

Woad enjoyed a solid first day, carding a 4-under 68 to sit four shots behind leader **Sei Young Kim**, who teed off 11 minutes after Woad’s group. Clearly, the early tee times didn’t bother those two.

“I flew from Canada on Monday, so kind of a too-short time to prepare this week,” said Kim, who was third in last week’s CPKC Women’s Open in Edmonton, Alberta. “Especially today, it was a little tough to wake up the early morning, it feels like I hurt everywhere. But I like to play in the early morning, anyway.”

Solheim slot frees Duncan

After being named to her first Solheim Cup team two days ago, 35-year-old American **Lindy Duncan** (2 under) said she felt like she was playing more freely and with plenty of gratitude. “It’s overwhelming,” she said. “I got so many messages. It’s really nice. I feel just so grateful to have made so many great friends and great relationships.” . . . Rockland’s **Megan Khang** had a quiet first day. She had no birdies and three bogeys through 15 holes, but birdied two of her final three (Nos. 7 and 9) to finish at 1-over 73, just inside the estimated cut line. The same can’t be said for Westborough’s **Alexa Pano**. She went out in even-par 36, but her first four holes on the back nine went double bogey, bogey, double bogey, and bogey. She added another bogey on 17, but was able to birdie the last for a 6-over 78.

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PGA TOUR CHAMPIONSHIP

Shaft change gets Lee flying

By Doug Ferguson

ASSOCIATED PRESS

ATLANTA — Min Woo Lee made his first trip to the Tour Championship a memorable one, playing bogey-free on a rain-softened East Lake for an 8-under 62 that matched his career low on the PGA Tour and gave him a two-shot lead Thursday.

A pair of runner-up finishes this year, at Pebble Beach and the Scottish Open, made Lee a lock to be among the top 30 players who get a shot at the FedEx Cup, the \$10 million prize, and a five-year exemption on the PGA Tour. He just hasn’t felt like a top-30 player in recent weeks.

“Very average two weeks the last two weeks. It was probably the saddest I’ve been on the golf course, which is not good,” Lee said. “We’re really lucky to be out here and play some good golf to get into the playoffs. It just felt so hard.”

There was no such feeling in the opening round of the final event of the FedEx Cup season. He rarely was under stress to make par, made four of his eight birdies from outside 10 feet and wound up with a lead over Viktor Hovland, Collin Morikawa, and Chris Gotterup.

Scottie Scheffler started his day with a 6-foot par putt and never came close to another bogey in his round of 65. He also was nearly recovered from the hand, foot, and mouth disease he picked up last week that gave him blisters on his feet, hands, and throat. The hands were the biggest problem. Those are fine. There’s still a few in his throat, and he sounded much better than a week ago.

The greatest testament came from Matt Fitzpatrick, who also played with him in the opening round at Bellerive last week.

“I played with him last week and he said, ‘Man, I thought I pissed you off or something. You didn’t talk to me for two days,’” Scheffler said. “I was like, ‘No, man, I just couldn’t speak.’”

Scheffler is No. 1 in the FedEx Cup — he picked up a \$23 million bonus last week — but that doesn’t matter at East Lake. Under the current format, any of



COLIN HUBBARD/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Min Woo Lee shot a bogey-free 8-under 62 and leads the Tour Championship by two.

the 30 players who win the Tour Championship are deemed the FedEx Cup champion.

The immediate payoff for Lee came after changing to a slightly heavier shaft in his irons; his coach felt he was swinging faster than usual. The shaft helped to slow it down.

He birdied the par-5 18th for a 62, matching the score he shot at the Nicklaus Tournament course at PGA West to start the year. That was the California desert at The American Express, a tournament known for its low scoring. This one might have been easier given the conditions.

All 29 players in the field were at even par or better, and the course played to a 66.7 average.

Missing from the field was 2025 US Open champion J.J. Spaun, who withdrew after five holes because of a shoulder injury. Spaun said he felt a sharp pain in his right shoulder blade on Tuesday and he spent two days trying to manage it.

BMW Championship winner Wyndham Clark birdied two of his last three holes to salvage a 67.

Gary Woodland, back at the Tour Championship for the first time since 2019, Adam Scott, defending champion Tommy Fleetwood, and British Open champion Ryan Fox were among those joining the group of players at 66.

Rory McIlroy, the only three-time FedEx Cup champion, opened with a 68.

Russell Henley, who grew up just over an hour south in Macon, Ga., had 18 pars in his round of 70.

Callaway, PGA Tour out on Good Good

By Doug Ferguson

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Good Good Golf lost its partnership with Callaway on Thursday, and no longer will be title sponsor of a PGA Tour event in November as the fallout continued over a video for a new Callaway driver that showed a man shoving a woman to the ground who was trying to touch the golf club.

Good Good, among the most popular in the YouTube golf space, has said the video was meant to be a spinoff from the movie, “Obsession.” But the criticism was immediate and relentless, and the pressure began mounting by the day.

The video was deleted the same day it was posted on Aug. 20, but it continued to make the rounds on social media. Apologies from Good Good and Callaway had little effect.

“After thoughtful discussions with the PGA Tour and careful reflection, we have decided to step away as sponsor of the tour event in Austin this fall,” Good Good said in a social media post. “We recognize that we have work to do as an organization, and our focus right now is on our team, our culture, and ensuring we will learn from this situation.”

The new Nov. 12-15 tournament already was changed on the PGA Tour’s website to “Austin Championship.”

Golf Channel postponed a Good Good reality show Wednesday — “Big Break x Good Good” — because a sponsor, reported to be Golf Galaxy, wanted its brand scrubbed from it. Dick’s Sporting Goods, which

owns Golf Galaxy, removed the apparel from its stores, and then Callaway said it was ending the three-year sponsorship.

Golf Channel announced Friday afternoon the Big Break series would be scrapped and return in 2027. The winner was to have received a sponsor exemption to the Austin tournament.

In the 60-second video for Callaway’s new driver co-branded with Good Good, Garrett Clark shoves Alexis Miestowski to the ground as she reaches for the driver. As she is on the ground, he leans over and tells her, “Do not touch my new driver.”

Clark and Miestowski work for Good Good.

The video was pulled the night it was posted, and it was followed by apologies the next day. But then Callaway added another layer of apologies, this one from CEO Chip Brewer, who conceded that while Good Good produced the video, Callaway approved it before it was posted.

Callaway posted to its social media channels on Thursday that it has taken “appropriate internal corrective actions” and strengthened approval procedures, and has committed \$1 million to support organizations working to prevent violence against women.

Good Good Golf was launched on YouTube in 2020 and now is among the largest content creators in the sport. The PGA Tour has embraced such content creators over the last several years, even staging exhibitions during the week of The Players Championship and Tour Championship.

Pedersen sitting just one off FM lead

►FM CHAMPIONSHIP

Continued from Page C1

said. “I think it’s been a really tough year. It’s been a lot harder to come back than I thought it would be.”

Sei Young Kim, the world No. 9, was in the mix when she made the turn at 2-under, and then turned on the jets on the front nine — she started on No. 10 — to card an 8-under 64 for a one-shot lead over Pedersen and Japan’s Miyu Yamashita.

Except for a bogey on the 13th hole, Pedersen played a spotless round, turning in eight birdies — including three over her final four holes.

“I think it’s just trying not to let that one mistake take away from the 12 really great holes I played before, and then just reminding myself that you’re playing great,” she said after hitting 16 of the 18 greens in regulation.

Against one of the toughest fields in FM Championship history, which includes 23 of the world’s top 25, the 242nd-ranked Pedersen is (at least on paper) an outlier at the top of the leaderboard.

“I still feel like my good golf is good, and I still feel that I haven’t peaked yet,” she said. “So it’s nice to see that I can have a day like today.”

In her 12th season on Tour, Pedersen said the competition



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Megan Khang of Rockland turned in a 1-over par 73 in the first round and is nine shots behind leader Sei Young Kim.

has gotten tougher over the course of her career, and the level of talent at the FM Championship is proof that younger players are setting a new pace.

Among those talented newcomers is 17-year-old Anna Huang, who shot 3 under. The Canadian teenager, who competes on the Ladies European Tour, earned her spot in the FM Championship by finishing in the top 10 of last week’s CPKC Women’s Open.

Huang struggled at the outset, with two bogeys on her first four holes, before surging back into contention with two birdies and an eagle to open the back nine.

“I don’t know if I was just tired or a bit nervous, but I managed to get loose and kind of get my game back together,” Huang said.

World No. 1 Nelly Korda also had a slow start, and finished the day with a disappointing

Baseball

Which version of Story will Sox get?

By Alex Speier

GLOBE STAFF

WORCESTER — As Trevor Story nears the conclusion of his Triple-A rehab assignment and his first big league games since mid-May, there are two very different ways of considering the Red Sox shortstop.

One is to view Story through the lens of his 2026 on-field performance. At the beginning of the season, he tried to play through a core injury that worsened to the point of affecting everything he did: swinging, fielding, running, walking, coughing.

In 41 games before he landed on the injured list and underwent surgery, Story ranked as one of the worst players in baseball, hitting .206/.244/.303 with an ugly 32 percent strikeout rate. His plate coverage was affected by his injury, forcing him to cheat to cover the plate, which exposed him to expanding the zone in jarring fashion, with a 44 percent chase rate that made him a relatively easy mark for opposing pitchers.

If that’s the player who rejoins the Red Sox, he could be a detriment to a lineup that has surged in his absence. And while Story has been encouraged both by how he’s holding up physically and by what he considers improved timing after a three-month absence from games, his production for the WooSox — 5 for 32 with no extra-base hits, one walk, and 10 strikeouts (29 percent strikeout rate), with a 39 percent chase rate entering Thursday’s game — hasn’t been encouraging.

But there’s another not-so-ancient version of Story that looked very different. As the Red Sox get ready to play in Yankee Stadium this weekend, and with the possibility of a return by the 33-year-old looming, it’s worth recalling the last time Story played in the Bronx. Coming off a regular season in which he led the Sox with 25 home runs and 31 stolen bases, Story went 5 for 13 (.385) with the team’s lone homer in the 2025 Wild Card Series against the Yankees.

He nearly won Game 2 (and the series) singlehandedly for the Sox, driving in three runs with a homer and two-run single. Then, in a 3-3 game, he caused Yankee hearts to stop by drilling a bases-loaded liner 391 feet to the edge of the track for an out in a 4-3 loss. He was vulnera-

ble to strikeouts in the series (four), but Story was also the biggest threat in a power-deficient lineup.

As he worked this week in Worcester for a possible return this weekend, Story accessed that vision of himself.

“I think about it a lot,” he said of the Wild Card Series. “When I signed here, that’s kind of the moments that I would think about. Watching that ’21 Wild Card Game at Fenway, the [Xander Bogaerts] homer, [Kyle] Schwarber [going deep], those are the homers that stuck in my mind about how electric the place was and how special it is to do that in Boston.

“It’s a big memory for me. Obviously wish the [Yankees] series would have gone a little different, but being able to play well in the playoffs meant a lot.”

Story believes that he’s physically capable of returning to that level. While he acknowledged there will be a buildup needed — “[the layoff] is not going to be invisible,” he said — he also believes he has the ability to be a difference-maker in the playoffs.

“That was the whole point of the surgery, to do it when I did,” said Story. “There is a level of physicality and mentality that it takes to be at that level and be that guy. I feel really good about where I’m at with that. I wouldn’t be coming back if I didn’t think that was the case. [I have] too much respect for this team and the way that we played, the way that we turned it around.

“Guys have really played well in my absence, and I’m super proud of them. I joined this organization to win, and that’s what we’ve been doing recently. I feel like we have something special brewing. My mind-set since surgery has been about coming back to play well in the postseason, to do something special.”

Does Story feel like people have forgotten what he showed the capacity to do last October?

“For sure,” he said. “There’s an element of that. So, we’ll see what happens.”

In which version of Story do the Red Sox believe? The answer will become apparent in the coming days, as the team makes its choice about when and how to reintegrate him in-to the lineup.

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NOTEBOOK

Union boss criticizes new proposal for free agency

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Major League Baseball proposed limiting free-agent signings to several weeks in December and then from early February on each offseason, along with a trade ban during the gap in-between, a plan aimed at creating more of an offseason transaction flurry similar to those in the NFL and NBA.

The plan offered to the players’ association Thursday is contingent on adoption of the salary cap system MLB proposed in May, which the union has vowed never to accept.

Union head **Bruce Meyer** immediately criticized the plan.

“Their latest proposals regarding free agency would eliminate player rights by establishing an artificial free agency window, subject to a salary cap, which would reduce player leverage and create a game of musical chairs pitting player vs. player,” he said in a statement.

Tampa OKs new ballpark

Tampa officials approved a \$2.3 billion deal for a new Rays ballpark funded by public and private money.

The 4-3 vote by the Tampa City Council came three months after a tentative agreement was reached for a stadium, which would include \$967 million in tax money.

Hillsborough County Commissioners will vote on the project Friday morning. The property is located next to the Yankees’ spring training facility and across a highway from Raymond James Stadium, home of the Buccaneers.

Error-prone Yankees

Christian Walker had three hits, including a two-run homer off **Ger-rit Cole** in the sixth inning, and **Jeremy Peña** added a solo shot to power the visiting Astros to a 5-1 victory over the Yankees.

Walker broke an 0-for-11 skid

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Tampa Bay	79	54	.594	—	—	5-5	W 1
New York	75	58	.564	4	—	7-3	L 1
Boston	73	60	.549	6	—	7-3	L 1
Baltimore	65	69	.485	14½	3	4-6	L 1
Toronto	65	70	.481	15	3½	4-6	L 1

CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Chicago	70	63	.526	—	—	5-5	W 2
Cleveland	68	66	.507	2½	—	8-2	W 7
Minnesota	64	70	.478	6½	4	4-6	L 2
Detroit	62	71	.466	8	5½	2-8	L 1
Kansas City	60	75	.444	11	8½	9-1	W 1

WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Houston	67	67	.500	—	—	4-6	W 1
Texas	66	68	.493	1	2	5-5	L 2
Seattle	64	70	.478	3	4	6-4	L 1
Athletics	53	81	.396	14	15	4-6	W 2
Los Angeles	52	82	.388	15	16	3-7	L 4

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Atlanta	79	55	.590	—	—	5-5	W 4
Philadelphia	74	60	.552	5	—	8-2	W 1
Miami	68	66	.507	11	4	5-5	W 1
Washington	63	73	.463	17	10	3-7	W 1
New York	60	74	.448	19	12	5-5	L 2

CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Milwaukee	83	51	.619	—	—	7-3	W 2
Chicago	76	58	.567	7	—	4-6	L 2
St. Louis	67	68	.496	16½	5½	3-7	W 1
Pittsburgh	65	70	.481	18½	7½	5-5	L 1
Cincinnati	63	71	.470	20	9	4-6	W 1

WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Los Angeles	80	54	.597	—	—	6-4	L 3
San Diego	72	62	.537	8	—	6-4	W 1
*Arizona	71	63	.530	9	1	5-5	W 2
*San Francisco	54	79	.406	25½	17½	3-7	L 1
Colorado	52	82	.388	28	20	2-8	L 1

* — Not including late game

RESULTS			
THURSDAY			
At Washington 7	Colorado 1	Milwaukee 8	at NY Mets 2
At St. Louis 7	Baltimore 5	At Atlanta 1	LA Dodgers 0
Houston 5	at NY Yankees 1	Arizona	at San Francisco
Kansas City 13	at Toronto 2		
WEDNESDAY			
At Miami 4	Boston 0	At NY Yankees 9	Houston 3
Tampa Bay 3	at Detroit 0	At Toronto 3	Kansas City 0
At Arizona 2	Chi. Cubs 0	Milwaukee 8	at NY Mets 1
Cincinnati 10	at San Francisco 9	At Atlanta 6	LA Dodgers 5
Cleveland 4	at LA Angels 3	At Chi. White Sox 10	Texas 4
Philadelphia 6	at Seattle 0	Baltimore 8	at St. Louis 7
At San Diego 3	Pittsburgh 0	At Athletics 7	Minnesota 4
Colorado 13	at Washington 1		



DILIP VISHWANAT/GETTY IMAGES

Ramón Urías hit a two-run homer in the fourth to give the Cardinals a 5-0 lead over the Orioles. St. Louis won, 7-5, to end a five-game losing streak.

FRIDAY'S GAMES												
.....2026..... Team2026 vs. opp. Last 3 starts.....												
Odds	W-L	ERA	rec.	W-L	IP	ERA	W-L	IP	ERA			
BOSTON AT NY YANKEES, 7:15 p.m.												
Sandoval (L)	+145	1-2	4.54	6-2	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-2	15.2	6.32		
Schlitter (R)	-170	11-6	2.16	16-11	1-1	18.2	0.96	1-0	18.1	1.47		
CINCINNATI AT CHICAGO CUBS, 2:20 p.m.												
Lowder (R)	+165	5-8	5.13	10-0	0-1	5.0	5.40	1-1	18.0	4.50		
Peterson (L)	-195	7-7	5.17	8-9	0-1	8.0	10.13	1-0	16.0	3.38		
LA DODGERS AT DETROIT, 6:40 p.m.												
Skubal (L)	-220	8-7	2.91	11-9	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-1	18.0	3.50		
Anderson (R)	+180	4-5	4.09	2-4	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-1	14.0	4.50		
MIAMI AT WASHINGTON, 6:45 p.m.												
Pérez (R)	-145	7-9	3.17	11-12	1-0	5.0	1.80	2-0	18.0	0.50		
Kent (L)	+125	0-2	8.03	0-3	0-1	4.2	5.79	0-2	12.1	8.03		
HOUSTON AT NY METS, 7:10 p.m.												
Brown (R)	Off	3-3	3.51	6-8	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-2	15.2	3.45		
Scott (R)	Off	4-3	3.73	14-5	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	15.0	6.60		
KANSAS CITY AT CLEVELAND, 7:10 p.m.												
Wacha (R)	Off	7-8	3.49	9-17	2-0	14.0	1.93	2-0	18.2	3.86		
Bibee (R)	Off	5-13	3.97	8-19	0-1	8.2	5.19	1-2	18.1	4.91		
SAN DIEGO AT TAMPA BAY, 7:10 p.m.												
Mize (R)	+110	5-7	3.44	8-12	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	14.2	3.68		
McClanahan (L)	-130	9-6	3.10	13-9	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	11.1	3.18		
COLORADO AT ATLANTA, 7:15 p.m.												
Sugano (R)	Off	12-7	4.96	14-9	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-2	14.0	8.36		
Holmes (R)	Off	8-5	3.64	17-7	0-0	5.0	9.00	1-1	15.2	3.45		
SEATTLE AT TORONTO, 7:15 p.m.												
Hancock (R)	Off	7-7	3.37	12-12	1-0	7.0	0.00	1-1	17.1	3.63		
Cease (R)	Off	8-5	2.37	16-9	1-0	7.0	0.00	1-0	18.0	3.00		
TEXAS AT MILWAUKEE, 7:40 p.m.												
Bradford (L)	+150	0-2	3.05	1-3	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-2	16.1	3.86		
Henderson (R)	-180	8-2	2.60	10-3	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-1	19.1	2.33		
CHICAGO WHITE SOX AT MINNESOTA, 8:10 p.m.												
Castillo (R)	-105	4-10	2.19	7-14	0-1	5.0	12.60	1-1	14.1	4.40		
Kremer (R)	-115	2-4	5.22	4-7	1-0	6.0	1.50	1-0	17.2	3.57		
PITTSBURGH AT ST. LOUIS, 8:15 p.m.												
Jones (R)	-110	2-5	4.76	6-9	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-2	12.0	8.25		
Mathews (L)	-110	0-2	6.43	1-2	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-2	14.0	6.43		
PHILADELPHIA AT ATLANTA, 9:38 p.m.												
Painter (R)	-140	3-8	6.04	6-11	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-0	17.1	4.15		
Detmers (L)	+120	4-8	3.62	9-17	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	20.0	0.45		
BALTIMORE AT ATHLETICS, 9:40 p.m.												
Young (R)	Off	9-3	3.50	17-5	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	15.2	4.02		
Lopez (L)	Off	5-4	4.98	8-10	1-0	5.1	3.38	0-0	19.0	2.37		
ARIZONA AT SAN FRANCISCO, 10:15 p.m.												
TBA	-120	—	—	0-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	0.0	—		
Tidwell (R)	+100	0-0	3.58	0-4	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	15.2	4.02		

* Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season.

BRAVES 1, DODGERS 0

LA DODGERS	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Ohtani dh	4	0	0	0	0	2	.285
Edman cf	3	0	0	0	0	3	.267
Betts ss	4	0	2	0	1	0	.235
Freeman 1b	4	0	1	0	0	0	.300
AThomas pr	0	0	0	0	0	0	.183
T Hernández lf	4	0	0	0	0	2	.



DAVID L RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Jennifer Epstein, controlling owner of the Legacy, takes solace in the clarity of knowing where her team will play all next season.

Legacy pass on White until '28

BOSTON LEGACY

Continued from Page C1

definitive date is an encouraging step, they said.

But the news marks a further delay in an already controversial project that has been hamstrung significantly by legal pushback over the past two years.

“This is a transformative project, White Stadium, and while it may be taking longer than we all would have hoped, it is going to affect the lives of our players and Boston’s youth for decades, generations to come,” Legacy controlling owner Jennifer Epstein said. “So it’s worth the wait.”

The polarizing, \$325 million plan to renovate the stadium, a public-private partnership between the Legacy and the City of Boston, has faced intense scrutiny and criticism, both over the scale of the project and its growing price tag.

Progress on the renovation was slowed significantly by a yearslong lawsuit to stop the project, but the Massachusetts Supreme Judicial Court on Aug. 19 rejected the lawsuit brought by an environmental nonprofit, the Emerald Necklace Conservancy, and a coalition of residents who live in the neighborhoods surrounding Franklin Park.

Following the SJC’s ruling, the Legacy’s project team conducted a “comprehensive review of the remaining construction schedule,” which indicated the stadium will not be ready for the start of the 2027 NWSL season in February.

“It is a very complex project, this stadium, and with this lawsuit giving some uncertainty, as well,” Epstein said. “There’s certain things that you can’t actually understand with respect to a construction project until you’re fully in the ground.”

Even before the ruling, the Legacy brass was working on contingency plans. The club has been weighing options for weeks, including the possibility of starting next season at Centreville Bank Stadium before shifting to White Stadium for the final few games.

But the Legacy knew even before the ruling that White Stadium likely wouldn’t be a viable option for the start of next season, which is a little more than six months away.

The city said the stadium will now open in the fall of 2027, but there’s no guarantee that opening will come before the end of the NWSL season, and according to Legacy president Jennifer van Dijk, “you can’t sell tickets with hope” that the team may play its final few games there next season.

The team decided to follow the path of certainty.

“We’re very excited to be able to, with clarity, share with our fans what the next two years are going to look like,” Epstein said.

Current season-ticket holders will be offered a two-year member-

ship renewal to secure their White Stadium tickets for 2028. The renewal will include seats for the 2027 season at Centreville Bank Stadium.

“We share in the fans’ disappointment, but we also, alongside them, believe in this club’s long-term vision,” van Dijk told the Globe.

The Legacy have played their last six home games at Centreville Bank Stadium after starting the year at Gillette Stadium. The 10,500-seat venue in Pawtucket, home to USL team Rhode Island FC, is a soccer-specific stadium with a compact configuration much like the planned White Stadium.

“We want this to be a place where the club can win games, build momentum, and give its supporters an outstanding fan experience,” Paul Byrne, general manager of Centreville Bank Stadium, said in a statement.

Work on the White Stadium site, which has been underway since early 2025, is ongoing, and crews employed by the City of Boston and the team are working six days a week. The foundations of the two grandstands are in place, as are structural steel elements and elevator shafts, according to footage from the web and live cameras at the site.

When it’s complete, the stadium intends to be a state-of-the-art, 10,500-seat facility shared by the Legacy and Boston Public Schools athletics.

According to the team, the project will triple public access to the venue from 35 to 105 hours per week, while more than doubling BPS programming, from approximately 250 to at least 700 hours annually.

The renovation of the stadium was a central piece of Legacy ownership group Boston Unity Soccer Partners’ successful bid to receive an NWSL expansion team for the 2026 season, as the league requires prospective owners to present clear, committed infrastructure plans.

“Boston Legacy FC has an exciting long-term vision for women’s soccer in the city of Boston, and we remain confident in the club’s plans for the future,” an NWSL spokesperson said in a statement when reached for comment on the Legacy’s new stadium timeline.

In addition to renovating White Stadium, the club also is in the process of building a privately funded, \$60 million training facility in Brockton, which will open in November.

“All we want to make happen is to get that stadium ready,” Epstein said. “That’s been the focus of an incredible amount of work since we launched the bid for this club.”

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Baseball

INTERNATIONAL LEAGUE

EAST					WEST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB		W	L	Pct.	GB
Rochester	32	21	.604		Indianapolis	33	20	.623	—
Scranton/W-Barre	29	21	.580	1½	St. Paul	31	22	.585	2
Durham	30	22	.577	1½	Nashville	26	26	.500	6½
Buffalo	28	24	.538	3½	Gwinnett	26	27	.491	7
Worcester	28	24	.538	3½	Columbus	25	26	.490	7
Syracuse	27	25	.519	4½	Omaha	25	26	.490	7
Lehigh Valley	26	25	.510	5	Toledo	23	28	.474	10
Charlotte	26	27	.491	6	Iowa	23	30	.434	10
Jacksonville	22	30	.423	9½	Memphis	23	30	.434	10
Norfolk	19	31	.380	11½	Louisville	18	35	.340	15

THURSDAY’S RESULTS				
At Worcester 7.....	Scranton/W-B 1			
At Indianapolis 6.....	Columbus 5			
Gwinnett 5.....	at Louisville 3			
Syracuse (ppd.).....	at Lehigh Valley 3			
At Rochester 7.....	Buffalo 3			
Norfolk 5.....	at Durham 4			
Memphis 3.....	at Charlotte 2			
At Jacksonville 10.....	Nashville 8			
At Iowa 7.....	Omaha 6			
Toledo 9.....	St. Paul 3			

FRIDAY’S GAMES				
Scranton/W-B at Worcester.....	6:05			
Nashville at Jacksonville.....	12:05			
Memphis at Charlotte.....	5:05			
Norfolk at Durham.....	6:45			
Buffalo at Rochester.....	6:45			
Syracuse at Lehigh Valley.....	6:45			
Columbus at Indianapolis.....	7:05			
Gwinnett at Louisville.....	7:15			
Toledo at St. Paul.....	8:07			
Omaha at Iowa.....	8:08			

Worcester, 7-1

At Polar Park, Worcester										
SCR./W-B	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.			
Volpe 2b	3	0	0	1	0	2	.215			
Dominguez cf	0	1	0	0	0	2	.263			
Garver c	3	0	0	0	1	1	.179			
Escarra dh	3	1	1	0	1	2	.282			
Schuemman 3b	4	0	1	1	0	2	.254			
Cabrera ss	2	0	0	1	2	0	.267			
Luciano if	4	0	0	0	3	2	.282			
Capra 2b	4	1	2	0	0	0	.277			
Hickey c	4	1	1	0	1	0	.204			
Cheng ss	4	1	2	0	1	0	.231			
Hardman 1b	3	0	1	0	1	1	.232			
Totals	30	1	5	1	6	13				

WORCESTER AB R H BI BB SO Avg.										
Anthony if	4	1	2	1	0	0	.333			
Falefa 1b	1	2	2	0	1	0	.182			
Story dh	3	0	1	1	0	0	.156			
Eaton cf	4	1	1	1	0	1	.261			
Campbell rf	4	0	1	1	0	2	.244			
Wils 1b	3	0	0	0	1	2	.267			
Capra 2b	4	1	2	0	0	0	.277			
Hickey c	4	1	1	0	1	0	.204			
Cheng ss	4	1	2	0	1	0	.231			
Totals	34	7	11	7	1	8				

LOB—Scr./W-B 8, Worcester 5. **2B**—Schuemann, Eaton, Campbell, Anthony, Cheng. **SB**—Hardman, Falefa. **S**—

LOB—Scr./W-B 8, Worcester 5, 2B—Schuemman, Eaton, Campbell, Anthony, Cheng, SB—Hardman, Falefa. S—Story, DP—Worcester 2.				
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Scr./W-B IP H R ER BB SO ERA										
Kloffenstein 5	6	3	3	3	0	5.24				
Coleman	1	4	4	1	1	18.10				
MacGregor	2	1	0	0	2	1.08				

Worcester IP H R ER BB SO ERA						
Wehnt	5	4	1	1	2	4.34
Berrios	2	0	0	0	3	4.85
Martinez	2	1	0	0	1	5.35

T—2:43. A—7:18.

EASTERN LEAGUE

NORTHEAST					SOUTHWEST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB		W	L	Pct.	GB
Reading.....	31	21	.596		Erie.....	35	18	.660	
Somerset.....	28	25	.528	3½	Chesapeake 2.....	28	24	.538	6½
Binghamton.....	27	26	.509	4½	Richmond.....	28	24	.538	6½
Portland.....	26	27	.491	5½	Harrisburg.....	26	25	.510	8
New Hampshire.....	21	32	.396	10½	Akron.....	24	27	.471	10
Hartford.....	19	34	.358	12½	Altoona.....	21	31	.404	13½

THURSDAY’S RESULTS				
Portland 11.....	at Richmond 2			
At Altoona 9.....	Erie 5			
At New Hampshire 7.....	Hartford 3			
At Harrisburg 2.....	Chesapeake 0			
At Somerset 8.....	Akron 6			
Binghamton (ppd.).....	at Reading			

FRIDAY’S GAMES				
Portland at Richmond.....	7:05			
Erie at Altoona.....	7:10			
Hartford at New Hampshire.....	6:03			
Akron at Somerset.....	6:35			
Binghamton at Reading.....	6:45			
Chesapeake at Harrisburg.....	7			

WEDNESDAY’S RESULTS				
Portland 5.....	at Richmond 4			
At Altoona 6.....	Erie 1			
At New Hampshire 5.....	Hartford 4			
At Harrisburg 5.....	Chesapeake 0			
Akron 7.....	at Somerset 5			
At Reading 6.....	Binghamton 2			

Portland, 11-2

Garcia c	4	1	1	0	0	1	.282
Godbout ss	4	3	1	2	0	0	.196
Taylor lf	4	2	1	0	1	1	.186
Liendo 3b	4	2	2	3	1	1	.238
Turner cf	4	0	0	0	1	2	.184
Rose 2b	4	0	0	0	1	2	.214
Totals	37	11	10	10	8	7	

RICHMOND AB R H BI BB SO Avg.										
Gonzales rf	4	0	0	0	0	0	.285			
Ceballos 3b	5	0	0	0	0	0	.283			
Diaz rf	3	0	1	1	0	0	.167			
Zielinski 2b	2	0	1	0	0	0	.205			
Ahuna ss	4	0	1	0	1	0	.227			
Wagner if	4	0	1	1	0	0	.282			
Payton 1b	4	0	2	0	0	0	.287			
Carlos Sio 2b	2	1	0	0	1	1	.229			
Hanchey c	3	0	1	0	0	1	.250			
Croes p	5	1	2	0	0	0	.262			
Totals	32	9	11	3	4	6				

Portland.....	020 050 220	—	11	0
Richmond.....	100 100 000	—	2	9

LOB—Port. 9, Richmond 12, 2B—Brannon, Payton, HR—Godbout, Liendo, SB—Godbout, 2, Ferguson, Diaz, 2, Croes, Ceballos, Ahuna, DP—Port. 1.				
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Portland IP H R ER BB SO ERA										
Brooks	2	2	1	1	2	15.40				
Bolden	2	1	1	1	0	5.76				
Vogtelsky	4	0	1	1	3	5.23				
White	1	2	0	0	0	0.00				

Richmond IP H R ER BB SO ERA						
Mendez	2	3	2	2	1	2.386
Stanavich	2	1	1	1	1	4.540
Mercedes	1	3	4	1	1	6.80
White	1½	0	1	1	1	6.20
Hill City	4	0	1	1	3	5.23
Croes	2½	2	2	2	1	0.771

HBP—by Bolden, by White, by Mendez, by White. T—3:12. A—7:237.

SOUTH ATLANTIC LEAGUE

NORTH					SOUTH				
	W	L	Pct.	GB		W	L	Pct.	GB
Frederick.....	33	21	.611	—	Bowling Green.....	30	25	.545	—
Greensboro.....	33	23	.589	1	Winston-Salem.....	29	26	.521	1
Hudson Valley.....	32	24	.571	1	Greenville.....	28	28	.500	2½
Wilmington.....	24	30	.444	4	Rome.....	25	30	.455	5
Brooklyn.....	29	26	.527	4½	Ashville.....	24	31	.436	6
Jersey Shore.....	18	37	.327	15½	Hub City.....	21	35	.375	9½

	W	L	Pct.	GB
Bowling Green.....	30	25	.545	—
Winston-Salem.....	29	26	.527	—
Greenville.....	28	28	.500	2½
Rome.....	25	30	.455	5
Ashville.....	24	31	.438	6
Hub City.....	21	35	.375	9½
THURSDAY'S RESULTS				
At Greenville 7.....	Rome 1			
At Greensboro 11.....	Hub City 4			
At Winston-Salem 10.....	Bowling Green 7			
Brooklyn 5.....	at Hudson Valley 2			
Ashville (ppd.).....	at Frederick			
Wilmington (ppd.).....	at Jersey Shore			



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Returning All-Scholastic Elise Cecere is committed to play at Providence College next year.

HIGH SCHOOL FIELD HOCKEY

Lincoln-Sudbury eyes legacy

By Inaaya Omer
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

No one told the players to arrive an hour early to Lincoln-Sudbury field hockey tryouts Monday morning.

They did it anyway, then ran the annual three-mile run known as Water Row, joined by alum Paula Verma and head coach Vicky Caburian.

After advancing to the Division 1 quarterfinals last fall, L-S is determined to make a run at a state title. Despite seven players now committed to college programs, including five who are Division 1 bound, Caburian emphasized talent alone won't outweigh strong chemistry.

"I think we have an opportunity to create a legacy team this year," said Caburian, who is entering her 28th season. "We've got some great players in place as far as potential, and it's just a matter of figuring out the chemistry and positioning. We've got a lot of strong returning players and great leadership, so I'm really excited to get the season started."

Caburian took a different approach with her leadership, appointing 11 seniors to form a captains' council rather than the typical two-to-four team captains. It already is fostering a sense of community.

"I actually really like it because once you're a senior you have that responsibility automatically, and I think that everyone takes being a captain differently," said senior Isabelle Waugh. "I think it's really cool for young women to have the opportunity to lead and be responsible for a team. "Also there's no drama of who's the captain, who isn't captain."

While chemistry is vital, talent still counts. The Warriors feature senior Elise Cecere, who is committed to Providence; Waugh, who will play at Tufts; Sabrina Tibbert, a senior forward committed to New Hampshire; Avery and Emerson Acquaviva, seniors committed to play lacrosse at Penn State; plus Indiana-bound junior Madison Porter and goalie Kaitlin Page, who plans to play at McDaniel.

"[Elise is] just an outstanding player. I really love her intensity, I love her competitiveness and her skill-set," Caburian said. "Isabelle . . . she's a strong defender who will definitely be a quarterback in the backfield. Sabrina's . . . a very strong forward. I know that she's got a great sense of the

game, has really improved her skills and will definitely be scoring a lot of goals for us. Avery and Emerson Acquaviva . . . are amazing athletes and just high-intensity players."

Cecere, a returning Globe All-Scholastic selection, Waugh, and Tibbert have played together on the Strikers club team since eighth grade. Tibbert said that chemistry has carried over to L-S.

"I've known them [Avery and Emerson Acquaviva] basically my entire life and same thing with Elise, she's known them for a really long time as well," said Tibbert. "We've always had that chemistry off the field, and now we've been able to have the opportunity to bring it on the field."

Waugh shared how their strengths complement each other.

"Sabrina is very loud and she's just a good leader. She knows what everyone's supposed to be doing. Elise is just a really good player and so that also shines through with her leadership," Waugh said. "All of us have grown together so it's just been really, really fun."

Still, Caburian said success will pivot on how quickly the players jell on the field once the season begins.

"It's a clean slate. You never know what you're going to get until you actually get them on the field, but I would just say that I'm really excited to see what the chemistry is on the team. There's a lot of potential as far as skill and hockey IQ," said Caburian. "I think with this group of leaders, we have a great opportunity to go deep into the tournament."

Last season, the Warriors went 13-3-3, a season-ending shootout loss to Winchester motivating the returning players.

"It obviously stinks, you put in more than an hour's worth of effort, a lot of work on your body . . . and then obviously an unfortunate ending," said Cecere.

Although the goal is to win a state championship, whatever happens, several players said the team's bond will outlast this season.

"I think a team goal for this year is for everyone to have fun, focus in practice, focus in games, but be able to shift from practice and social life," said Avery Acquaviva. "We compete against each other and work really hard, but at the end of the day we're going to be sisters for life and I want to be able to cherish that."

SportsLog

Jets' Hellebuyck says he wants a trade

Three-time Vezina Trophy-winning goaltender **Connor Hellebuyck** publicly confirmed he's asked the Winnipeg Jets to trade him. In a statement released by his agent, **Ray Petkau**, Hellebuyck said he made the request several months ago and "tried to handle the situation quietly and respectfully while giving the organization time to explore its options." Hellebuyck said he felt it was important to go public because training camp is fast approaching. Hellebuyck, 33, has played his entire NHL career with the Jets and was voted MVP in the 2024-25 season. He backstopped the United States to the gold medal at the Olympics in February. Jets general manager **Kevin Chevel-dayoff** acknowledged he's been working to trade the former UMass Lowell netminder, but otherwise had no update. Hellebuyck had a career-worst .895 save percentage last season as Winnipeg missed the playoffs. He has 345 wins, a 2.58 goals-against average, and a .916 save percentage since entering the league in 2015, but the Jets have only made it beyond the second round of the playoffs once. He signed an eight-year, \$59.5 million extension in October 2023.

SOCCER

Revolution add Siqueira

After playing his first two matches for the Revolution, Easton native **Judah Siqueira** signed a Homegrown Player contract with the club, it announced. The 17-year-old midfielder is the 17th player to make the jump from the Revolution Academy to the MLS roster. Siqueira joined the Revolution Academy in 2022. He scored 25 goals for the under-16 squad in 2024-25 before moving up to the under-18s for 2025-26. He made 23 appearances in MLS Next Pro for Revolution II, scoring two winning goals this year. Siqueira made his MLS debut in a 3-0 win over D.C. United on Aug. 19 and was a substitute in Sunday's 1-1 draw with New York City FC . . . The Revolution's Sept. 9 game at NYCFC has been moved back 30 minutes to 8 p.m. On Wednesday, the team announced this weekend's game at Columbus has been moved to 4:30 p.m. Sunday. It had been scheduled for Saturday night.

UEFA still after Infantino

UEFA is preparing a criminal complaint against FIFA president **Gianni Infantino** in Swiss courts for possible financial mismanagement over his failed plan to sell future World Cup profits to private investors. The governing body of European soccer announced its intentions in court documents filed Thursday in the United States seeking access to possible evidence related to the sell-off plan, which was withdrawn after a furious backlash by UEFA and other global soccer leaders. UEFA filed documents in a Manhattan court requesting discovery of potential evidence from the New York investment fund Thrive Capital Management, founded by **Josh Kushner** — the younger brother of **President Trump's** son-in-law, **Jared Kushner**. UEFA also filed a request in a southern Florida district for authorization of discovery "in a foreign proceeding" against FIFA itself, which has offices in the Miami suburb of Coral Gables.

COLLEGES

ACC bans pros; SEC blocked

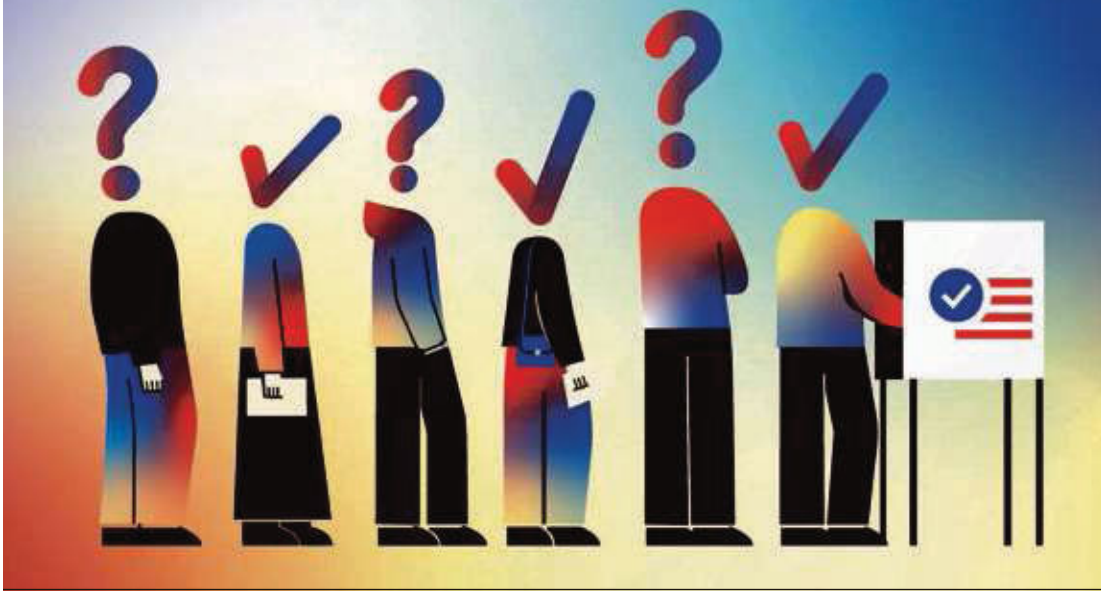
The Atlantic Coast Conference joined its power conference peers in banning players who were on NFL rosters from returning to college football, but the Southeastern Conference's similar ruling was blocked via a temporary restraining order by Dallas County Judge **Martin Hoffman**. The ACC's ban also covers professional athletes returning to play men's or women's college basketball. It comes a day after the Big 12's ruling and followed moves by the SEC and Big Ten earlier this week. "Just to me, that's kind of a cutoff, when a guy goes pro," N.C. State football coach **Dave Doeren** said. "And we say 'Goodbye, good luck,' and we move on." The Mountain West, a Group of Six conference, passed a similar prohibition hours after the ACC announcement . . . **Eddie Buehler** threw for 199 yards and two touchdowns as Maine won at Towson, 21-18, in its football opener. Linebacker **Sam Oppenheimer** stripped Towson receiver **Cleveland Charlton** after making the reception and **Jake Kucera** recovered for the Black Bears with 1:22 remaining.

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BY CITY AND TOWN

ARLINGTON PONTES, Margaret T. (Kelley)	WEST ROXBURY KELLY, Maureen Killilea
CAMBRIDGE PONTES, Margaret T. (Kelley)	WESTWOOD KELLY, Maureen Killilea
MELROSE KELLY, Maureen Killilea	
MISSION HILL KELLY, Maureen Killilea	
READING KELLY, Maureen Killilea	

KELLY, Maureen Killilea

Formerly of Westwood and Mission Hill, passed away, on August 22, 2026. Beloved wife of the late Francis J. “Frank” Kelly. Loving daughter of the late John J. and Mary M. (Small) Killilea, originally from Co. Galway. Dear sister of Thomas W. Killilea and wife, Margaret F. (Mahoney) of Watertown, Catherine S. Dietz of Brooklyn, NY and the late John P. Killilea, James M. Killilea and SP4 Martin Francis Killilea, U.S. Army. Loving sister-in-law to Catherine M. (Walsh) Killilea of Canton, Delia A. (McTigue) Killilea of Framingham; and late brother-in-law, William R. Dietz, Austin I. Kelly; and late sister-in-law, Jeanne I. (Kelly) Vetere. Dear cousin of Mary P. (Small) Gardiner of Dedham. Devoted mother to Anne-Marie Knighton and her husband, Ernest of Edenton, NC and Colette T. McGonagle and her husband, Kevin of Melrose. Loving aunt to many nieces, nephews, grandnieces, and grandnephews. Relatives and friends invited to attend Visiting Hours at William J. Gormley Funeral Home, 2055 Centre St., WEST ROXBURY, on Sunday, August 30, from 2 pm - 5 pm. Funeral from the funeral home on Monday, August 31, at 9 am, followed by Mass of Christian Burial at St. Theresa Church, at 10 am. Interment in St. Joseph Cemetery. Retired elementary school teacher in the Walpole School District. Donations in Maureen’s memory may be made to the Mission Church Restoration Fund, 1545 Tremont St., Boston, MA 02120. For directions and guestbook, visit www.gormleyfuneral.com

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PONTES, Margaret T. (Kelley)



Of Arlington, MA, formerly of Cambridge, MA, passed away peacefully, surrounded by family, on August 23, 2026. Beloved wife of the late Richard J. Pontes. Loving mother of Valerie Coll and husband, Dennis Coll, of Silver Spring, MD, Regina Pontes, of Arlington, MA, the late Patricia Haviland and her surviving husband, David Haviland and the late Richard James Pontes, both of Arlington, MA. Grandmother of Michael Haviland of New York; Kathryn Conroy and Marty Conroy, of Burlington, MA, Daniel Coll, of VA and Elizabeth Coll, of Silver Spring, MD. Great-grandmother of Vivian, Martin Jr., Liam, and Luke. Sister of James Kelley, of Cambridge MA, Raymond Kelley and his wife, Ruthie Kelley, both of Arlington, MA and Virginia Kelley, of Somerville, MA. Beloved sister of the late Mary Doherty, Francis Kelley, Kevin Kelley, Kathleen Kelley, Ellen Briggs, and Christine Kelley. Also survived by many loving in-laws, nieces, and nephews. Relatives and friends are kindly invited to a Visitation at St. Eulalia Church, 50 Ridge St., Winchester, MA, on Monday, August 31, at 11:30 AM, followed by her Funeral Mass at 12:00 PM. Interment will follow at Mount Pleasant Cemetery, Arlington, MA. In lieu of flowers, please donate to Tunnels to Towers. To view an online guestbook, please visit www.brownandhickey.com

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Obituaries



PETER DEJONG/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Mr. Mladic sat in the courtroom in The Hague, Netherlands, when he was tried on charges of genocide, crimes against humanity, and war crimes.

Ratko Mladic, 83, ‘Butcher of Bosnia’

By Dan Bilefsky
NEW YORK TIMES

Ratko Mladic, the former Bosnian Serb general whose actions during the Balkan wars of the 1990s led to him being called the “Butcher of Bosnia” and who was held responsible for Europe’s deadliest massacre since World War II, the killing of some 8,000 Muslim men and boys at Srebrenica in 1995, has died in custody in The Hague. He was 83.

His death was announced Thursday by Serbian state media. Authorities at The Hague said he died while hospitalized there but did not provide a specific cause of death.

Mr. Mladic was captured May 26, 2011, in a farming village north of Belgrade, Serbia’s capital, after almost 16 years as a fugitive, ending one of the longest searches in modern history. His 2017 conviction by an international tribunal on charges of genocide, crimes against humanity, and war crimes marked the end of a dark and bloody chapter.

In pronouncing a life sentence, the presiding judge, Alphons Orie, said Mr. Mladic’s crimes ranked “among the most heinous known to humankind.” Mr. Mladic appealed the verdict, which was upheld in 2021.

The Balkan wars erupted as Yugoslavia was breaking up into independent states. Slobodan Milosevic, the nationalist president of Serbia, one of those states, was intent on creating a Greater Serbia. He reawakened old ethnic and religious enmities and started wars pitting Serbs against Slovenes, Croats, Bosniaks, and the Albanians of Kosovo.

Roughly 100,000 people died during the conflict, and more than 2.5 million were displaced.

A ruddy-faced and intimidating man with a bellowing voice, piercing blue eyes, and a grandiose sense of himself, Mr. Mladic, an officer in the Yugoslav People’s Army, led the army of the Bosnian Serbs in the early 1990s.

On the eve of the Srebrenica massacre, he promised to avenge the conquest of Serbia centuries before by the Ottoman Muslim Turks. Over 10 days, his soldiers hunted down, captured, and summarily executed thousands of Bosniaks, lining them up with hands tied behind their backs and shooting them. Women were raped. International pleas for restraint were ignored.

Serb forces buried the remains, dug them up again, and scattered them in distant mass graves in an organized effort to hide damning evidence of war crimes.

Mr. Mladic’s trial was among the last high-profile ones at the International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia in The Hague. The tribunal wound down after trying nearly 100 of those responsible for the atrocities of the Balkan wars, including Mladic’s boss, Radovan Karadzic, the political leader of the Bosnian Serbs.

Arrested in 2008, Karadzic was convicted in 2016 on charges almost identical to Mr. Mladic’s, and his sentence was extended to life in prison three years later.

Mr. Mladic’s arrest was a signal moment in Serbia’s long effort to shed its status as a pari-

ah nation. It removed a major obstacle to the country’s still-pending accession to the European Union, which had grown weary of the refusal of successive Serbian governments to capture him.

When he was finally tracked down, he was hiding in the house of a cousin and was so desperate for money that one of his repeated demands was the restoration of his frozen military pension.

During his trial, Mr. Mladic, once a seemingly invincible warrior, at times appeared reduced to a meek old man as witness after witness offered harrowing testimony about the violence he had unleashed. His right arm was impaired by the effects of at least two strokes he suffered while a fugitive, and he was unable to take notes.

Flashes of the mercurial, domineering general remained, though. In his first court appearance in June 2011, he dismissed the charges against him as “obnoxious” and “monstrous.” At other times, he yelled at the judges.

At one point, he was absent from a session, apparently to receive treatment for high blood pressure. When he returned, he raged at the bench, shouting, “Everything you are saying is a pure lie!” He was removed from the court.

In addition to masterminding the massacre at Srebrenica, he was eventually also convicted of multiple crimes tied to the nearly four-year siege of Sarajevo, Bosnia’s capital, in which 10,000 people died, including 1,500 children.

During the siege, the longest in the history of modern warfare, Mr. Mladic’s men shelled the city from surrounding mountains and terrorized civilians with sniper bullets. Judges also found him guilty of the persecution and extermination of non-Serbs living in large swaths of Bosnia.

Within Serbia, Mr. Mladic’s military prowess was legendary. Ljiljana Bulatovic, who wrote a biography of him, said he remained a hero to many Serbs, who would always regard him as “the mythical protector of the Serbian people.”

But the magnitude of the crimes he was accused of — and the immense suffering he inflicted on Bosnians and Croats driven from lands slated for Serbs — provoked international revulsion.

His early life of desolation and struggle may have helped sustain him during his long, spartan years as a fugitive.

“He had a strong psychological makeup,” Ratko Skrbic, a former general who served under him, later said. “It has to do with military honor. He was brought up never to surrender.”

Ratko Mladic was born into poverty in the remote village of Bozanovici on March 12, 1943, when the area was part of the Independent State of Croatia, a Nazi puppet state dominated by fanatical Croat nationalists.

His father, Neda Mladic, an ethnic Serb member of the communist-led partisan resistance, was killed when Ratko was a toddler, and his mother, Stana (Lalovic) Mladic, raised him and his two siblings. His family’s experience planted in Mr. Mladic a deep fear that ethnic Serbs, unless they held the upper hand, would always face persecution by Croats and oth-

er ethnic groups.

He was a metalworker as a young man but soon turned toward the military for his schooling. With his sharp mind, physical strength, and a charisma that inspired deep loyalty, Mr. Mladic rose swiftly in the Yugoslav People’s Army.

He was said to have adhered early in his military career to Josip Broz Tito’s brand of communism, which rejected nationalism and called instead for Yugoslav brotherhood as a way of holding together Yugoslavia’s fragile assemblage of multiethnic, multireligious republics.

Tito died in 1980, and after Milosevic stirred up nationalist grudges and Yugoslavia had begun to disintegrate in the early 1990s, Mr. Mladic took up Milosevic’s cause: halting separatism and assuring the dominance of the Serbs, the largest ethnic group. In 1992, a month after the Bosnian Republic’s declaration of independence, Mr. Mladic’s forces began the siege of Sarajevo.

In 1994, his daughter, Ana, a medical student in her early 20s, killed herself with his prized military pistol, apparently distraught by her father’s actions in the war.

Zoran Stankovic, a former Serbian minister of defense and friend of Mr. Mladic’s who performed her autopsy, later said Mr. Mladic had asked him to cut off a lock of her hair and extract the bullet from her head, and to give them both to him as mementos.

Friends said he became unhinged after her death, and he insisted on visiting her grave under guard before his extradition from Serbia to The Hague.

“After the suicide,” Stankovic said, “I never saw brightness in his eyes, only sadness.”

Before the massacre at Srebrenica, Mr. Mladic summoned the Dutch commander of a United Nations peacekeeping force that was protecting the Muslim community there and ushered him to a room where a live pig was tied up.

Mladic ordered his men to slit the pig’s throat, sending blood gushing over the floor. “That’s how we deal with our enemies,” Mr. Mladic said, according to witnesses.

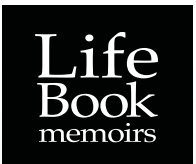
In July 1995, with video cameras rolling, Mr. Mladic’s bodyguards handed out candies to Bosniak children. “No one will be harmed,” Mr. Mladic told terrified women and children July 12, patting a young boy on the head. At the time, his soldiers were preparing to conduct the mass killings.

After the massacre, the outrage in Washington and Europe prompted a NATO bombing campaign that overcame Bosnian Serb forces and led to the Dayton Accords, which ended the Balkan wars in December 1995, though conflict in the former Yugoslavia erupted again in 1998 over Kosovo.

In 1995, the international tribunal in The Hague, which had been created two years earlier, indicted Mr. Mladic on war crimes and genocide charges related to the Sarajevo siege and the Srebrenica massacre.

In the end, he was captured alone, with two loaded pistols at his side, and surrendered willingly.

“Congratulations,” he said when officers stormed in. “I’m the one you’ve been looking for.”



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Obituaries

Yayoi Kusama, 97, Japanese artist who expanded abstract art

By Holland Cotter
NEW YORK TIMES

Yayoi Kusama, a Japanese artist whose polka-dot-covered paintings, phallic sculptures, and public performances caused a stir in New York City and Europe in the 1960s, and whose mirrored “Infinity Room” installations became selfie sensations and blockbuster museum and gallery attractions in recent decades, died Aug. 14 in Tokyo. She was 97.

The Yayoi Kusama Museum and the Yayoi Kusama Foundation announced her death, at a hospital, on Thursday.

Ms. Kusama first gained attention in the late 1950s and early 1960s with her immense abstract paintings that she called “Infinity Nets.” These were composed of countless small, curving strokes of white paint on all-white or all-black surfaces, suggesting giant, swirling meshes pierced with pin-prick holes.

Far larger in scale than the Abstract Expressionist works that still dominated New York galleries, her pieces quickly attracted the notice of young artists who were trying to take American art in new directions. One was Donald Judd, who was working at the time as an art critic and formulating what would become Minimalism. He began championing her work.

Creating art incrementally from repeated components became Ms. Kusama’s fixed working mode, and she applied it to sculpture. In the early 1960s, she began sewing thousands of stuffed fabric phalluses, painting them white or gold, and gluing them onto the surface of everyday objects — tables, armchairs, coats, shoes, a baby carriage, a rowboat — to create bristling room-filling installations.

These “Accumulation Sculptures” made their debut, along with work by Claes Oldenburg, James Rosenquist, and Andy Warhol, in a 1962 group show at Green Gallery that was among the first exhibitions of pop art. With that, Ms. Kusama became a pioneer in the two major avant-garde styles of the day, pop and minimalism.

Although her work was often taken to be assertively erotic, its intended effect was the opposite. As Ms. Kusama explained in an autobiography published in Japan in 2002, she found sexual organs threatening, a reaction she traced back to infantile experiences. Yet she frequently had herself photographed lying scantily dressed or nude on fields of tumid forms.

“By continually reproducing the forms of things that terrify me,” she wrote, “I am able to suppress the fear.”

Yayoi Kusama was born March 22, 1929, into a prosperous middle-class family with deep roots in the city of Matsuyama, northwest of Tokyo. She was the youngest of four children. Her father, Kamon Kusama, and mother, Shigeru Kusama, helped oversee the family’s wholesale seed business.

Ms. Kusama took steps to be a professional artist as a teenager, an extremely unusual move for a woman in conservative postwar Japan. In 1948, over the objections of her parents, she enrolled in art school in Kyoto and

studied Nihonga painting, a style that merged Japanese and Western traditions.

But chafing at academic discipline and the style’s association with wartime nationalism, she went her own way. Immersing herself in reports of surrealist-inspired art in Paris and New York, and keeping a close eye on avant-garde developments in Japan itself, Ms. Kusama produced hundreds of semiabstract paintings that set floral, astronomical, and sexual forms against fields of dots and spiky lines.

She later said that such images reflected fearful, engulfing hallucinations that had plagued her all her life. “I am pursuing art in order to correct the disability which began in my childhood,” she said.

Ms. Kusama began gaining attention while in her teens. In 1955, three of her paintings were sent to New York for inclusion in an international watercolor exhibition at the Brooklyn Museum, and she began to make plans to move to the United States.

Needing advice on how to establish a career there, she wrote to Georgia O’Keeffe — the only American woman artist she knew of — having tracked down her New Mexico address through the American Embassy.

O’Keeffe replied with encouragement, and in 1957 Ms. Kusama flew to Seattle, where she lived for about six months before moving on to New York City.

From her base there, the allure of her personal presence increasingly became a component of her art. She was very aware that as an Asian woman she projected an exotic outsider presence in the city’s art world, an identity that had useful potential for her career. Calibrated orientalism became the substance of some of the public performance work she developed in the mid-to late-1960s, when she aligned herself with rising hippie culture.

In a series of anti-authoritarian and specifically anti-Vietnam War happenings starting in 1966, Ms. Kusama made guerrilla appearances in strategic locations throughout New York City — Wall Street, the Statue of Liberty, and the Museum of Modern Art Sculpture Garden — leading a group of male and female volunteers. At her cue, they would strip down and pose as she painted their nude bodies with polka dots, to which she sometimes attributed magical properties.

“With those polka dots the people will self-obliterate and return to the nature of the universe,” she said.

Wearing dot-covered costumes, she remained fully clothed.

These events, which she called Body Festivals and Atomic Explosions, had pragmatic dimensions. The display of bare flesh was calculated to grab public attention; if the police showed up, all the better. Scandal was valuable for promoting her extra-aesthetic activities, which included a pop-up boutique, “Kusama’s Korner,” in Bloomingdale’s and a gay bar called “Kusama’s Omophile Klub.”

All of this was a success for a while. But trends were fleeting in that chaotic time, and as the Flower Child 1960s turned into

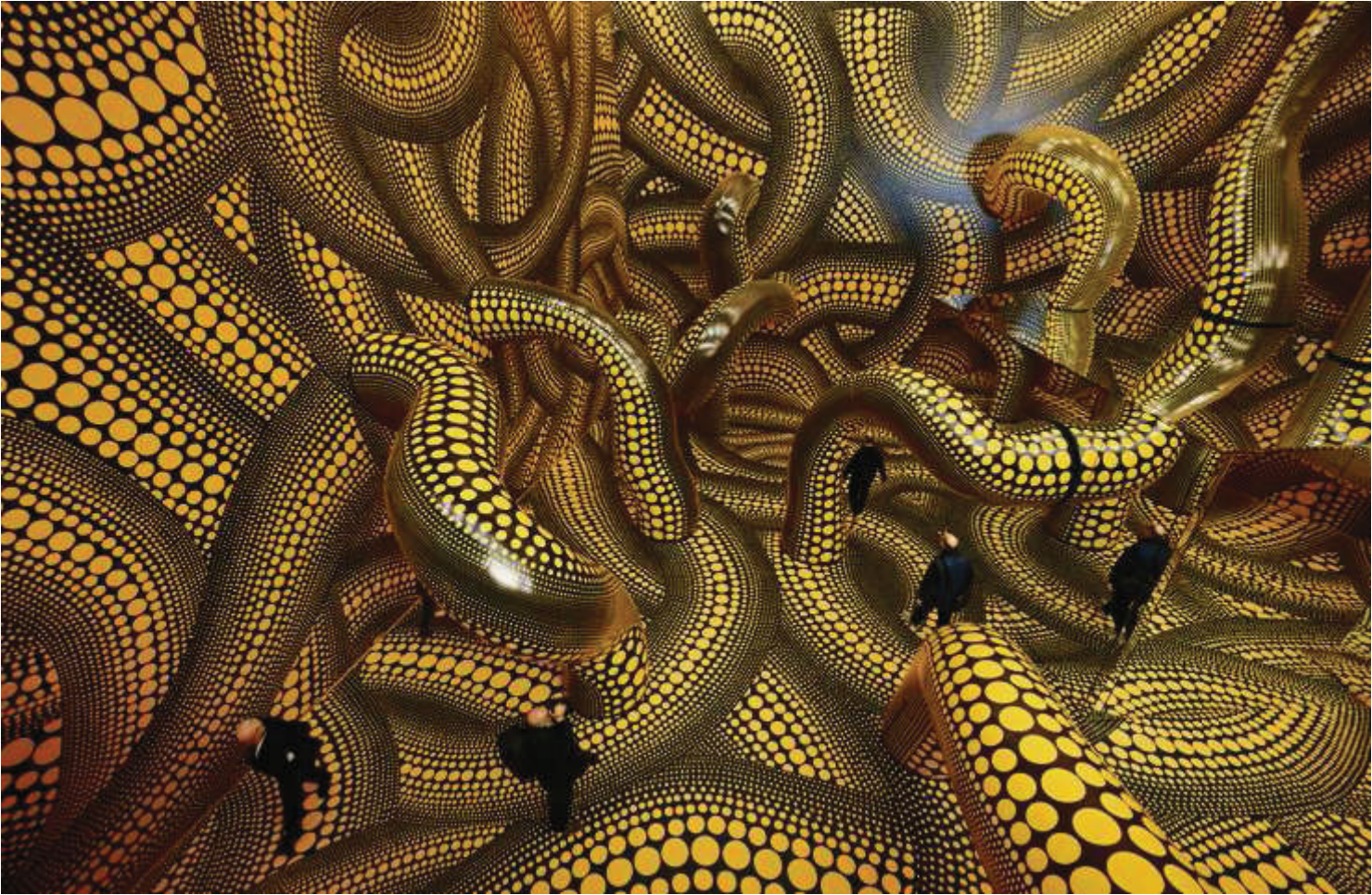


MOTOHIKO HASUI/NEW YORK TIMES



ODED BALITV/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Ms. Kusama (left) caused a stir in the West in the 1960s with polka-dot-covered paintings. Among her works: “The Spirits of the Pumpkins Descended into the Heavens” (top); “Infinity Mirrored Room The Hope of the Polka Dots Buried in Infinity Will Eternally Cover the Universe”; and “Longing for Eternity,” all of which invite patrons to walk through.



INA FASSBENDER/APF VIA GETTY IMAGES



VINCENT TULLO/NEW YORK TIMES

the grimmer 1970s, her art spectacles began to look old. Sensing that Americans had lost interest in her, she returned to Japan in 1973.

In Tokyo, to support herself, Ms. Kusama sold modern and contemporary Western art until the mid-1970s oil crisis ended the Japanese economic boom and forced her to seek other means of income. She began making collages inspired by American artist Joseph Cornell, with whom she had earlier formed an intense but platonic relationship.

She also began writing fiction, publishing more than a dozen novels, some of them, like “Manhattan Suicide Addict,” autobiographical. She wrote several volumes of poetry. All the activity was not enough to stave off panic attacks and hallucinations,

which became acute. In 1977 she admitted herself to the Seiwa mental hospital in Tokyo. She would make it her permanent home and build a studio nearby.

With the emotional security that the hospital environment afforded, she continued to work at high volume, creating a virtual industry in bright-color paintings, some with patterns suggesting capillary webs or swarms of spermatozoa, some incorporating figures and flowers and recalling her Surrealist-tinged work of the 1950s.

In the late 1990s and early 2000s, she returned to creating encompassing installations for the first time in three decades: rooms covered entirely in polka dots and endlessly reflective mirrored “Infinity Rooms.”

Her persistent effort to establish herself and her art as an in-

ternational brand paid off. In the 21st century, as Japanese contemporary art and popular culture gained attention, interest in her work soared, as did prices for it. She herself referred to the phenomenon as “Kusamania.”

When one of her 1960 “Infinity Net” paintings sold for \$7.1 million at Christie’s in 2014, it was the most expensive work by a living female artist ever bought at auction.

In recent years, she made lucrative arrangements to endorse commercial products, from cosmetics to cars. With her dot-patterned wardrobe and fluorescent page-boy-cut wigs, she was an instantly recognizable pop star, invited to contribute to international art shows and awarded shows of her own, often of new work produced with a platoon of assistants.

In 2017, a major survey of her work was organized by the Hirshhorn Museum in Washington, D.C. In the same year, a Yayoi Kusama Museum opened in Tokyo.

Also in 2017, an article in Vice magazine pointed out repeated anti-Black comments — specifically, racist descriptions of Black people — that Ms. Kusama had made in her 2002 autobiography. In 2023, on the occasion of a solo exhibition at the San Francisco Museum of Modern Art, when the accusations resurfaced, the artist publicly apologized for those comments.

Iterations of the poetic, endlessly reflective “Infinity Room” — a mirror-lined chamber housing an intricately twinkling LED light display — have been box office gold for museums and galleries, either as part of larger exhibitions or on their own. They’ve drawn enormous crowds, with visitors lining up for hours and entering one at a time for 45 seconds each, basically long enough to take a selfie, an exercise in aestheticized narcissism that the artist understood and endorsed.

Japan, though slow in coming to appreciate her, has also honored Ms. Kusama with exhibitions. She represented her home country at the 1993 Venice Biennale. (She had appeared in the 1966 Biennale representing herself, showing up in a gold kimono and passing out clips of her reviews.)

Information on her survivors was not immediately available.

Peter Cullen, voice actor who gave Optimus Prime of ‘Transformers’ a soul; at 85

By Sopan Deb
NEW YORK TIMES

Peter Cullen, a voice actor best known for bringing to life Optimus Prime in the “Transformers” franchise and the gloomy donkey Eeyore in “Winnie the Pooh” cartoons, died on Wednesday at his home in Los Angeles. He was 85.

His agent, Kevin Motley, confirmed the death, but did not specify a cause.

Mr. Cullen has said his favorite voice role was the one with which he was most closely associated: Optimus Prime, the honor-bound protagonist of the “Transformers” franchise, which began as a television cartoon series in 1984, based on a popular set of toys.

His take on the character was inspired by his brother Larry, who had served with the Marines in Vietnam. The brothers were roommates when Mr. Cullen auditioned for a role in the series, about robots that transform into other objects, like vehicles.

“I say, ‘I’m going to an audition,’” Mr. Cullen told the Los Angeles Times in 2014, recalling an exchange with his brother. “He says, ‘For what?’ I say, ‘I’m going to be a truck.’ He laughs. I say: ‘No, Larry. It’s a hero truck!’ He says, ‘A hero truck? Well, if you’re going to be a hero, be a real hero. Don’t be a jerk.’”

His brother then offered one final pointer: “Be strong enough to be gentle.”

Mr. Cullen remembered that counsel during the audition, adjusting his voice’s pitch to more closely mimic his older brother’s.

“His advice to me was that to be a leader, be strong and compassionate,” Mr. Cullen told The Calgary Herald in 2019. “Don’t be a yelling, screaming Hollywood phony. The tone of his voice was very, very clear and compassionate and soft with depth.

“I went to the audition and there it was. It was Larry, my brother, on the pages in front of me. That’s how I handled it.”

After the cartoon series, which ran for four seasons in syndication from 1984-87, Mr. Cullen reprised the role in several iterations of the “Transform-

ers” franchise, including video games, television series, and the Michael Bay-helmed live-action films, which were box office smashes in the 2000s.

The Optimus Prime character was killed off in a 1986 animated film. At a 2015 Transformers convention in Mississauga, Ontario, Mr. Cullen recalled reading the script with Frank Welker, who voiced Megatron, Optimus Prime’s mortal enemy.

“‘Hey Frank, I’m getting whacked on page 17,’” Mr. Cullen recalled telling Welker, according to an account in The Mississauga News. “I’m not coming back. There go the car payments.”

(After a backlash, Optimus Prime was revived in the third

season of the cartoon series.)

Mr. Cullen’s other notable role came when he was cast in 1988 as the voice of Eeyore, Winnie the Pooh’s grumpy friend, in “The New Adventures of Winnie the Pooh,” an animated series on ABC. He went on to reprise the role in films, other animated series, and straight-to-video releases.

“I enjoyed doing Eeyore because he was simply charming,” Mr. Cullen told NPR in 2014. “And I get an awful lot of reactions from, especially, young kids when I go up and just say” — he slipped into Eeyore’s voice — “Hello. Thanks for noticing me. And to see their faces light up, that to me is one of the great joys.”

Peter Claver Cullen was born July 28, 1941, in Montreal to American parents, Muriel McCann, a graduate of the American Academy of Dramatic Arts in New York, and Henry Laurence Cullen, an executive with the International Paper Sales Co.

He graduated from the National Theater School of Canada in 1963 and spent the early days of his career working in the Canadian theater and on satirical shows, including “Funny You Should Say That” on CBC Radio.

Mr. Cullen’s marriage to Carol Ann Balmer, a former Miss Canada, ended in divorce in 1982. They had two children, Peter Cullen Jr. and Claire Ann Cullen, both of whom he leaves. His brother Larry died in 2011.

Three New Englanders to compete on ‘Survivor’

By Matt Juul
GLOBE STAFF

“Survivor” has unveiled its latest crop of castaways, including a trio of New Englanders set to compete on the upcoming 51st season.

In a YouTube livestream on Wednesday, host Jeff Probst revealed the 21 contestants who will vie for the title of Sole Survivor when the long-running reality series returns Wednesday, Sept. 23, at 8 p.m. with a two-hour season premiere.

Three castaways with Rhode Island ties will appear in season 51 of “Survivor.” The livestream kicked off by introducing Aaliyah Puglia, a 24-year-old chef originally from New Jersey, according to a press release, who now lives in Providence.

“I’m a bold, independent woman who was raised by bold, independent women,” Puglia said during the livestream reveal. “I’m not here to find myself. I’m here to win the title and come back with something that my family can be proud of.”

Also hailing from New England is Eric Macksoud, a 34-year-old mental health counselor originally from Lincoln, R.I., who currently resides in



Eric Macksoud



Rob Antonson



PHOTOS BY ROBERT VOETS/CBS

Aaliyah Puglia

Windsor Locks, Conn., according to a press release. In the livestream, Macksoud opened up about some of the struggles he had growing up in a “primarily Italian-American” household with a strict dad.

“Whenever I would make a mistake, it was met with anger,” Macksoud said. “This is the ultimate game of lying and deceit, and I’m someone with abandonment issues and rejection wounds. I’m throwing myself in with the sharks.”

The third castaway with Rhode Island connections is Rob Antonson, a 40-year-old airline gate agent whose hometown is Johnston, R.I., although he currently lives in Cumberland, R.I., according to a press release. In the livestream introduction, Antonson talked about his job at Logan Airport (“It is craziness,” he quipped in a notable New England accent), as well as his family life (“Three kids, a beautiful wife I met on a cruise just as a solo guy,” he explained).

“I’m ready to kill it on ‘Survivor,’” Antonson said. “I’m ready to take it all. I’m ready to rip the \$1 million out of everyone’s hands and take it back to my kids.”

Following the premiere on Sept. 23, 90-minute episodes will air weekly, beginning on Sept. 30.

Matt Juul can be reached at matthew.juul@globe.com.



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Cape Cod’s quirky side

From R-rated alleys to haunted lighthouses

Some local people and paranormal researchers believe the Highland Lighthouse in North Truro and nearby cliffs are haunted.

By Diane Bair
and Pamela Wright
GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

One of us accidentally bought a sweat shirt with embroidered letters that read “CAPE ODD.” (No wonder it was on sale.) Which got us to thinking, there actually *are* some rather ODD places on the Cape — elements you wouldn’t expect to find in this coastal enclave. Here’s a look at a few Cape oddities and the stories behind them.

Bob Gasoi Memorial Art Alley, Provincetown

Artists are drawn to the Cape’s landscape of saltmarshes, sand dunes, and cedar-shingled cottages, bathed in luminous light. The ever-changing sea and sky have inspired creators for centuries. Provincetown in particular is a great spot for a gallery hop, but you might discover some intriguing art in an unlikely location: the alleyway at 290 Commercial St.

This short stretch — labeled provocative, primitive, and tasteless by some — is adorned with work by artist Bob Gasoi (1932-97.) Much of the work consists of jigsaw-cut figures from murals that Gasoi made for the old Shop Therapy store, open from 1987 to 2010. The assemblage was created by artist Arnie Charnick and assistant Bo Johnson, featuring biblical references, Greek mythology, Alice in Wonderland, and a nude woman holding a severed head. A woman spanking a man-monkey hybrid is a centerpiece. (Did we mention this alley is an R-rated attraction?) Some bits are faded, some are bright, and all will grab your attention. In an area where seascapes dominate the art scene, this art alley makes a splashy statement.

The Edward Gorey House, Yarmouth Port

Experience a different kind of art moment at The Edward Gorey House. Best known for his pen-and-ink drawings featuring maca-

bre themes and oddball characters in surreal Victorian and Edwardian settings, artist and author Gorey (1925-2000) owned this former sea captain’s house from 1979 to 2000. Today, it’s a house museum filled with his sometimes dark but always whimsical work, along with changing exhibitions, children’s events, and literary programs. Notably, the museum’s profits benefit animal rights and literacy; Gorey left his estate to a charitable trust that protects the welfare of all living creatures, including insects and invertebrates.

The Gorey House is open to the public from mid-April through December. \$10; 8 Strawberry Lane, Yarmouth Port; 508-362-3909; www.edwardgorey-house.org

The Old Jail, Barnstable

Haunted tours of Barnstable Village typically start in the Old Jail, one of the oldest surviving wooden jails in the US. It makes sense that disgruntled defendants might haunt the place: The jail served as a pre- and post-trial detention space for poor and unpopular accused parties (think thieves and pirates) because the wealthy could pay bribes and avoid imprisonment.

Built on the orders of the Plymouth and Massachusetts Bay Colony courts around 1690, the white-shingled building served as the county jail until 1820. According to legend, Goody Hallett, the girlfriend of pirate Samuel Belamy, spent some time in the Old Jail. Six cells are intact, where prisoners survived with meager food, disease, and no heat. Windowless, the cells have their original locks, iron bars, and prisoner graffiti. No surprise, some say the jail is haunted, reporting clinking chains, random chills, and sightings of a man dressed in Colonial-era garb.

The jail once stood at Old Jail Lane in Barnstable Village, but

was moved to its present location at the Coast Guard Heritage Museum on Cobb’s Hill in 1972. Open seasonally, on Saturdays from 10 a.m. to 3 p.m., the property is maintained by the Barnstable Historical Society. Free, but donations are appreciated; 3353 Main St., Route 6A, Barnstable; 508-362-2982; www.barnstable-historicalsociety.org/the-old-jail

Highland Lighthouse (Cape Cod Light), North Truro

Think the Sagamore Bridge is an arduous journey? The Cape’s 50-mile-long outer coast claims more than 3,000 shipwrecks. “Some of the vessels were driven into the shoals and shallows by violent storms, while others occurred as ships were simply making their way along the coast in fair weather,” says Highland Lighthouse operations manager Ken Rose.

Highland Light, commissioned by George Washington in 1797, is the oldest lighthouse on the Cape. The original 45-foot-tall wooden lighthouse was replaced by a brick tower in 1831. The current 66-foot-tall brick tower was built in 1857 and relocated in 1996 due to coastal erosion. Owned by the National Park Service as part of Cape Cod National Seashore, it’s still an active navigation aid. The keeper’s house displays artifacts and exhibits about the lighthouse, and houses a gift shop, open from May 1 to Oct. 25. You can also climb the tower, provided you’re taller than 48 inches. There are 69 steps, narrow and steep, equal to climbing a five-story building. “The views of the Atlantic and the tip of the Cape are stunning,” Rose says. Henry David Thoreau reportedly visited in the 1850s.

But know this: Some local people and paranormal researchers believe the lighthouse and cliffs are haunted by the lost souls of wayward sailors, shipwreck victims, and former keepers. Visitors report a variety of ghostly goings-

on, including phantom footsteps and a woman in white who wanders the cliffs with a lantern, perhaps searching for a lost lover. That spine-tingling chill you feel may not be the salty breeze — perhaps it’s the spirit of a sailor long-gone. Seasonal tours, \$10; grounds open year-round; 27 Highland Light Road, North Truro; <https://americasnationalparks.org/highland-lighthouse-3/>

Cape Cod Airfield, Marstons Mills

If you’ve spent any time in Barnstable, you might have noticed the cherry red Waco YMF-5 biplane overhead. Are Snoopy and the Red Baron somewhere in the vicinity?

Cape Cod Airfield, a former training ground for the Army Air Corps, sits on 80 acres of wildflower-dotted fields on the mid-Cape. This unlikely setting offers a peek at aviation, 1920s-style. The collection of 21 iconic aircraft here includes the Waco, a Bamboo Bomber, and several vintage tail-draggers.

Want to take a ride? One or two passengers can ride in the open front cockpit of one of two historic biplanes for a tour of Cape Cod. You’ll fly at around 1,000 feet up, over beaches, bridges, forests, and the Cape Cod Canal. Rides are 15, 25, and 35 minutes long. Or, just stop by, sit at a picnic table, and watch the planes and skydivers take off. The property includes three intersecting grass runways, two hangars, and a picturesque old windmill. “It’s a way to see ‘Olde Cape Cod’ from the ground and the air, and take a step back in time,” says airport manager and pilot Chris Siderwicz. Rides from \$279.45 to \$403.65; weather permitting; 1000 Race Lane, Marstons Mills; 508-428-8732; www.capecodairfield.com

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Tiny Cape cottage offers 294 square feet of living space

By Megan Johnson
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

What this Eastham cottage lacks in square footage, it makes up for in updated amenities.

Located in the coveted Cape Cod hamlet of Eastham, unit 9 at 785 State Highway is a 294-square-foot seasonal home tucked inside the 14-unit Cranberry Cottages complex right off Route 6. Built in 1952, the home has been transformed in the last few years into a stylish tiny cottage. Now it features hardwood floors and freshly painted walls and is on the market for \$279,000.

“It’s been completely reimaged. Every single square inch of the whole 294 square feet is taken advantage of,” said Callie Zaglio of Christie’s International Real Estate Brokerage, who has the listing and has already sold three other cottages in the same complex.

The home is set toward the back of the Cranberry Cottages complex. It has a home’s front parking space. Upon entering, you’ll find a queen-size bed on the right.

The kitchen was redone in 2022 and features a retro-style mint green refrigerator and quartz countertops. White cabinetry is above and below the sink,



PHOTOS BY BRYAN STEARNS

The seasonal Eastham home, which has been transformed in the last few years, is on the market for \$279,000.



and there’s an area for small appliances in the corner. Under the window, there’s a dining nook.

The bathroom was redone in 2020 and has a step-in shower and porcelain tile floors, as well as new cabinets, a sink, and a mirror.

A door to the right of the bed leads out to the back deck, the backyard, a shed, and an outdoor shower. The yard, which has an exclusive-use area, is surrounded by leafy trees. A shed contains two Cannondale bikes and two stand-up paddleboards that come with the home. The back of the complex leads to a bike path.

“If you’re coming for the summer and you have to rent a hotel room, a hotel room is like \$300 to \$400 a night. I would much rather have something like this instead,” said Zaglio. “You can literally just pack your bags and go.”

Almost everything inside the cottage is included in the sale, except for some artwork. The buyer will be buying into a piece of the 5.67-acre complex, which is collectively owned by the residents.

The annual HOA fee is \$1,295.00, and it includes landscaping, town water, basic cable, Wi-Fi, and trash. There is a new roof and a new water heater.

Weekend

THE BOSTON GLOBE FRIDAY, AUGUST 28, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/ARTS

MOVIES



Rescued from tax shelter hell, ‘Coyote vs. Acme’ follows lawyer Will Forte as he represents plaintiff Wile E. Coyote in his looney lawsuit against the Acme Corporation

By Odie Henderson
GLOBE STAFF

There’s a joke in the opening seconds of “Coyote vs Acme” that hits harder than originally intended. After the Warner Bros. logo appears onscreen, the camera zooms in on the fine print that appears beneath the WB shield. Next to an asterisk are the words “A wholly owned subsidiary of the Acme Corporation.” Under normal circumstances, this would just be a funny, faux self-deprecating swipe at a major corporation. But this film isn’t arriving in theaters under normal circumstances.

After being notoriously shelved by David Zaslav and Warner Bros. for a tax write-off in 2023, “Coyote vs. Acme” is finally seeing the light of day thanks to distributor Ketchup Entertainment and



PHOTOS BY KETCHUP ENTERTAINMENT

Lana Condor (left) and Will Forte with Wile E. Coyote, voiced by Eric Bauza, in a scene from “Coyote vs Acme.”

a legion of protesting fans who refused to give up hope. A credit at the end dedicates the film to “everyone who posted, shared, held up signs and spoke out when it counted.” At last week’s advance screening, the second time I saw the film, the dedication was met with cheers as loud as the boos that erupted when the WB logo made its appearance 101 minutes earlier.

There was no reason other than greed for shelving a movie that tested well and featured the most recognizable and famous characters in the Warner Bros. canon. After giving the completed film a “funeral screening” for the cast that included stars Will Forte and Lana Condor, it appeared that they would be the last people to see the movie director Dave Green worked on for three years.

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CRITIC’S NOTEBOOK

Does Gen Z dislike sex onscreen? Maybe not.

By Chris Vognar
GLOBE STAFF

Gen Z doesn’t have as much sex as its predecessors, or so the studies say. But you wouldn’t know it from watching their recent batch of TV comedies. Both “I Love L.A.” and “Not Suitable for Work” begin with scenes of furious coupling, one interrupted by a classic Los Angeles earthquake, the other by anxieties over a pending job interview. Where HBO quickly renewed “I Love

L.A.” for a second season, Hulu abruptly canceled “Not Suitable” this week. Perhaps the TV industry prefers earthquake sex to employment-obsessed sex.

“I Love L.A.” happens to be the best in a recent spate of libidinous Gen Z comedies, which also includes Prime Video’s “Overcompensating” and FX’s “Adults” (the second season of which premiered Thursday on Hulu and FXX). “L.A.” is zippy, tightly written,

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CHRISTOS KALOHORIDIS/FX

Owen Thiele as Anton, Lucy Freyer as Billie, Jack Innanen as Paul Baker, and Amita Rao as Issa in “Adults.”

SOUND CHECK

50 years after Donna Summer’s first hit, fans gather at a party fit for a (disco) queen

By Victoria Wasylak
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Since 2014, Boston has greeted the summer solstice as a swirling mass of bodies — some shimmying, others roller skating, but all sweat-slicked under the moonlight.

I’m talking, of course, about the annual **Donna Summer** disco party at City Hall Plaza. The timing is cute — Summer rings in the summertime — but the event itself is quite the badge of honor for the family of the Mission Hill-raised diva, who died of lung cancer in 2012. The disco party is the only recurring event produced by the city’s Office of Tourism, Sports, and Entertainment that honors a Boston musician.

This year, the city bumped the free event to this Friday so City Hall Plaza could accommodate the influx of soccer

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NATHAN KLIMA FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Revelers dressed in disco attire for the Celebration of Summer at Boston City Hall in 2023.

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The Ticket

UPCOMING EVENTS,
CHOSEN BY GLOBE
CRITICS AND WRITERS

Sign up for The Big To-Do newsletter,
your guide to staying entertained,
from live shows and outdoor fun to
the latest events around Boston.



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Welcome to The Ticket, our guide highlighting the top things to do in and around Boston each weekend, as curated by Globe critics, editors, and writers.

On tap this weekend: the annual Donna Summer Disco Party returns, plus Jaylen

Brown bids farewell to Boston with a block party. — *Matt Juul*

1 DONNA SUMMER DISCO PARTY Disco fever takes over City Hall Plaza Friday night with the return of the annual party celebrating Boston icon Donna Summer. The festivities will include roller skating, colorful lights, glow sticks, bubbles, and, of course, a disco ball, with DJ Vince1 playing Summer's hits and other classic tunes. The family-friendly event is free and open for anyone to dance the night away. *Aug. 28, 5-9 p.m. Free. City Hall Plaza, 1 City Hall Square. boston.gov/calendar/donna-summer-disco-party* — *Daisy Levine*

2 VINYL NIGHTS AT THE ICA Sheer Bliss, a collective focused on highlighting music from the queer, underground electronic dance music scene, joins the ICA for this weekend's Vinyl Nights bash. Visitors can dance along to DJ sets or peruse a collection of rave artifacts and stories. Food and beverages will be available for purchase at the ICA Wine + Coffee Bar. *Aug. 28, 5-9 p.m. Free advance ticket required; museum entry is not included. ICA Boston, 25 Harbor Shore Drive. icaboston.org/events/vinyl-nights* — *Janira Skrbkova*

3 KACEY MUSGRAVES Eight-time Grammy winner Kacey Musgraves brings her "Middle of No-where" tour to TD Garden on Friday night. The Texas-born country singer will be joined by opening band Midland. Read more about upcoming concerts in this week's Sound Check column. *Aug. 28, 7:30 p.m. TD Garden, 100 Legends Way. tdgarden.com/events/detail/kacey-musgraves* — *DL*

4 ORNITHOLOGY Comic Thomas Coughlin brings together a group of his talented artist friends for this showcase, with stand-up from Steph Simon, Richie Raymond, Leke, Addy Gover, and Erin Lee, improv from In This House, We Believe, music from Kayla Hutchins, and a graphic novel reading from Jared Sarnie. *Aug. 29, 8 p.m. \$15-\$20. The Lilypad, 1353 Cambridge St., Cambridge. event-brite.com* — *NZ*

5 FRANK SANTORELLI "Trying to cut down on fat," says the Boston veteran comic, whom fans might recognize as Georgie from "The Sopranos." "Now when I eat Haagen-Dazs, you know those pints? Take off the top, the ice cream stuck to the lid? Toss that." *Aug. 28 at 8 p.m. and Aug. 29 at 7:30 p.m. \$33.85-\$35.98. Giggles Comedy Club, 517 Broadway (Route 1), Saugus. 781-233-9950, princerestdurant.com* — *Nick A. Zaino III*

6 DL HUGHLEY One of the original Kings of Comedy, Hughley packs his shows with political and social critiques, sometimes sharp, sometimes more off-the-cuff. This summer, he appeared in a pointed and moving story arc in the final season of Michelle Buteau's "Survival of the Thickest" on Netflix. *Aug. 28-29 at 6:30 p.m. and 9:30 p.m. and Aug. 30 at 5 p.m. \$42-\$78. City Winery Boston, 80 Beverly St. citywinery.com* — *NZ*

7 BOSTON JAZZ FEST The 16th annual Boston Jazz Fest returns to the Seaport with a lineup

of jazz acts hailing from around the world. This year's fest features soul-funk Afrobeats band The GroovaLottos, Indo-American jazz composer and pianist Charu Suri, and City Strings United, a non-profit program that provides free cello lessons for youth. Visitors can enjoy food and browse merchandise from dozens of vendors, including Mei Mei Dumplings and Suya Joint. *Aug. 28-29, 5-10 p.m. on Friday, noon-10 p.m. on Saturday. Free. South Boston Maritime Park, 600 D St. boston-jazzfest.org* — *JS*

8 WICKED: FOR GOOD It's a movie night under the stars on Boston Common. Cynthia Erivo and Ariana Grande star in the sequel to their 2024 box office hit, "Wicked." An adaptation of the beloved Broadway show about the witches of Oz, "For Good" tells the second act of the musical, following Elphaba's journey as the Wicked Witch of the West. Come early for free popcorn. *Aug. 29, 8 p.m. Boston Common, near Brewer Fountain. boston.gov/calendar/movie-night-wicked-good* — *DL*

9 JAYLEN BROWN BLOCK PARTY Former Celtics star Jaylen Brown bids farewell to Boston with a special community block party. Attendees can enjoy carnival games, giveaways, surprise performances, and more as a "thank you" to the city that cheered him on for so many years. The festivities will also include a pop-up shop featuring Brown's 741 apparel and footwear. *Aug. 30, 2-7 p.m. Free. Boston Common, Charles Street entrance. 741performance.com/pages/frequency-fest* — *JS*

10 SAINT ANTHONY'S FEAST Billed as the largest Italian religious festival in New England, the 107th anniversary of St. Anthony's Feast takes over the North End this weekend. See parades and processions, plus enjoy bites of Italian cuisine from food vendors, groove to live music performances, and more. *Through Aug. 30. Endicott, Thatcher, and North Margin streets, North End. stanthonys-feast.com* — *DL*

LAST CHANCE

THROUGH AUG. 29

DEAD GIRL'S QUINCEANERA

Phanésia Pharel's tonally complex work centers on three teenage girls in Miami who are trying to solve the disappearance of their friend. The sheer verve of Pharel's authorial voice carries her one-act play past its wobbly stretches as she blends a coming-of-age story with a parody of true-crime podcasts while also exploring the danger predatory men pose to girls and women. A splendid cast of four — Jacqueline Guillén, Carmen Berkeley, Ariana Burks, and Andrea Ferro — is directed, with a characteristically sure hand, by Melia Bensussen. *Presented by Barrington Stage Company. Co-production with Goodman Theatre and Hartford Stage. At St. Germain Stage, 36 Linden St., Pittsfield. 413-242-6411, barringtonstageco.org* — *DA*



AUGUST 29

MAMMA MIA!

Don't miss out on the last screening of the season for the Prudential's annual outdoor summer movie series. Laugh along to the Greece-set musical comedy "Mamma Mia!" in which bride-to-be Sophie (Amanda Seyfried) attempts to identify which of her mother's (Meryl Streep) lovers is her biological father. *6:30 p.m. Free. South Garden, Prudential Center. prudentialcenter.com/experiences/events/summer-flicks* — *JS*

CRITICS' PICKS

ODIE HENDERSON'S PICK

THE OUTSIDERS

On Sunday, the Alamo Draft-house has a Movie Party screening for nostalgic Gen Xers. At 12:45 p.m., they're unspooling "The Outsiders: The Complete Novel," the director's cut of Francis Ford Coppola's adaptation of S.E. Hinton's beloved novel. If you only saw the film back in 1983 (instead of reading the novel like you were supposed to in high school English class), you missed out on 32 extra minutes added to this version. Savor more footage of young Matt Dillon, C. Thomas Howell, Ralph Macchio, Patrick Swayze, Diane Lane, and Tom Cruise. In addition to rumbling with audience members dressed like the Socs, you'll also receive "a comb, a Stay Gold keychain, and Ponyboy's pencil" with your ticket. Stevie Wonder provides a soundtrack song at no extra charge. *Aug. 30, 12:45 p.m. Alamo Drafthouse, 60 Seaport Blvd., #315. draft-house.com/boston/event/movie-party-the-outsiders-the-complete-novel*

DON AUCOIN'S PICKS

RHINOCEROS

Diane Paulus directs a brilliantly realized production of Eugène Ionesco's allegorical 1959 play about a small French village whose residents suddenly and inexplicably turn into rhinoceroses. An anguished John Turturro gets under your skin as Berenger, the lone holdout, refusing to follow his fellow residents as, one by one, they sur-

render their human identities. As Jean, his pompous friend, Paul Giamatti executes a convulsive transformation into a snorting, bellowing rhino that you won't soon forget. Also featuring Tatiana Maslany, Alex Ross, and Kristine Nielsen, who delivers a dose of the comic juice that made her a favorite of the late Christopher Durang. This is a "Rhinoceros" equal to our present, precarious moment, serving as a warning about the speed with which a community — and a nation — can acquiesce to authoritarianism. And it puts a searing exclamation point on what has been the Year of Ionesco in Boston-area theater. *Through Sept. 27. American Repertory Theater. At Loeb Drama Center, Cambridge. 617-547-8300, www.american-repertorytheater.org*

THE REALISTIC JONESES

Will Eno's play about the mysterious relationship between two married couples, both named Jones, features Brenda Withers, Jonathan Fielding, Samantha Steinmetz, and Robert Kropf. Reviewing its premiere in 2012 at Yale Repertory Theatre, where the cast included Parker Posey and Tracy Letts, I wrote that Eno's play "subtly imprints on our consciousness not just a general awareness of our mortality — that's old news — but of the way dread pervades our daily routines, and how it instills in us a need for other people." Directed by Alison Greene. *Through Sept. 5. Harbor Stage Company, 15 Kendrick Ave., Wellfleet. 508-214-0495, har-*



HAWVER AND HALL

Tatiana Maslany and John Turturro in "Rhinoceros."

borstage.org

THE NORWEGIANS

Elizabeth Aspenlieder and Peggy Pharr Wilson play two women who meet in a Minnesota bar, learn that each has been betrayed by their romantic partner, and hire a couple of unusually polite Norwegian hit men (Michael F. Toomey and Mark Zeisler) to exact revenge. C. Denby Swanson's dark comedy is directed by James Warwick. *Sept. 4-Oct. 4. Shakespeare & Company. At Elayne P. Bernstein Theatre, 70 Kemble St., Lenox. 413-637-3353, shakespeare.org*

A.Z. MADONNA'S PICKS

BERKSHIRE OPERA FESTIVAL

The founding conductor-director

team of Brian Garman and Jonathon Loy head up this year's mainstage production of Donizetti's astounding "Lucia di Lammermoor," featuring Christine Lyons in the title role opposite Terence Chin-Loy (no relation to Jonathon) as Edgardo, Dean Murphy as Enrico, and Stephan Egerstrom as Raimondo. *Aug. 28, 7:30 p.m. Mahaiwe Performing Arts Center, 14 Castle St., Great Barrington. 413-213-6622, berkshireoperafestival.org*

OPERA OPEN MIC NIGHT

"Opera" and "open mic" don't usually mix, but at this community event hosted by Boston Summer Opera and Little Songbook Opera, they will. Got a piece to sing? Bring sheet mu-

sic and the accompanist stands ready — first to sign up is first up to sing. Just want to listen and maybe meet fellow opera lovers? That's an option too. It's free, but seating is limited, so RSVP is required. *Aug. 29. Doors at 6:30 p.m., music between 7 p.m. and 9:30 p.m. Arts at the Armory, 191 Highland Ave., Somerville. artsatthearmory.org/events/open-mic-night*

VICTORIA WASYLAK'S PICK

BOYS LIKE GIRLS

Even though it's been 20 years since Andover-formed band Boys Like Girls made it big, their splashy breakout single "The Great Escape" and similar pop-rock gems still sound as youthful as they did in the 2000s. Read more about upcoming concerts in this week's Sound Check. *Aug. 29, 6 p.m. Leader Bank Pavilion, 290 Northern Ave. ticketmaster.com*

MURRAY WHYTE'S PICKS

AVERY, GOTTLIEB & ROTHKO: BY THE SEA

A heartwarming tale of groundbreaking artists poised to shake the world while sunning happily on the beach may sound a bit far-fetched, but this exhibition, of the deep friendship forged between Mark Rothko, Adolph Gottlieb, and Milton Avery on summer retreats to Gloucester is the account of exactly that, right down to seaside scenes of summer delight by Rothko, otherwise renowned as a master of the dour sublime. A revelation. *Through Sept. 27. Cape Ann Museum, 27 Pleasant St., Gloucester. 978-283-0455, capeannmuseum.org*

ter. 978-283-0455, capeannmuseum.org

JARED LANK: BAY OF HERONS

Lank, a Mi'kmaq artist, has always focused on the history of Indigenous peoples' assimilation and its impact on identity over generations. This piece, his first short film, is a meditation on place centered on Maine's Mackworth Island; through image, word, and personal experience, it is a paean to Wabanaki heritage, cosmology, and loss. *Through Nov. 1. Portland Museum of Art, 7 Congress Square, Portland, Maine. 207-775-6148, portlandmuseum.org*

THE WAY WE NEVER WERE: THE AMERICAN PROFESSIONAL PHOTOGRAPHERS COLLECTION

Opening this week: In the 1970s, sociologist and curator Barbara P. Norfleet assembled a 200,000-strong collection of photographs that, taken together, depicted a version of America at mid-century that "staged and refined ... how Americans saw themselves and their nation." Given the nature of the pictures — made by professional photographers hired by businesses, families, and civic organizations — there's a deceptively one-note sunniness to the images not quite in tune with the upheaval of the era — and that's exactly the point. The show examines "not only ... what was included, but also what was left out of the photographic record." *Through May 9. Harvard Art Museums, 32 Quincy St., Cambridge. 617-495-9400, harvardartmuseums.org*

APPRECIATION

Dolly Parton had one cowboy boot in country, and one stiletto in pop

By James Sullivan
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Did Dolly Parton, in fact, write “Jolene” and “I Will Always Love You” in one epic session?

The facts are murky. Parton herself, after claiming the legend to be true for years, later admitted that she may have written the songs in close proximity, but not exactly on the same day. But when the legend becomes fact, as they say, print the legend.

Whatever the circumstances, “Jolene” is one of the all-time great country songs, and “I Will Always Love You” — written for Porter Wagoner, the domineering country star who gave Parton her big break on his TV variety show (but boiled over when she declared she was stepping out on her own) — is unequivocally one of the most successful pop songs of all time. On Tuesday, Parton’s publicist confirmed that the 80-year-old star died peacefully in her Nashville home.

For an astonishing 60 years, Parton’s talent for writing and recording music shone through every aspect of her outsize personality — the image, the vivacity, the philanthropy, the universal appeal. She was country through and through, yet she bedazzled New York City during the disco era, recorded many covers over the years by her favorite singer-songwriters, and called her final studio album (in 2023) “Rockstar.”

Born into a large, impoverished family in the Great Smoky Mountains region of Tennessee, she sang as a child on the radio in Knoxville. After moving to Nashville the day after her high school graduation, she and an uncle named Bill Owens began writing songs for other artists, including Kitty Wells and Skeeter Davis.



TYLER HICKS/NEW YORK TIMES

Dolly Parton in 2002.

Though Parton did not write the first successful single she recorded, Curly Putnam’s “Dumb Blonde” announced the new star to the world on her own terms: “This dumb blonde ain’t nobody’s fool,” she declared.

That song appeared on her debut album, “Hello, I’m Dolly.” With Wagoner, Parton covered Tom Paxton’s “The Last Thing on My Mind,” the first in a string of hit duets.

Solo success was slower to come, until Wagoner hit upon the idea that Parton should record Jimmy Rodgers’s early country song “Mule Skinner Blues.” With the barn door kicked open, she unleashed a series of hits, including “Coat of Many Colors” (an ode to her mother’s ingenuity) and “Touch Your Woman.” “The Bargain Store” (1975) and “Here You Come Again” (1977) were two more highlights, her fifth and sixth No. 1s on the country charts, respectively.

At the turn of the new decade, Parton celebrated the pinnacle of her pop fame with “9 to 5,” from the film of the same name. Within a few years, however, her hard-won country bona fides were in need of some rehabilitation.

That came in the form of “Trio,” a collaborative album with Linda Ronstadt and Emmylou Harris, released in 1987. “Honky Tonk Angels,” recorded with Loretta Lynn and Tammy Wynette, followed in 1993.

Parton spent much of the rest of her career with one cowboy boot in the country world (including popular duets with Ricky Van Shelton and Vince Gill) and the other stiletto in pop. In the early 2000s she returned to her backwoods roots, recording a series of bluegrass albums highlighted by the Grammy-nominated “Little Sparrow.”

Of that “Rockstar” album, perhaps the less said, the better. (But look at the names on that absurd guest list!) Still, she remained relevant to generations young enough to be her great-grandchildren, appearing on records by Sabrina Carpenter, Bebe Rexha, Post Malone, and her godchild, Miley Cyrus.

In 2019, Parton made a surprise appearance at the Newport Folk Festival. It was one of the many bouquets of flowers lavished upon her over the last years of her extraordinary life. On “Dolly Parton’s America,” a nine-part series from the podcasting pioneer Jad Abumrad released around that time, they revisited that definitive writing session she’d had a half-century earlier. Parton explained why she’d had to step outside Wagoner’s shadow all those years ago.

“He didn’t know how many dreams I had,” she said.

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Neo-traditional country music is on the rise

By Stuart Munro
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Over the past few years, country music has seen one of its periodic traditionalist revivals. This time around, what’s being revived is the neo-traditional country that emerged in the 1980s and reached its heyday in the 1990s with artists such as George Strait, Alan Jackson, Garth Brooks, Patty Loveless, and Lee Ann Womack. You could call it “neo-neo-traditionalism,” the revival of a revival.

The revival’s trailblazer was arguably Midland, who mixed their throwback sound with vintage Nudie Cohn suits; they released their debut, “On the Rocks,” in 2017. Zach Top started making his way a few years later, and he broke out with “Cold Beer & Country Music” in 2024. He makes no bones about the kind of music he’s playing; “sounds like the radio back in 1994,” he sings on that album’s lead-off song.

In the wake of Top’s success — he’s already won a Grammy, and new male artist awards from both the Country Music Association and the Academy of Country Music — artists mining similar veins have increasingly been getting traction.

Here’s a few of them: Tyler Halverson mixes a neo-trad vibe in with Red Dirt and other sounds. Braxton Keith’s major-label debut, “Real Damn Deal,” adds an ample amount of Texas swing to his honky-tonk; he’ll be in Boston in November. Newcomer William Beckmann, who plays at Red Room at Cafe 939 in September, has a sound redolent of “Smoke Rings in the Dark”-era Gary Allan. And on the distaff side, you’ll find artists like Hailey Whitters and Kaitlin Butts.

You can add Jake Worthington, who released his sophomore album, “When I Write the Song,” last fall, to that list. Worthington was scheduled to play a show in Cambridge in June but canceled to join Brad Paisley’s tour as a supporting act, and that’s how he’s coming to town tonight at MGM Music Hall at Fenway.

The Texas native has been surrounded by country music for as long

Jake Worthington, one of the genre’s rising stars, weighs in on the reasons



JIM WRIGHT

Jake Worthington calls this “the Renaissance of country music.”

as he can remember, and playing it for almost as long. His grandfather was a songwriter, and his mother was a huge fan of what was current when Worthington (now 30 years old) was a kid.

“She took us shopping at JC Penney, and one time she got a free radio,” Worthington recalled during a recent phone conversation. The radio had a CD player, and soon the kitchen silverware drawer was filled with CDs instead of cutlery. After his parents got home from work, the family would sit around in the kitchen, listening to music and enjoying each other’s company while his mom cooked supper.

His parents also regularly took him to hear music “at dance halls and beer joints,” and before long, Worthington was sneaking into bars on weekends to see live bands. He said he picked up the guitar when he was 12 or 13, and soon he was playing those same honky-tonks.

He took two cracks at competing on the television show “The Voice,” auditioning unsuccessfully in 2013 and then competing the following

JAKE WORTHINGTON
Supporting Brad Paisley.
At MGM Music Hall at Fenway,
2 Lansdowne St., Boston, Aug. 28,
7:30 p.m. Tickets: \$40 and up.
crossroadspresents.com

year, when he finished as runner-up. But as good as that experience was, it was no “rocket-ship takeoff,” as he put it; “once that was done, I went back to the beer joints.”

He signed with his record label in 2021 and has released two albums since: a self-titled LP in 2023, and “When I Write The Song” in 2025. Both display Worthington’s talent as a songwriter; both are stuffed full of pedal steel, fiddle, and twangin’ electric guitar; both bring to mind the music he grew up with — Alan Jackson, Mark Chesnutt, George Strait, Tracy Lawrence, as well as enduring titans such as Merle Haggard and George Jones.

The reflective melancholy of the title song on his new album sounds like something that might have come

The Donna Summer celebrations continue 50 years after first hit

► **SOUND CHECK**
Continued from Page G1

fans and America250 programming in June. Now that the World Cup’s been claimed, and the star-spangled fanfare is winding down, another American milestone — the 50th anniversary of Summer’s mainstream breakthrough — can have its own moment.

On Feb. 7, 1976, “Love to Love You Baby” hit No. 2 on the Billboard Hot 100, marking Summer’s first Top 10 hit. The song had arrived the year prior as the breathy 16-minute, 48-second A-side of her 1975 LP. The far shorter single version wasn’t necessarily radio-friendly, either; even with a fraction of Summer’s ecstatic cries, some American stations banned the song.

But for every pearl-clutching listener, there was a dance floor’s worth of fans. “Love to Love You Baby” spent 18 weeks on the Hot 100, and as Summer wrote in her 2003 memoir, the single “went on to become the anthem of seventies pop culture. Or so they tell me.” The success triggered a landslide of chart-toppers for the fledgling disco queen, who would go on to earn four No. 1 songs by the end of the 1970s: “Hot Stuff,” “Bad Girls,” “MacArthur Park,” and the **Barbra Streisand**-assisted “No More Tears (Enough Is Enough).”

Now, when Summer’s nephew Robert Grant — a.k.a. Boston hip-hop artist **O’Mega Red** — and his longtime friend **DJ Vince1** plan the annual disco event alongside the city of Boston, they see it as a nostalgic party that’s also bringing “history to the youth,” Grant says.

DJ Vince1, who’s known locally for his work on JAM’N 94.5, has been involved since 2018, but Grant has been working on the event since its inception in 2014. The city of Boston approached him to help spearhead the event after Grant raised money to fund a mural of Summer at Jeremiah E. Burke High School. (Summer dropped out of the Dorchester school to pursue her music career in 1967, but she was awarded an honorary diploma, in 1983.)

Grant says he was close to his aunt, who poured music industry knowledge into him. After Summer released her 17th and final album, “Crayons,” in 2008, Grant worked on a few remixes for her.

“Donna Summer was just a character, you know? She was theater,” Grant says. “That’s what her persona was, but she was way more complicated.” (Now feels like a good time to mention that the suggestive “Love to Love You Baby” crooning “happened simply because we had run out of words, and I had to do something to fill up the time,” Summer explained in her memoir.)

Roughly a year before her death, the pair worked on a collaboration called “Angel,” which would later appear on Grant’s 2018 album, “Red October.” He performs the song at the disco party every year. On Friday, Grant will also break out his 2021 tune “Soul Clap,” and DJ Vince1 will spin a blend of Summer classics. (Special guests are on deck for this weekend, although the pair won’t spoil the surprise.)

“One of the things that I noticed, from standing on the stage and DJing and looking out to the crowd, is the different walks of life — different backgrounds, different heritages, different demographics — all reacting the same way when her songs come on,” DJ Vince1 says. “That says a lot.”

“That’s what my aunt always told me,” Grant adds. “She said ‘Rob, when you do something great ... no one can ever deny you of it.’ This is just proof of that fact.”

GIG GUIDE

Fans of folk and Southern sounds should camp out this weekend at Tanglewood, which welcomes **Carrie Underwood** (Saturday), **Judy Collins** (Sunday), and **Tedeschi Trucks Band** (Wednesday). Collins’s visit will be particularly special, and not just because it’s billed as part of the 87-year-old folk legend’s farewell tour; **Mary Chapin Carpenter** and **Rosanne Cash** (yes, the eldest daughter of Johnny) are also scheduled to perform.

Meanwhile, the Xfinity Center hosts a dance-a-thon, which kicks off with intergalactic electro-rock from **Empire of the Sun** (Friday) and revs up to the intense pop-rap of Energizer Bunnies **Pitbull** and **Lil Jon** (Saturday). One of this summer’s more promising package tours, a perfect blend of R&B and hip-hop from **TLC**, **Salt-N-Pepa**, and **En Vogue**, stops by the amphitheater Sunday.

The Moody Blues quit touring in 2018, but vocalist and guitarist **Justin**



JASON KEMPIN/GETTY IMAGES/FILE

Kacey Musgraves returns to TD Garden Friday.



MARCEL KRIJGSMAN/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Pitbull visits the Xfinity Center Saturday.

Hayward is keeping the English rock band’s catalog alive. He’s at the Cabot in Beverly Friday, and at Lexington’s Cary Memorial Hall Saturday.

More folks from the Globe’s “best albums of 2026 so far” list are in town this week, as country crooner **Kacey Musgraves** returns to TD Garden Friday to promote “Middle of Nowhere,” and Swedish synth-pop maven **Robyn** gets “Sexistential” at the Agganis Arena Thursday.

At Royale Sunday, founding **Beastie Boys** member **Mike D** expresses gratitude for his solo career with material from his brand-new album, “Thank You.” Then British R&B and indie-pop artist **Arlo Parks** takes over the club Tuesday with cuts from her third LP, “Ambiguous Desire.”

Across town, Lansdowne Street pops with the sounds of the Caribbean, as Haitian konpa act **KAÏ** headlines the House of Blues Saturday, and Puerto Rican reggaeton star **Omar Courtz** holds court at MGM Music Hall at Fenway Thursday.

NOW SPINNING

Olivia Rodrigo, “serena joy.” Fans of “The Handmaid’s Tale” already know the gist of Olivia Rodrigo’s new

from Haggard’s pen, and when it is suggested to him that there’s a lot of another neo-traditionalist, the late Keith Whitley, in his singing and his songs, he takes it as a high compliment. In his eyes, Whitley is “bar none, one-of-a-kind. Nobody can touch him.”

Worthington readily agrees that he’s part of the current neo-trad revival.

“We’re not reinventing no wheel here,” he said. “The music we make is what moves us.”

At the same time, he suggested that what he and others are doing isn’t just a carbon copy of the past. The artists and records that they grew up with will always be the foundation of the music they’re making in terms of influence, he reckoned.

“But nowadays, we have access to all kinds of music from all decades,” he said. “And in my mind, you’re gonna get a different sound because the culmination pot is a little thicker. It’s got a whole lot more stuff in it than it used to. And so I think that that provides an opportunity for a new way to do salt and pepper, meat and taters.”

Asked to reflect on why neo-traditional country music is currently having a moment, Worthington responded that he wasn’t sure, but he wondered if it has something to do with authenticity and a desire for connection.

“The way that things have gone [in mainstream country music] for the last two decades has worked, right? But I do think that with the way society has gone, traditional country music is a familiar thing — it reminds people of their childhood, it reminds people of their parents and grandparents, the love they had or still do. I think people are more starved for a real connection, they want something real.”

“I like calling this time the Renaissance of country music,” he added. “It’s a celebration of the past and bringing it back and also an effort to push into the future.”

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XAVI TORRENT/GETTY IMAGES

Olivia Rodrigo just released the single “serena joy.”

single. Named after an antagonist from Margaret Atwood’s dystopian novel, “serena joy” is a cry against political complacency, anchored to the warning “If they do it to them/ They’ll do it to you.” Pop rarely sounds this urgent, and Rodrigo’s already creating positive changes in the music industry. The song arrives just in time for her Saturday set at Daisy Chain Fields, a California-based all-women festival spearheaded by the 23-year-old singer.

BONUS TRACK

It’s time to ramble on in Ashburnham. The **Adam Ezra Group**’s annual music festival, **the Ramble**, takes over “the Mountain” festival grounds on Gibson Road Saturday to raise money for the New England Center and Home for Veterans. The Boston folk-rock band has been hosting the event since 2010, with impressive results, raising over \$750,000 for the organization to date. Tickets are pay-what-you-can, and a livestream of the festival will also be available on the band’s Facebook page.

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ARTS IN BRIEF

Michelle Obama closes out Vineyard author series

Former first lady Michelle Obama helped close out the Martha's Vineyard Author Series with two sold-out conversations at the Martha's Vineyard Performing Arts Center on Sunday. Obama sat for a pair of chats, discussing her new book, "The Look," with MS NOW senior contributing editor Michele Norris.



"I loved sitting down with my dear friend [Michele Norris] for two wonderful conversations about my book," Obama wrote in a post shared on her Instagram account on Wednesday. "A huge thank you to everyone who joined us at the Martha's Vineyard Author Series — your support truly means the world to me!"

— Matt Juul

Gary Sinise honors fallen firefighter Kilduff Jr.

Actor Gary Sinise was in Boston on Tuesday to honor Robert Kilduff Jr., a firefighter who died in May after falling from a third-story window while battling a three-alarm fire in Dorchester.

Sinise noted in a tribute posted on his Instagram account in May that Kilduff "was a dedicated volunteer of the Gary Sinise Foundation," the actor's nonprofit that supports first responders, active duty service members, veterans, as well as their families.

"In Boston today to visit the firehouse of our Gary Sinise Foundation friend, fallen firefighter Bobby (BK) Kilduff. Served food to some of our heroes and their families," Sinise wrote in a post shared on Instagram Tuesday. "BK dedicated his life to serving others, and it was very special to spend time with the men and women who knew and loved him and who continue that tradition of service every day."

— Matt Juul



Kate Price's 'This Happened to Me' now out in paperback

Wellesley research scientist Kate Price's account of her years-long abuse at the hands of her father and other men was first published as a Globe piece by reporter Janelle Nanos; it was a finalist for the Pulitzer Prize. "This Happened to Me," Price's book about the abuse, her arduous journey to uncover the details, and her work as a scholar and advocate, was published last year in hardcover. It's now available as a paperback. Not a beach read, but a stirring and ultimately heartening account of survival and renewal.

— Kate Tuttle



DUNKIN'

Pooches received dog treats, bandanas, and more in Quincy.

Dunkin' brings doggie drive-thru to Quincy

In honor of National Dog Day on Wednesday, Dunkin' and BARK, a dog food and toy company, teamed up to create a drive-thru experience for dogs, which set up shop at the Dunkin' at 588 Washington St. in Quincy. According to a press release, the pooches who rolled up were welcomed with dog treats, bandanas, and the chance to take home new BARK x Dunkin' collection plush toys with a donation to the Joy in Childhood Foundation.

— Matt Juul

Show about the end of summer in Provincetown has relevance far beyond

By James Sullivan
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Where will you be on Monday night, when the calendar flips from August to September?

More to the point, how will you be feeling?

With the possible exception of New Year's Eve, no other transition from one month to the next feels as momentous as the last day of August. Rentals end. The school year begins. The air often seems to turn crisp overnight, reminding us that the beaches will soon be desolate.

We all recognize that particular sense of melancholy that comes with the end of summer. The plot of "Grease" hinges on it. It's the subject of some of your favorite songs, from Bob Seger's "Night Moves" to Lana Del Rey's "Summertime Sadness."

"Summer's lease hath all too short a date," wrote one Wm. Shakespeare.

Provincetown songwriter Jon Richardson spent the last several years writing a song cycle about the last day of summer. His musical, "The Jack of Hearts Club," had its world premiere at the Provincetown Theater last year, and it wraps up a very successful second season on Sept. 6.

The story is set just before closing time inside a Provincetown bar on the last day of August 1963, at a time when the bohemian getaway at the tip of Cape Cod truly closed up overnight.

"We call September 'townie summer,'" Richardson said. "But that wasn't the case back then."

At an early workshop performance of "The Jack of Hearts Club," an older man in the audience explained that when he was young, the queer crowd that came to Provincetown looking for a safe haven each year built a bonfire on the beach on the last day of August. They'd stay up until dawn, and say their tearful goodbyes when the sun came up.

The theme of the musical is essentially "summer camp is over," as Richardson said in a recent conversation. That's something all kinds of people, gay or straight, can relate to, he believes.

The ensemble cast that populates the Jack of Hearts Club — the mother and daughter who run the joint, the gay men and lesbians looking for love and solace there, the piano man whose boyfriend can't commit — represent anyone facing big changes, big decisions.

"Every character has a little bit of desperation, because the clock is ticking," said Richardson, who earned a master's degree in musicology at New



JEN ZEE

The cast of "The Jack of Hearts Club," set at a Provincetown bar on the last day of August 1963.

England Conservatory before moving to Provincetown almost a decade ago. "There's so much for a dramatist to work with."

Audiences in P-town have enthusiastically embraced "The Jack of Hearts Club." After Governor Maura Healey caught the show in early August, she called it "incredible."

"Even though it's set in 1963," she wrote on Facebook, "this story of found family and belonging feels as relevant as ever."

In March, director Leda Hoffman, who is also the producing artistic director of the Contemporary Theatre of Ohio, helped stage a reading of the play in Columbus. For Richardson, the performance confirmed something he'd been hoping — that the story of his characters' last day of summer would appeal to audiences anywhere, not just in Provincetown.

"They were laughing and crying in all the same spots" as the P-town crowds do, he recalled. "That was the relief of all reliefs."

Richardson and the company recently released an original cast recording of the musical. In his wildest dreams, "The Jack of Hearts Club" would become part of the repertory across the country.

"I wrote this show for this community, as a love letter to this world that I live in here," he said. "I really want it

THE JACK OF HEARTS CLUB
Book, score, and lyrics by Jon Richardson. Directed by Leda Hoffman. Thursday-Saturday at 7 p.m., Sunday at 2 p.m. through Sept. 6. Provincetown Theater, 238 Bradford St., Provincetown. Waitlist information: provincetowntheater.org

to play here until I'm dead.

"But I am just coming to expand my dreams about this play, that it can be done anywhere," he continued. "I love watching all kinds of people fall in love with the show for all kinds of reasons."

For now, however, he's laser-focused on delivering the last shows of this season.

"Every time I think about what's going to happen in the future," he said with a laugh, "I snap the rubber band on my wrist."

For several years, Richardson has been a regular on the lively piano bar scene in P-town. After multiple seasons at the Crown & Anchor, this summer he's been appearing at the Pilgrim House.

Due to "The Jack of Hearts Club's" barroom setting, some observers have dubbed it "the gay 'Cheers.'" There are cast members who "chafe" at that de-

scription, Richardson said, but he kind of gets it.

When he was writing the show, "I weirdly watched the pilot to 'The Mary Tyler Moore Show' over and over." (He's originally from Minneapolis.)

Just like the characters in "The Jack of Hearts Club," the fictional Mary was "a fish out of water" who found her home among the lovable eccentrics of the newsroom that hired her.

"Sitcoms are so instructive about [writing] really clean lines inside storytelling, and establishing character quickly," Richardson said.

Recently, scheduling conflicts and illnesses have resulted in some of the musical's understudies needing to step in. After working with the same core of actors night in and night out, the experience was "emotionally very moving," said Richardson.

"It was the first time I'd seen anyone else play these parts, and they did it with such grace and beauty," he said. It was a welcome reminder that "other people are going to maybe do this show one day."

With the curtain closing in a matter of days on the second season of his show, he said, "I'm so aware of how depressed I'm gonna be when it's over."

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These shows upend a Gen Z stereotype

►TELEVISION
Continued from Page G1

and certain of what it's doing. It manages to lampoon influencer culture at the same time that it presents TikTok exposure as a viable career alternative for a generation whose predecessors didn't leave it much to plan or hope for. And it positions star/creator Rachel Senott, who also co-created Netflix's crackerjack comedy "Big Mistakes," as a voice of her generation. Or at least, to quote Lena Dunham's millennial Hannah in "Girls," "the voice of a generation."

But let's get back to the sex. That's just about all anybody can talk about in "Overcompensating," which follows the exploits of closeted gay former high school football star Benny (series creator Benito Skinner) as he navigates his new life in college. Breaking: College kids really like to talk about sex, and occasionally even *have* sex, especially on TV. Such is life in the wild, wild west of streaming and cable.

Benny's straight peers, assuming the ex-jock is a raging hetero, push him to get laid as quickly as possible — as do the friends of Carmen (Wally Baram). She, like Benny, is an awkward sexual novice with a tendency to, well, overcompensate. After a scene of comically interrupted, college-try fellatio, they become chums and try to steer each other toward their better, more authentic selves. Skinner is 32 and looks it, which is merely to say he's pushing it a little in playing a college freshman. But he winningly inhabits the secrets of his character, which are based on Skinner's own closeted college experiences.

Unlike Gen X hangout sitcoms — say, "Friends" — the Gen Z crop pays more than mere lip service to diversity, and none of the shows, to their credit, feel like they're straining to fill quotas. Gen Z, in addition to its alleged sexual apathy, is also known to embrace diversity as a natural positive (which, of course, it is). These shows are peppered with lead characters of different ethnicities and sexual orientations. Owen Thiele, Black and very much out of the closet in real life and onscreen, is a lead



DISNEY

Avantika (left) and Ella Hunt in "Not Suitable for Work."



HBO

Jordan Firstman, True Whitaker, and Odessa A'zion in "I Love LA."

on "Adults" and a supporting player on "Overcompensating." "I Love L.A." wouldn't go far without Jordan Firstman's deliciously queer sense of humor.

The Gen Z comedy that was canceled, "Not Suitable for Work," felt the

most like a previous generation's TV series. This probably isn't a coincidence. Created by Cambridge's Mindy Kaling — like me, a Gen Xer — it lacked some of the rapid-fire vim and comfort in its own skin that defines, say, "Adults,"

which somehow feels authentic even as it works hard to hit proscribed comedic beats. (Since we're keeping score, the creators of "Adults," "Overcompensating," and "I Love L.A." are all young millennials.) "Adults" also gets credit for trying to explain how four underemployed youngsters can afford a nice place in Queens: Samir (Malik Elassal) and his friends are essentially squatting in the house that his absent parents own; the inside of the front door is covered in yellow caution tape to remind his roommates to enter and exit elsewhere lest they be caught on doorbell camera and reveal their residency to his parents.

Shows about young friend groups are always going to alienate some portion of older audiences; it's safe to say that "Friends" bewildered many viewers who came of age on "Happy Days." So let's turn to other kinds of perhaps more objective criteria: How's the writing? How's the acting? Is the show reducing its generation to a glib stereotype? (I despised the movie "Reality Bites" when it came out because I thought it was putting Gen X in a slickly designed box. Yes, they were talkin' 'bout my generation.)

By these standards, I enjoy the Gen Z comedies. At their best, they ride the anarchic energy of classic screwball comedies, except those had to smuggle in their racier content through the strictures of Production Code censorship. There was no onscreen earthquake sex back then. Even the late "Not Suitable for Work" had a little hop in its step; its cancellation might have as much to do with what the Gen Z comedy market will bear than any particular sins of its own.

At some point, even the Gen Z comedies will come to feel like the work of old folks. By then, however, Gen Alpha will be sneaking up from behind with its own thing. That's the thing about youth. It always comes with an expiration date.

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Blue skies through the tears: A tribute to Tim Curry

By Odie Henderson
GLOBE STAFF

It’s a devastating week for queer icons and the people who love them. A day after Dolly Parton left us, Tim Curry died at his Los Angeles home. Both were 80 years old. They leave behind a legion of fans touched by their work and their humanity, especially those in the LG-BTQ+ community.

Back in London, 1973, Curry breathed onstage life into Dr. Frank-N-Furter, the bustier-clad, sex-positive mad scientist who ruled over Richard O’Brien’s “The Rocky Horror Show.” Two years later, Curry performed the role in the movie version, creating a vehicle for LGBTQ+ people to find their tribe over the past five decades of midnight screenings of “The Rocky Horror Picture Show.” Curry’s haunting performance of “I’m Going Home,” “RHPS”’s 11 o’clock number, is all the more poignant today.

Every actor who has played an iconic, larger than life character with immense staying power will ultimately have to deal with the shadow that role casts. While Tim Curry accepted his forever status as Dr. Frank-N-Furter (there’s a clip of him at a “RHPS” screening saying “I’m the only person here who doesn’t look like me” to a crowd of cosplaying fans), he did not let it stop him from assaying a wide variety of voiceover and starring roles. A guy who can successfully portray Mozart, King Arthur, a murderous Stephen King clown, Long John Silver, and “The Wild Thornberrys”’s Nigel Thornberry



EVAN AGOSTINI/GETTY IMAGES/FILE 2005

Tim Curry (pictured on Broadway in “Spamalot”) died Wednesday at 80.

doesn’t have to worry about being type-cast.

After a stroke befell the actor in 2012, Curry continued to do voiceover work and make appearances. His memoir, “Vagabond,” was released in 2025, and is a rollicking, fun read.

In a career that began in the late 1960s with the London version of “Hair,” Curry did a remarkable amount of stage, screen, and television work. He also recorded three rock albums, showing his mettle as a singer. He received three Tony nominations, for playing Mozart in 1981’s “Amadeus” (he lost to his costar, Ian McKellen), Alan Swann in 1993’s “My Favorite Year,” and King Arthur in the original Broadway pro-

duction of “Spamalot.” I saw him in “Spamalot,” and can vouch that his nomination was more than deserved.

Curry had the distinction of being one of only three actors to upstage the Muppets in a movie — and they’re all British thespians. David Bowie did it in “Labyrinth,” and Michael Caine did it in “Muppet Christmas Carol.” Curry’s turn as Long John Silver in “Muppet Treasure Island” is the most manic of them all; he’s a profoundly entertaining spectacle unashamed of making a fool of himself. He sings, he dances, he does broad comedy, and, according to his memoir, he copped to an affair with Miss Piggy during the shoot. Talk about having a sense of humor and good taste

‘The Dog Stars’ barks up the wrong tree

By Odie Henderson
GLOBE STAFF

Director Ridley Scott’s dystopian thriller “The Dog Stars” is three movies in one, none of which is compelling enough to sustain a two-hour runtime. Based on the 2012 novel by Peter Heller, this dull-as-dishwater film presents a poorly defined future where humanity has been wiped out by an unexplained epidemic. It’s 2035, and survivors huddle in uninfected community bubbles when not under attack from feral out-siders.

The first movie is the most intriguing of the three. “The Dog Stars” begins with Hig (Jacob Elordi) and his canine companion, Jasper, flying around Colorado in a big yellow Cessna. He’s looking for any dangerous people approaching their safe haven. Hig shares his space with a grizzled vet named Bangley (Josh Brolin), who mans a security lookout where he shoots first and asks questions later.

Occasionally, Hig lands in a deserted town to get cases of Sprite and canisters of gasoline. The latter serves two purposes: to fuel the plane and to burn the bodies of those unlucky enough to pass in front of Bangley’s rifle sight. Product placement is alive and well in the future; Coca-Cola and Mickey D’s are just two of the familiar logos you’ll find in this apocalypse now.

The screenplay, by “The Revenant”

MOVIE REVIEW

★½
THE DOG STARS
Directed by Ridley Scott. Written by Mark L. Smith, Christopher Wilkinson. Based on Peter Heller’s novel. Starring Jacob Elordi, Josh Brolin, Margaret Qualley, Guy Pearce, Allison Janney. At AMC Boston Common, Landmark Kendall Square, Alamo Drafthouse Seaport, AMC Causeway, suburbs. 118 minutes. R (people lose their heads — literally)

scribe Mark L. Smith and Christopher Wilkinson, drops unsatisfying bread-crumbs regarding what happened to the world. Images of abandoned IV poles clue us in to some kind of health crisis, and there’s passing mention of deadly infections. During his soda runs, Hig returns to the house he once inhabited, where he’s haunted by visions of his late, pregnant wife. Hig also drops off supplies to a Mennonite encampment run by Aaron (Benedict Wong).

Sprite may exist in the future, but Black people and other minorities, apart from Wong’s Aaron, appear to be extinct. This presents a problem, as the lack of explanation allows “The Dog Stars” to play dirty pool with its details. If the virus is fatal, why are some survi-

vors turning feral? Why do these survivors look like ridiculous rejects from Club CBGB with their tattoos and Mo-hawks? And why are they hooting, hollering, and swarming like stereotypical Native Americans in a John Wayne before being massacred by a white guy with a high-powered gun? The optics are as messy as the plot.

The second movie in this tired self-contained trilogy unfolds after Hig is forced to land in an unfamiliar territory. There, he meets Cima (Margaret Qualley), a former medical student, and her father Pops (Guy Pearce), who is even grungier and grumpier than Bangley. The four characters form a predictable family unit, with Cima providing love interest potential and little else. We learn so little about these people that they may as well be stick figures drawn on the pretty Rocky Mountains landscape backgrounds.

Once Hig gets confirmation that there’s human life and a possible safe haven at a place called Grand Junction, the third and final movie kicks into gear. This one features an ominous scenario played out in what looks like Denver’s old Stapleton Airport on a good day. Allison Janney has a brief role here as a character best described as a flight attendant on WTF? Airlines. Dressed like a Pan Am stewardess imported from “Mad Men,” Janney is a jarring presence whose weird persona is wast-

in Muppets!

As a star of movies that became cult classics later, Curry was a repeat offender. There’s “Clue,” where he played a hilarious, snobby butler opposite Made-line Kahn and an all-star cast. (He’s also fun as the even snobbier concierge in “Home Alone 2.”) As Wadsworth the butler, he has one of the best scenes of his career with his convoluted explanation of the murder mystery solution in one of “Clue”’s three endings.

Cult status was also bestowed on Ridley Scott’s 1985 fantasy “Legend,” where Tom Cruise tiptoes through the tulips as a forest child out to save the unicorns from Curry’s impressive make-up job as the Lord of Darkness. This movie is beyond homoerotic, with boy-ish imp Cruise and horseys and, oh, never mind!

It wasn’t all fun and games on the big screen for Curry. He played dramatic roles in films as varied as “The Hunt for Red October” and the biopic “Kinsey.” I wish I could have seen his Mozart, but Tom Hulce got that role in the movie version.

On the TV front, Curry scared the hell out of viewers as Pennywise the Clown in the 1990 miniseries version of Stephen King’s “IT.” His first appearance in the sewer was so terrifying that the child actor sharing the scene with him stopped and said, “Tim, you’re scaring me.” Ever the dapper, understanding gentleman, Curry responded, “I’m so sorry, but that’s what I’m supposed to be doing.”

In addition to scoring a Daytime Emmy for voiceover work on “Peter Pan & the Pirates,” Curry also scored a Prime-



FABIO LOVINO/20TH CENTURY STUDIOS

Jacob Elordi and Margaret Qualley in “The Dog Stars.”

ed on a predictable plot turn.

I have not read Heller’s book, so I cannot speak to how faithful this adaptation is. Though I’m a firm believer that dystopian plots can be dramas instead of thrillers, “The Dog Stars” can’t make up its mind as to which genre it is. Making matters worse, the characters all have one trait: Pops is Oscar the Grouch, Cima’s a woman, Hig is Jacob Elordi’s trademark brand of sad, and Bangley likes to shoot people. At least Brolin and Pearce are having a good time being crotchety.

Scott is a director who is only as

good as the script he’s been given. His classic films (“Alien,” “Thelma & Louise,” “Matchstick Men,” among others) all benefited from a tight, well-written screenplay that allowed Scott to create a world while his actors defined their developed characters. “The Dog Stars” has none of these elements. In fact, it doesn’t even have a point. The song playing over the end credits should have been Peggy Lee’s “Is That All There Is?”

Odie Henderson is the Boston Globe’s film critic.

‘Coyote vs. Acme’ is a fast and furry-ous delight

► **“COYOTE VS. ACME”**
Continued from Page G1

“Coyote vs. Acme” was slated to suffer the same fate as “Batgirl” and “Scoob!: Holiday Haunt,” the other two unreleased films Warner Bros. shelved for tax write-offs.

And yet, here I am reviewing a movie that, like its hero, Wile E. Coyote, lives to fight another day despite being temporarily defeated by the deficient actions of a major corporation. The best part of all is that “Coyote vs. Acme” is a superb piece of filmmaking, a loving tribute to the most hapless of all Looney Tunes characters and the many fans who love him.

We begin with a flashback that honors Peter Lorre, one of the many famous WB stars parodied by the animators of Termite Terrace. The animated Dr. Lorre works in research and development for the Acme Corporation, but he knows too much about something called “Project Sisyphus.” After Acme’s goons dispatch him with a familiar product seen in numerous cartoons, the film jumps to the present.

Next, we’re in Albuquerque, New Mexico, site of Bugs Bunny’s many wrong left turns. The desert locale is also the home of Wile E. Coyote and his preternaturally fast nemesis, the Road Runner. The coyote whips out one of his trusty Acme products, which malfunctions as usual. Like Sisyphus rolling his rock up that hill for all eternity, Wile E.’s relationship with Acme products has been the same since he first bought their Super Suit product in his 1949 debut “Fast and Furry-ous.”

Distraught after his latest set of blueprints leads to failure, Wile E. is



KETCHUP ENTERTAINMENT VIA AP

Wile E. Coyote in “Coyote vs. Acme.”

inspired by an ad he sees on TV. Attorney Ken Avery (Will Forte) asks if he’s been in a cartoon-related accident. After describing several scenarios, Avery suggests calling the law firm of “Avery, Jones & Maltese” to file a lawsuit. The firm is named after directors Tex Avery and Chuck Jones, and writer Michael Maltese. The latter two were the creators of the Road Runner-Coyote series, which they saw as parodies of chase cartoons like Tom & Jerry.

Unfortunately, Ken is no Johnnie Cochran. He’s a lazy, jaded, Harvard-educated lawyer who settles every law-

suit brought against Acme by his toon clientele. His younger, idealistic niece, Paige (Lana Condor), is interning with the firm, and her perky desire to make a difference drives Ken crazy. So, when Wile E. brings his case to the firm, the attorney is quick to dismiss him despite his examples of Acme products malfunctioning.

Wile E. refuses to settle despite Ken’s pleas. An accidental filing of lawsuits involving every single Acme product that failed Wile E. puts Ken at odds with his law school rival, Buddy Crane (John Cena), the hard-as-nails attack

MOVIE REVIEW

★★★★
COYOTE VS. ACME
Directed by Dave Green. Written by Samy Burch. Screen story by James Gunn, Jeremy Slater. Based on the New Yorker article by Ian Frazier. Starring Will Forte, Lana Condor, John Cena, Eric Bauza, Candi Milo, Jim Cummings, Luis Guzmán. At AMC Boston Common, Alamo Drafthouse Seaport, suburbs. 101 minutes. PG (slapstick violence. That’s all, folks.)

lawyer for the Acme Corporation. And it’s a lot of lawsuits; the coyote’s been a loyal Acme customer for 77 years. That’s a lot of exploding detonators, failed catapults, round bombs with short fuses, and malfunctioning power skates.

From here, “Coyote vs. Acme” becomes not just the tale of a consumer David taking on a conglomerate Goliath — it’s also a story of friendship and acceptance. Wile E. Coyote is clearly a compulsive whose existence must revolve around chasing an uncatchable bird — it’s what defines him and gives him purpose. The clever, tight screenplay by Samy Burch (“Late Fame,” “May December”) excels at acknowledging this quirk, as well as recontextualizing the entire Wile E.-Road Runner dynamic without ruining their characters.

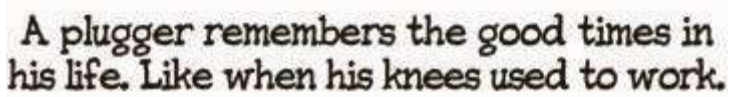
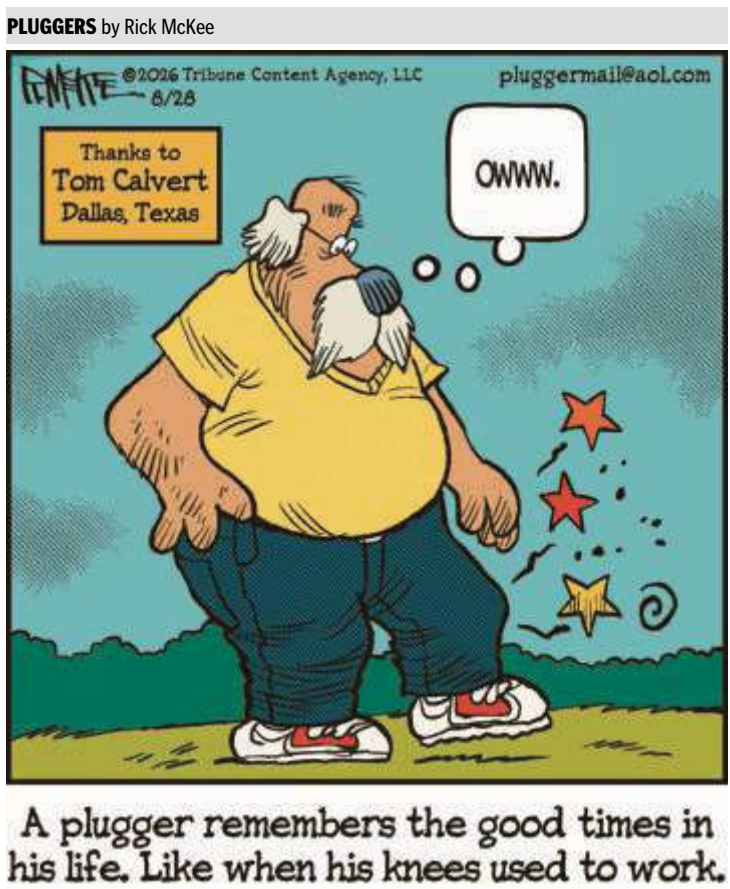
Working off a screen story by James Gunn (“Superman”) and Jeremy Slater, Burch also creates a fun, crackling con-

spiracy theory yarn that sneaks in an anti-corporate message while putting the Looney Tunes characters in roles you’d expect. In this paranoid thriller, it makes sense that Bugs Bunny is a Deep Throat-style informant and Foghorn Leghorn is a backwoods Southern lawyer working for Acme. Of course hopeless hunter Elmer Fudd would be a senator. After all, he’s a millionaire who owns a mansion and a yacht!

Forte and Condor are both excellent, with Forte providing an unexpected level of sentiment. West Newbury native Cena is a fun villain, and Luis Guzmán shows up in a fun cameo. There are also some blink-and-you’ll-miss-them gags that are absolutely hilarious. I’m still laughing at what happens to Pepe Le Pew, and stunned that the filmmakers included Cool Cat (the late 1960s Looney Tunes character) in a scene. The Looney Tunes characters look and sound great, too. Kudos to Eric Bauza, who voices many of them, and to voice artists Candi Milo and Jim Cummings. The cartoony score by Steven Price includes an appropriate choir of Road Runners singing “Beep Beep.”

Ketchup Entertainment, the company that made the entertaining Porky Pig-Daffy Duck animated feature “The Day the Earth Blew Up,” deserves credit for saving “Coyote vs. Acme” from the abyss. It’s one of the year’s best movies, and deserves to shame Warner Bros. by raking in boffo box office numbers. For once, an Acme product would work as intended.

Odie Henderson is the Boston Globe’s film critic.



DE-CREASE BY JARED CAPPEL | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

- 1 Oohs and ____
- 2 With 11-Down,
rom-com trope of
an adorable first
encounter
- 3 Diva's solo
- 4 NFL team in black
and gold
- 5 Gymnast Strug
- 6 Driver's licenses,
passports, etc.
- 7 Pasta sauce brand
- 8 Wow
- 9 Wow
- 10 Dole (out)
- 11 See 2-Down
- 12 Pre-owned
- 14 On fire
- 16 Give the meaning of
- 20 Word after "gummy"
or "teddy"
- 22 "That's yours
now"
- 24 Bearded garden
statue
- 25 Giant opportunity?

54 Herr's wife
55 Fish that are
 snakelike
56 Foods dyed on Easter
57 Large canine?
59 Fly high
60 Spanish currency
61 Artisan's website
63 Actor McKellen

8-28-26

CLUE: He was a Mouseketeer on "The All New Mickey Mouse Club."

How to play Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

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Boston's forecast

TODAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 80-85

LOW 63-68

A couple of afternoon showers and a thunderstorm. Winds SW 6-12 mph. Partly cloudy tonight. Winds NW 6-12 mph.

SATURDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 72-77

LOW 64-69

Pleasant and less humid with clouds and sunshine. Winds ENE 7-14 mph. Mainly clear at night. Winds SW 6-12 mph.

SUNDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 83-88

LOW 67-72

Warmer with intervals of bright sunshine. Winds WSW 7-14 mph. Thickening clouds at night. Winds WSW 7-14 mph.

MONDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 77-82

LOW 63-68

Mostly cloudy. Winds ENE 6-12 mph. Showers and a thunderstorm at night, mainly later. Winds NE 4-8 mph.

TUESDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 73-78

LOW 63-68

Mostly cloudy; a thunderstorm. Winds NE 7-14 mph. Mostly cloudy at night; rain and a thunderstorm late. Winds E 6-12 mph.

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AccuWeather.

New England

<0 0s 10s 20s 30s 40s 50s 60s 70s 80s 90s 100+

TODAY:

Mostly cloudy and humid with a few thunderstorms around the area, especially along the coast.

TOMORROW:

Less humid and pleasant. A beautiful start to the weekend throughout the region.

EXTENDED:

Times of clouds and sun; turning warmer on Sunday. Cloudy with rain and thunderstorms around the area on Monday.

Forecasts and graphics provided by AccuWeather, Inc. ©2026

Temperatures are today's highs and tonight's lows.

Almanac

Yesterday's high/low 85°/66°

Sunrise today 6:05 a.m.

Sunset today 7:25 p.m.

Moonrise today 7:36 p.m.

Mount Washington (5 p.m. yesterday)

Weather Rain

Visibility 0 miles

Wind south-southwest at 31 m.p.h.

High/low temperature 52/45

Snow depth at 5 p.m. 0.0"

24 Hr. Precipitation (valid at 5 p.m. yesterday)

Yesterday 0.00" Month to date 0.98" Year to date 17.59"

Precip days in August 9 Norm. month to date 2.84" Norm. year to date 27.65"

Climate data are compiled from National Weather Service records and are subject to change or correction.

Tides

	A.M.	P.M.
Boston high	---	12:13
Height	---	9.6
Boston low	6:01	6:14
Height	0.3	0.6

High tides

	A.M.	P.M.
Gloucester	---	12:13
Marblehead	---	12:13
Lynn	---	12:13
Scituate	---	12:16
Plymouth	---	12:21
Cape Cod	---	12:02
Canal East	---	12:02
Cape Cod	---	12:20
Plum Island	---	12:25
Ipswich	---	12:01

Eastern Massachusetts air quality

GOOD MOD. UNHEALTHY VERY UNHEALTHY

43 50 100 150 200 300

For more information on today's conditions, call the state hotline at (800) 882-1497 or Massachusetts Department of Environmental Protection web site www.state.ma.us/DEP

New England marine forecast

	Wind	Seas	Temp
Boston Harbor	S 6-12 kts.	1-3 ft.	81/64
East Cape	S 6-12 kts.	1-3 ft.	81/65
Cod Canal	S 6-12 kts.	1-3 ft.	81/65
Buzzards Bay	S 7-14 kts.	1-3 ft.	81/65

For current Charles River Basin water quality, call (781) 788-0007 or go to http://www.charlesriver.org.

Cities

Forecast high and low temperatures and conditions

● Travel delays possible, C Clouds, F Fog, H Haze, I Ice, Pc Partly Cloudy, R Rain, Sh Showers, S Sun, Sn Snow, Fl Flurries, T Thunderstorms, W Windy

	Today	Tomorrow
● Atlanta	88/72 T 88/72 T	
● Atlantic City	84/67 T 81/65 Pc	
● Charlotte	86/71 T 84/70 T	
Chicago	81/66 S 80/69 Pc	
Dallas	101/78 S 100/79 S	
● Denver	94/67 T 92/65 Pc	
Detroit	79/59 S 83/64 Pc	
● Fort Myers	93/76 T 93/77 T	

	Today	Tomorrow
Los Angeles	95/74 S 91/69 S	
● Miami	92/80 T 93/79 T	
● New Orleans	89/78 T 90/76 T	
● New York City	83/65 T 80/65 Pc	
● Philadelphia	85/68 T 86/67 Pc	
Phoenix	113/88 S 109/86 T	
Salt Lake City	91/66 Pc 81/63 T	
San Francisco	70/58 Pc 70/56 Pc	

	Today	Tomorrow
Seattle	71/54 Pc 68/54 Pc	
● Washington	86/69 T 87/70 C	
Beijing	72/64 R 89/63 Pc	
Cancun	95/77 S 95/76 Pc	
● Mexico City	78/58 R 74/57 R	
Montreal	72/54 Pc 75/60 Pc	
Toronto	73/55 C 77/64 Sh	
● Vancouver	70/55 Sh 68/56 Sh	

	Today	Tomorrow
Jerusalem	88/70 S 88/70 S	
● London	74/62 Pc 70/59 Sh	
Moscow	67/52 Pc 69/53 S	
● Paris	70/59 Sh 71/60 R	
Rome	96/78 Pc 90/70 C	
San Juan	91/80 Sh 92/81 R	
Stockholm	69/58 C 63/55 R	
Tokyo	89/77 R 78/72 R	

HOROSCOPES

HAPPY BIRTHDAY for Friday, Aug. 28, 2026: You're a determined, inventive nonconformist. You seek knowledge and ways to express your creativity. This is the beginning of a new cycle. Expect adventures and major changes. Be open to new opportunities. Prepare for leadership. What you do now will bring great benefit in the future.

ARIES (*March 21-April 19*) This is a challenging day at work. Equipment breakdowns and unexpected problems, including staff shortages, might occur. People are also touchy. Everyone (including you) is ready to rebel against anything they don't like. Be mindful of everything you say and do. Tonight: Privacy. **TAURUS** (*April 20-May 20*) Today you need to keep track of your money because something unexpected could impact your wealth through damage, loss, or theft. Parents should be extra vigilant, as this is an accident-prone day for your kids. Social plans will change. Tonight: Friendships. **GEMINI** (*May 21-June 20*) This is a challenging day! The

Moon is at the top of your chart and the Sun is at the bottom of your chart, and they are both at odds with unpredictable Uranus in your sign. It's the classic day for rebellion against authority. Your home routine might change. Equipment might break. Tread carefully! Tonight: Be modest. **CANCER** (*June 21-July 22*) Pay attention to everything you say and do today because this is an accident-prone day. Think before you speak, because you might feel controlled by your impulses. This could get you in trouble. Be aware of everything you do. Keep things simple. Tonight: Check your finances. **LEO** (*July 23-Aug. 22*) This is a challenging day in terms of dealing with your money, possessions, friends, and groups. It feels like everything is up for grabs, and in a way, it is. Fortunately, you will be diplomatic and skillful when speaking with others. By nature, you are quick to see the big picture, and this will help. Tonight: Cooperate. **VIRGO** (*Aug. 23-Sept. 22*) Today the Sun is in your sign at odds with Uranus and the Moon. This is not easy. You might suddenly have an argument. Sudden

upsets are classic. Equipment or cars might have sudden breakdowns. Your daily routine will not be the same. Keep your eyes open to avoid accidents. Tonight: Work. **LIBRA** (*Sept. 23-Oct. 22*) This is a tough day, but there are some blessings. For the most part, your work routine might be interrupted. Travel plans might suddenly change. It's the kind of day where you take two steps forward and one step back. Fortunately, your ruler Venus is in your sign helping you cope. Tonight: Get better organized. **SCORPIO** (*Oct. 23-Nov. 21*) Unexpected upsets with friends, groups and financial institutions might take place today. People might quarrel about assets or money. Parents must be vigilant because this is an accident-prone day for your kids. Nevertheless, travel appeals. Keep your eyes open. Tonight: Socialize. **SAGITTARIUS** (*Nov. 22-Dec. 21*) This is the classic day for a public argument or a rebellion. Fortunately, the position of the Sun makes you look good. Nevertheless, you could end up with egg on your face. (Ketchup helps.) Don't throw your weight around.

Be patient and tolerant with others. Tonight: Relax at home. **CAPRICORN** (*Dec. 22-Jan. 19*) Tread carefully, because this is an accident-prone day. Whatever happens will be swift and come right out of the blue. Pay attention to everything you say and do, especially related to your work. Travel will be interrupted or canceled. Be alert. Tonight: Intense conversations. **AQUARIUS** (*Jan. 20-Feb. 18*) Today is full of all kinds of unexpected events and little rebellions; however, this wild energy will likely impact your possessions, money, and shared property. Social plans will suddenly change. Parents must be more aware about their kids to avoid accidents. Tonight: Check your belongings. **PISCES** (*Feb. 19-March 20*) Today the Moon is in your sign at odds with the Sun, Mercury, and Uranus, which is an explosive energy. This is the classic day for little rebellions and accidents. Equipment and cars might break down. Family arguments might take place. Stay chill. Tonight: You're in charge.

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SUDOKU

				6		7	4
			2	7		6	
		8			2		
	7		2				6
4	1				5		9
8			1		4		
		4			6		
	8		3	2			
9	3			5			

Fill in the grid so that every row, every column, and every 3X3 box contains the digits 1 through 9. Puzzle difficulty levels: Easy on Monday and Tuesday, more difficult on Wednesday and Thursday, most difficult on Friday and Saturday. Tips and computer program at www.sudoku.com.

DAILY BRIDGE CLUB

BY FRANK STEWART

South dealer — N-S vulnerable

North

♠ J 6 4 2
♥ Q 9 3
♦ K 7 6
♣ Q 10 5

East

♠ Q 10 5
♥ J 10 4 2
♦ 10 5
♣ 9 8 4 2

South

♠ K 8
♥ A K 6
♦ A J 8 4 3
♣ 7 6 3

South

1 NT

West

Pass

North

2 NT

East

All Pass

Opening lead — ♠ 3

Unlucky Louie and his wife have raised nine kids. Louie says being a parent is like skydiving with people who can't open their chute, and you have to do it for them. And then you hit the ground, but you don't die; you have to get up and see about supper.

Bridge is a partnership game; you must be considerate of your partner's problems. In today's deal, West led the three of spades against 2NT: deuce, ten, king. Declarer led a diamond to dummy's king and finessed with the jack. West took the queen, pondered and led the nine of spades: four, five ... eight!

Great. But West was so euphoric at squashing South's eight of spades that he led a third spade. East took the ten and had to guess what to do next. When he led a heart, South made 2NT with four diamond tricks, three hearts and a spade.

West didn't take care of his partner. After the nine of spades wins, West must cash the king of clubs before leading another spade. When East wins, he will know to return a club.

DAILY QUESTION You hold: ♠ K 8 ♥ A K 6 ♦ A J 8 4 3 ♣ 7 6 3. Neither side vulnerable. The dealer, at your right, opens one spade. What do you say?

ANSWER: To act isn't safe; if your partner is broke, any action could land you in serious trouble. But to pass isn't safe either since you may even have a game if he has some values. An overcall of two diamonds on a broken five-card suit would put your eggs in one leaky basket. If you act, a double is a more flexible call.

ZIPPY "Lap Dance" by Bill Griffith

BIZARRO by Wayno & Piraro

MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM by Mike Peters

ADAM@HOME by Rob Harrell

ROSE IS ROSE by Pat Brady & Don Wimmer

Today's Crossword Solution

Y	O	R	E	A	N	G	N	V	S	S	U
S	R	V	E	R	R	N	E	E	R	G	T
T	U	O	N	O	R	I	A	T	A	T	E
E	E	S	I	H	O	E	F	A	S	T	E
		A	S	E	S	T	E	E	T		
S	S	O	T	F	U	V	T	N	O	T	E
R	E	A	E	F	O	C	S	I	D	C	W
A	P	I	O	O	S	P	A	S	B	O	R
E	E	R	E	D	E	F	E	R	E	N	I
S	M	E	N	E	R	A	E	E	M	A	G
		I	T	E	K	I	T	L			
D	E	E	F	Z	U	B	R	E	T	A	S
E	T	E	Z	V	G		S	R	E	I	H
S	U	E	D	W	A		D	E	T	A	V
C	U	M	D	R	A		S	K	I	A	M

Today's Sudoku Solution

8	4	7	1	5	9	6	2	3	6
5	6	1	2	4	3	6	8	7	
2	3	9	6	7	8	4	5	1	
7	2	4	5	1	6	3	9	8	
6	8	5	9	3	7	1	2	4	
9	1	3	8	2	4	7	6	5	
3	5	2	4	6	1	8	7	9	
1	9	6	7	8	2	5	4	3	
4	7	8	3	6	5	9	1	2	

TV CRITIC'S CORNER

BY MATT JUUL



From left: Yahya Abdul-Mateen II and Sir Ben Kingsley in “Wonder Man.”

5 first-time Emmy-nominated shows worth streaming

The 2026 Emmy Awards arrive Monday, Sept. 14, and among the latest crop of nominees are a ton of first-timers worth checking out or revisiting. In a special edition of our weekend streaming guide, here are five new shows nominated for Emmys this year that are worth binge-watching (or re-watching) ahead of next month's ceremony.

‘Widow’s Bay’ Easily my favorite new show of the year, the New England-set, Mass.-filmed horror comedy “Widow’s Bay” scored an impressive 19 Emmy nominations for its first season, including a nod for outstanding comedy series. While the Apple TV series itself is a first-time nominee, star Matthew Rhys is no stranger to the Emmys stage, and is up for outstanding lead actor in a comedy series (he’s also a nominee in the category outstanding lead actor in a limited or anthology series or movie for “The Beast in Me”). Deservingly, co-stars Kate O’Flynn and Dale Dickey both earned their first Emmy nominations and will face each other in the outstanding supporting actress in a comedy series category. *Available on Apple TV*

‘A Knight of the Seven Kingdoms’ I was admittedly skeptical of yet another “Game of Thrones” spinoff dominating my Sunday nights, but newcomer “A Knight of the Seven Kingdoms” has proven worthy of its royal time slot. Earning nine nominations, including a nod for outstanding drama series, the show spins a tale set well before the events of the original series, following the adventures of aspiring knight Dunk (Peter Claffey) and his squire Egg (Dexter Sol Ansell). *Available on HBO Max*

‘Margo’s Got Money Troubles’ Scoring eight nominations, including a nod for outstanding comedy series, Apple TV’s star-studded “Margo’s Got Money Troubles” has the chance to make some noise with its Emmys debut. The series stars Elle Fanning (up for outstanding lead actress in a com-

edy series) as the titular protagonist, a young writer who unexpectedly becomes pregnant after a tryst with her married English professor (Michael Angarano) and turns to OnlyFans to help pay the bills. “The performances in ‘Margo’s Got Money Troubles’ carry it a long way,” Globe TV critic Chris Vognar wrote in his review of the series. “Fanning can do fierce or tender, and when Margo smiles (and scowls) for the webcam, we see not a victim but a woman taking control of her image.” *Available on Apple TV*

‘Pluribus’ Creator Vince Gilligan cooked up another TV gem with the first season of “Pluribus,” with the hit sci-fi series scoring 18 nominations, including a nod for outstanding drama series. The show revolves around Rhea Seehorn’s Carol, a woman immune to a virus causing folks to lose themselves in a zonked out hive mind. Seehorn earned her fourth Emmy nomination for her performance and is up for outstanding lead actress in a drama series this year. *Available on Apple TV*

‘Wonder Man’ It’s a shame Disney decided to can the previously greenlit season 2 of “Wonder Man,” because star Yahya Abdul-Mateen II turned in a fabulous performance as the titular Marvel hero in the show’s first and now likely only season. Earning an Emmy nomination for outstanding lead actor in a comedy series (he previously won the award for outstanding supporting actor in a limited series or movie for his work on HBO’s “Watchmen” series), Abdul-Mateen plays an actor named Simon Williams who secretly has powers but keeps them hidden as he looks for his breakout moment in Hollywood. Williams finds an unlikely friend in disgraced actor and villainous face of “Iron Man 3,” Trevor Slattery (Sir Ben Kingsley), with the duo’s often heartwarming relationship serving as the show’s backbone. *Available on Disney+*

LOVE LETTERS

BY MEREDITH GOLDSTEIN

Feeling guilty 15 years later

Q. About 15 years ago I was dating a man, and we weren’t in a very good relationship. We were fighting a lot.

One day, a friend of mine came over with her her boyfriend, and we all became friends.

Then something happened. I ended up cheating on my boyfriend with my friend’s boyfriend. Then he broke up with her without telling her why.

He didn’t tell anyone why, actually. I still feel really guilty about it.

I’m no longer friends with any of them, mostly because we stopped talking to each other over time. But the guilt is still there. I don’t talk to my ex anymore either. Eventually he left because he simply didn’t want to continue the relationship.

I’ve never told anybody about what happened, but I feel like everyone involved knows. I plan on telling my therapist about this.

I was just wondering: How do I move on and stop feeling guilty about it?

GUILTY

A. *“I plan on telling my therapist about this.”*

Please do. A therapist can help you make sense of the ugly stuff. Get more for your money by saying everything.

“Then he broke up with her without telling her why.”

You don’t know why your friend’s boyfriend broke up with her. Sure, the cheat was probably part of it, but what led to that decision? Maybe they were unhappy anyway.

Don’t get me wrong, it’s bad behavior — and I’m not saying you’re blameless — it just seems like their relationship was *breakable* for reasons you were never told.

There is a lesson here, from my vantage point. You were unhappy with your boyfriend. In-



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stead of breaking up with him, you cheated. I hope that in a present-day relationship you’d be more honest about your feelings along the way.

I *also* hope this experience taught you to be more thoughtful about friendships.

After 15 years, you’ve evolved into a new version of yourself, right? You’re allowed to accept who you’ve become, flawed past and all.

Telling a therapist will make you feel lighter, I think. Maybe it’s harder to move on when a bad deed feels like a skeleton in the closet, never to be discussed or understood.

One last thought: I would not recommend calling anyone to apologize at this point. Let it be. I only bring that up because you put a detail in your question — one I edited out because it felt too specific. It made me wonder if you *wanted* to be recognized, caught, contacted, etc. The forgiveness has to come from within.

MEREDITH

READERS RESPOND:

Talk to your therapist and maybe a close friend (one who doesn’t know the people involved) to get it out, and then don’t spend any more en-

ergy on this.

DDL314

Lesson learned, forgive yourself, don’t try to do confesionals with the actual people involved, and try to get a more satisfying present day life focus.

AUNTTIGGYWINK

It sounds to me as if you’d like an excuse to start something back up with some of these folks — to contact someone under the fake excuse of “I’m sorry.” DO NOT DO THAT. Let this all go and focus on your current life.

KWINTERS1

Fifteen years is a long time to carry that weight. Focus on what you’ve done since then, and how, ultimately, things worked out better for everyone because they got out of whatever mess they were in at the time.

SUNALSORISES

I have a friend who would hold onto guilt like this. We are in our 40s, and she would randomly text me apologies for things she felt she did wrong in our teens. I never understood it and still don’t. What function does the guilt serve you? It has to benefit you in some way or you would have released it long ago. Ask yourself how it benefits you. And yes, talk to your therapist (surprised they don’t know about this since it seems significant for you).

HELLOWORLD14

Send relationship and dating questions to loveletters@globe.com. Catch new episodes of Meredith Goldstein’s “Love Letters” podcast wherever you listen to podcasts. Column and comments are edited and reprinted from boston.com/loveletters.

Friday August 28, 2026

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
2	WGBH PBS	BBC News	R. Steves	Stories-Stage	My Music With	Great Performances (N)	Great Performances	Great Performances	Aman-pour (N)	
4	WBZ CBS	Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	NFL Football Cincinnati Bengals at Philadelphia Eagles From Lincoln Financial Field in Philadelphia. (N)	(Live)			News	(:35) Comics	
5	WCVB ABC	News (N)	Chronicle	Jeopardy! Masters	(N)	20/20 (N)		NewsCenter 5	(:35) J. Kimmel	
6	WLNE ABC	Videos		Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live	
7	WHDH	Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud	Family Feud	7 News at 9PM	7 News at 10PM	7 News at 11PM	(:35) Inside	
9	WMUR ABC	Football	News	Jeopardy! (N)		20/20 (N)		News	J.Kimmel	
10	NBC Boston	Boston News	Hollywood (N)	America’s Got Talent	"Quarterfinals 2"		Dateline NBC (N)	Boston News	(:35) J. Fallon	
10	WJAR NBC	News (N)	Extra (N)	America's Got Talent	"Quarterfinals 2"		Dateline NBC (N)	News (Live)	(:35) J. Fallon	
11	WENH PBS	Week-	R. Steves	Week (N)	Hoover (N)	Great Performances (N)	Great Performances	Aman-pour (N)		
12	WPRI CBS	Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	NFL Football Cincinnati Bengals at Philadelphia Eagles From Lincoln Financial Field in Philadelphia. (N)	(Live)			12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics	
25	WFXT FOX	Women's College Volleyball Purdue vs. Creighton (Live)		Women's College Volleyball Minnesota vs. Arizona State (Live)				News (Live)	(:35) News (N)	
27	WUNI	Rosa "Regalos de fantasia"	Tan cerca "Frente a la verdad"	Guardián d "Boda y venganza" (N)	Corazón "El rescate de Miranda" (N)			Noticias Univisión	(:35) Noticiero	
36	WSBE PBS	WaterFire: Art & Soul of a City	Lively with	Ian Donniss	Air Supply: 50th Anniversary Concert		Rick Steves	PBS News Hour		
38	WSBK	Big Bang	Big Bang	WBZ News 8p (N)	48 Hours "Invitation to a Murder" (N)	Perfect	Perfect	Flip Side	Flip Side	
44	WGBX PBS	Test Kitchen	Antiques	Week (N)	Hoover (N)	POV "How to Build a Library"	POV Shorts	PBS News Hour (N)		
50	WWJE	48 Hours		Heartland Homicide	Homicide "Brown"	Crime Stories	Unusual Suspects			
56	WLVI CW	NASCAR (Live)	NASCAR O'Reilly Auto Parts Series Winn-Dixie 250	(Live)		7 News at 10PM on CW56	Modern Family	Modern Family		
64	WNAC FOX	Women's College Volleyball Purdue vs. Creighton (Live)		Women's College Volleyball Minnesota vs. Arizona State (Live)			12 News	Seinfeld		
68	WBXP ION	WNBA (Live)	WNBA Basketball Connecticut Sun at Indiana Fever (N)	(Live)	WNBA-Game (N)	WNBA Basketball Toronto Tempo at Las Vegas Aces (N)	(Live)			
PREMIUM CABLE										
Cinemax	(6:15) ★★★ It ('17) Jeremy Ray Taylor, Jaeden Martell.		★★ Y2K ('24) Jaeden Martell, Rachel Zegler.		(:05) ★ Stonewall ('15) Jonny Beauchamp, Joey King, Jeremy Irvine.					
Flix	(6:00) The Saint ('97)		★★ The Bodyguard ('92) Whitney Houston, Gary Kemp, Kevin Costner.		(:15) ★★★ An Officer and a Gentleman ('82) Debra Winger, Richard Gere.					
HBO	(:10) ★★★ The Drama ('26) Robert Pattinson, Alana Haim, Zendaya.		Conan O'Brien Must Go (N)		Real Time With Bill Maher (N)		Conan O'Brien	(:50) Real Time		
HBO 2	(:10) ★★★ Deadpool 2 ('18) Josh Brolin, Morena Baccarin, Ryan Reynolds.		(:10) ★★★ It Comes at Night ('17) Joel Edgerton.		(:40) Monsters of God		How to Make a ...			
Paramount-Sho	★★ He's Just Not That Into You ('09) Jennifer Aniston, Ben Affleck.		(:15) ★★★ Best in Show Michael Hitchcock.		(:50) ★★ The Mechanic ('11) Ben Foster, Jason Statham.					
Showtime 2	(6:15) ★★ Vacation ('15) Ed Helms.		★★★ The Hangover ('09) Ed Helms, Bradley Cooper.		(:45) ★★ The Hangover Part II ('11) Ed Helms, Bradley Cooper.		Hangover Part III			
Starz!	(:05) Outlander "Birthright"		(:05) Fightland		Fightland (N)	(:55) Fightland	(:50) Fightland	(:45) ★★ Michael		
TMC	(6:15) Vicious ('25) Dakota Fanning.		★★★ Sleepy Hollow ('99) Christina Ricci, Johnny Depp.		(:50) ★★ Friday the 13th ('80) Adrienne King, Harry Crosby, Betsy Palmer.		Friday the 13th, Par...			
SPORTS										
CBSSN	Athletes Unlimited Softball League All-Star Cup: Teams TBA (N) (Live)				UFC Ultimate Knockouts					
ESPN	High School Football (N) (Live)				College Football Idaho at Cal Poly-San Luis Obispo (N) (Live)					
ESPN2	(6:30) Wm. Volleyball Kansas at Pittsburgh (N) (Live)		Volleyball (N)		Women's College Volleyball Wisconsin at Stanford (N) (Live)		SportsCenter (N) (Live)			
Fox Sports 1	(6:00) IndyCar	All In: Indycar	Big Noon Conversations		ARCA Menards Series Madison International Speedway 200 (N) (Live)		IndyCar Milwaukee Mile 250, Practice 1			
Golf	PGA Tour Champions Golf				2026 TOUR Championship Second Round					
NBA	(6:30) TBA		To Be Announced		The Association (Live)		The Association			
NBC Sports	Early Edition		Best of Felger & Mazz		Best of Zolak and Bertrand		BST Fridays (N) (Live)	BST Fridays		
NESN	(6:00) Minor League Baseball		Chat (N)		WooSox	Clubhouse	Life	Hobby		
FAMILY										
Cartoon	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty	President	
Disney	(6:50) Bluey		★★ Alvin and the Chipmunks: Chipwrecked ('11) Jason Lee.	(:35) ZOMBIES	FAMILY ZOMBIES: Re-	Kiff	Ladybug	Ladybug		
Encore Family	Movie	(:45) The Ladybug ('18)		★★★ The Mistress of Spices	(:35) Race to Win ('16)					
Nickelodeon	★★★ The Boss Baby 2: Family Business		Friends	Friends	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang		
Nick Jr.	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; TV-Y7 For children age 7 and older; TV-G General audience; TV-PG Parental guidance suggested; TV-14 May be unsuitable for children under 14;

TV-MA Mature audience only Additional symbols: D Suggestive dialogue; FV Fantasy violence; L Strong language; S Sexual activity; V Violence; HD High-Definition; (CC) Close-Captioned

News	Specials									
	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
BASIC CABLE										
A&E	(6:00) Scott Peterson "Part 1"	Scott Peterson: The New Evidence "Part 2"				Scott Peterson: The New Evidence (N)		(:05) Scott Peterson "Part 1"		
AMC	(5:00) Bad Boys II	★★★ Casino '95) Sharon Stone, Joe Pesci, Robert De Niro.								
Animal Planet	Treehouse Masters	Treehouse "Off-the-Grid Getaway"			Treehouse Masters		Treehouse "Treetop Medieval Fortress"		Treehouse Masters "Treehouse Utopia"	
BBC America	Law "Birthright"	Law & Order			Law & Order		Law "Criminal Law"		Law & Order "Acid"	
BET	(6:05) ★★★ Training Day '01) Ethan Hawke, Scott Glenn, Denzel Washington.				★★★ Baby Boy '01) Tyrese Gibson.		Omar Gooding, Adrienne-Joi Johnson,			
Bravo	(6:00) ★★ Transformers: Revenge of the Fallen '09) Megan Fox, Shia LaBeouf. (P)				★★★ Transformers: Dark of the Moon '11) Josh Duhamel, John Turturro, Shia LaBeouf. (P)		Josh Duhamel, John Turturro, Shia LaBeouf. (P)			
CMT	Movie	★ Dirty Grandpa '16) Zac Efron, Robert De Niro. (P)				★★ Ace Ventura: Pet Detective '94)				
CNN	OutFront	(Live)	Cooper 360		The Source With		CNN NewsNight		Laura (Live)	
Comedy Central	The Office	(:35) The Office	(:10) The Office	(:45) The Office	(:20) The Office "Product Recall"		(:55) The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office
CSPAN	Ceasefire	C-SPAN Primetime				Ceasefire		C-SPAN Primetime		
CSPAN2	(6:55) Co..	(:55) Cou..	(:20) The Courts			(:50) Q & A	(:40) The Courts	Courts		
Dest. America	Island	Island	Island	Island	Island	Island	Island	Island	Island	Island
Discovery	Deadliest Catch	Deadliest Catch (N)				In the Eye		In the Eye		
Discovery Life	(6:00) My 600-Lb	My 600-Lb. Life "Lisa's Journey"				My 600-Lb. Life "David's Journey"				
E!	★ Coyote Ugly Piper Perabo.				★ Coyote Ugly Piper Perabo.				Cocktail	Cocktail
Encore	(:10) ★★ Click '06) Adam Sandler.				★★★ 50 First Dates '04)				(:45) ★ Big Daddy '99)	
Food	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive
Fox News	Ingraham (Live)	Jesse (N) (Live)		Hannity (Live)		Gutfeld!		Fox News (Live)		
Freeform	R.J. "Pilot" (N) (P)	R.J. Decker (N)		R.J. Decker (N)		R.J. Decker (N)		The 700 Club		
FUSE	Diddy: Monster's Fall	Fatal Addiction: Michael Jackson			Elvis Presley: The Final Hours			Sex Sells	Sex Sells	
FX	★★★ Venom: The Last Dance '24)		★★★ Thor: The Dark World '13) Chris Hemsworth.		Invincible					
FXM	(6:05) French Dispa...		(:20) ★★ Jojo Rabbit '19) Roman Griffin Davis.		(:35) The French Dispatch					
Hallmark	(6:00) Never Kiss a ...		We Met in December '25)				Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) Aurora		Aurora "Reunited and It Feels So Deadly"				Murder, She Wrote	Murder, She Wrote	Murder, She Wrote	Murder, She Wrote
HGTV	Dream Home	Dream Home	Dream Home	Dream Home	Dream Home (N) (SF)	Zillow (N) (SF)	Roast My Hunters (N)	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters
History	UnXplained "The Search for Atlantis"		The UnXplained "Buried Mysteries"		UnXplained "Human Anomalies" (N) (SF)		(:05) UnXplained "Dangerous Places"		(:05) The UnXplained	
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic
HSN	DG2 Fash. (N) (Live)		DG2 Fash. (N) (Live)		Debbie (N) (Live)		Debbie (N) (Live)		Football (Live)	
ID	Evil Lives "A Special Place in Hell"		Evil Lives Here "He'll Kill Me Next"		Evil Lives "The Child I Thought I Knew"		Evil Educator (N)		Killers "Chilled to the Bone"	
IFC	(6:30) National Lampoon's Euro...				★ Vegas Vacation '97) Chevy Chase.		★★★ Trading Places '83)			
Lifetime	NCIS "Deception"		NCIS		NCIS "Head Case"		(:05) NCIS		(:05) NCIS	
LMN	(6:00) Wrong Blind ...		The Wrong Housemaid '26)				The Wrong Marriage '25) Vivica A. Fox.			
MAGN	Maine		Maine		Maine		Maine		Maine	
MSNBC	The Weeknight		All in (Live)		Briefing (Live)		Last Word (Live)		The 11th (Live)	
MTV	★★★ Harry Potter and the Chamber of Secrets '02) Daniel Radcliffe.						Harry Potter & the Prisoner of A...			
National Geographic	Smuggler "Kilos From Colombia"		Smuggler "Lights Camera Cocaine"		Catch a Smuggler "Strange Brew"		Smuggler "Elderly Cocaine Carrier"		Catch a Smuggler "Dirty Dealing"	
NatGeoWild	Life Below Zero (N)		Life Below Zero (N)		Life Below Zero (N)		Life Below Zero (N)		Life Below Zero (N)	
NECN	OpenHou... 1st Look		Dateline		Dateline		Rescue		OpenHou... 1st Look	
NewsNation	Vargas Report		Cuomo (N)		On Balance (N)		Katie Pavlich		Jesse Web	
Ovation	Death in Paradise		Death in Paradise		Death in Paradise		Death in Paradise		Death in Paradise	
OWN	Put a Ring		Put a Ring (N)		Iyanla: Inside		Iyanla: Inside		Put a Ring	
Oxygen	Snapped		Snapped		Snapped		Snapped		Snapped	
Paramount	(6:00) Raiders of the Lost Ark		(:35) ★★★ Ghostbusters '84) Bill Murray.		Bill Murray.		(:05) Ghostbusters II			
QVC	Haircare (N) (Live)		Over 50 (N) (Live)		Friday Night Beauty (N) (Live)		Sandra (N) (Live)			
Science	What on Earth?		What on Earth?		What on Earth?		What on Earth?		What on Earth?	
Sundance	(5:00) Dirty Rot...	★★★ Cheve Amigos! '86) Steve Martin, Martin Short.				★★★ Planes, Trains and Automobiles '87) John Candy, Steve Martin.				
SyFy	(6:00) ★★★ The Matrix Reloaded '03)				★★ The Matrix Revolutions '03) Keanu Reeves.					
TBS	Big Bang		Big Bang		★★★ Ocean's Eleven '01)		(:20) ★★★ Ocean's Twelve '04)			
TCM	(6:15) The Incident		★★★★ To Kill a Mockingbird '62)				(:15) ★★★ Black Girl '72) Brock Peters.			
TLC	90 Day Fiancé		90 Day Fiancé (N)		90 Day		Last Resort		90 Day	
TNT	(6:15) ★★ Man of Steel '13) Henry Cavill.				★★★ Wonder Woman '17) Chris Pine, Gal Gadot.					
Travel	The Dead Files		The Dead Files		The Dead Files		The Dead Files		The Dead Files	
TruTV	Banana Ball World Tour				★★★ Tin Cup '96) Rene Russo, Cheech Marin, Kevin Costner.					
TV Land	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	(:20) Raymond		Raymond	Raymond	King	King
TV One	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..
USA	Anna Pigeon "The Preacher"		WWE Friday Night SmackDown (N) (Live)				Anna Pigeon "Hell Is Other People" (N)		(:05) Law & Order: Special Victims Unit	
VH-1	My Wife	My Wife	★ Anaconda '97) Jennifer Lopez.				★★★ Selena '97) Jennifer Lopez.			
WE	(6:15) ★★ Overboard '87) Goldie Hawn.				Age (N)		Age Inappropriate		★★ Overboard '87)	